

Design of Operational amplifiers

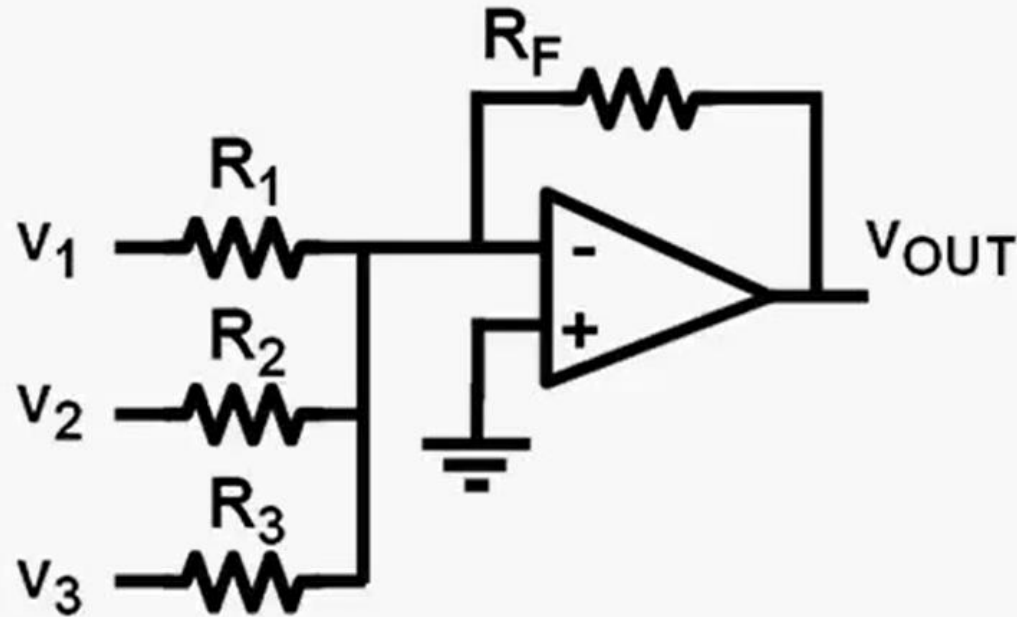
1



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Basics of opamp



$$-\frac{V_{OUT}}{R_F} = \frac{V_1}{R_1} + \frac{V_2}{R_2} + \frac{V_3}{R_3}$$

Requires High gain
High speed
Low power

Opamp specs :

Voltage Gain = High

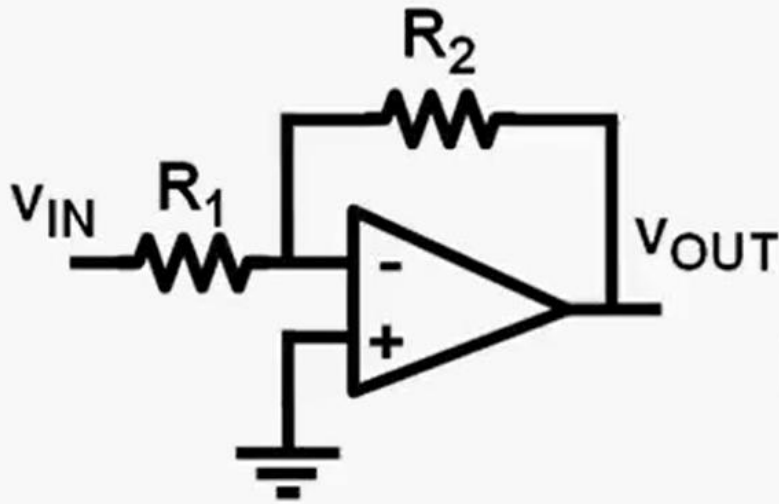
Input current = 0

Differential input voltage = 0

BW = High

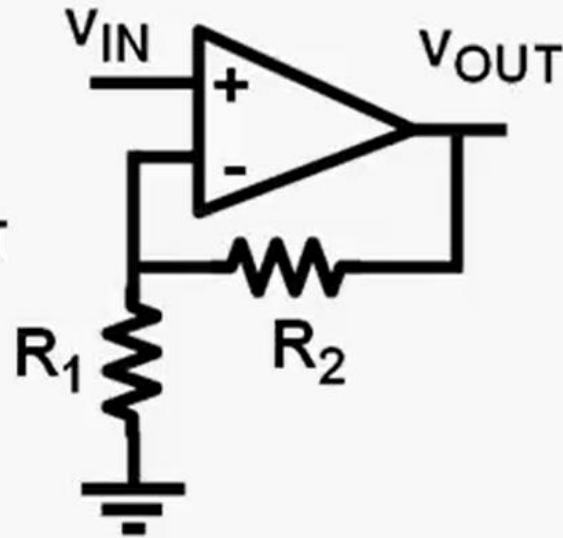
GBW = Very High

Basics of opamp



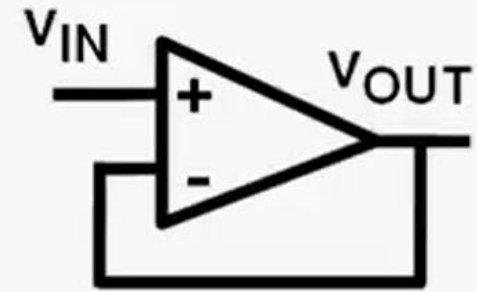
$$A_V = -\frac{R_2}{R_1}$$

$$R_{IN} = R_1$$



$$A_V = 1 + \frac{R_2}{R_1}$$

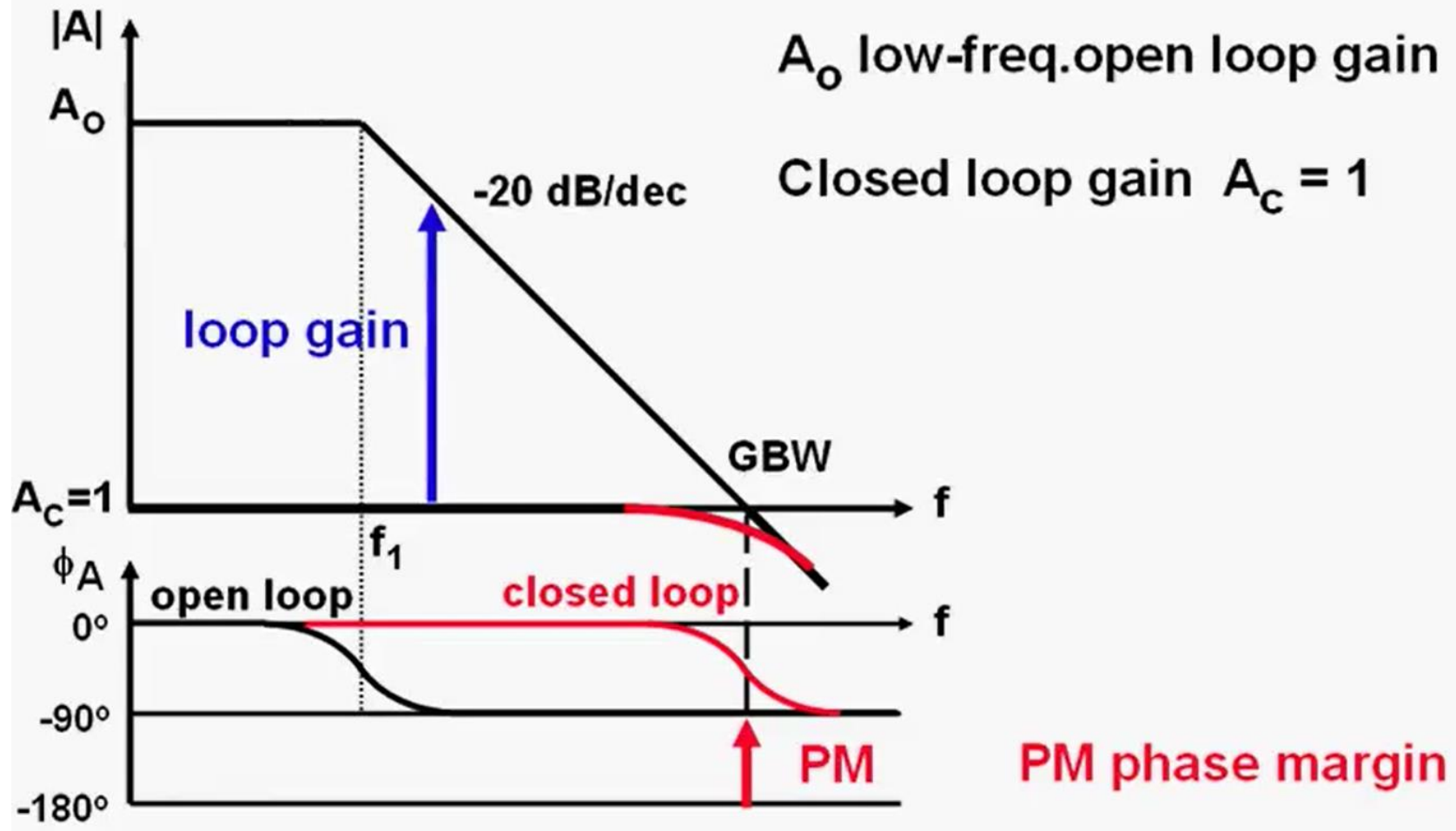
$$R_{IN} = \infty$$



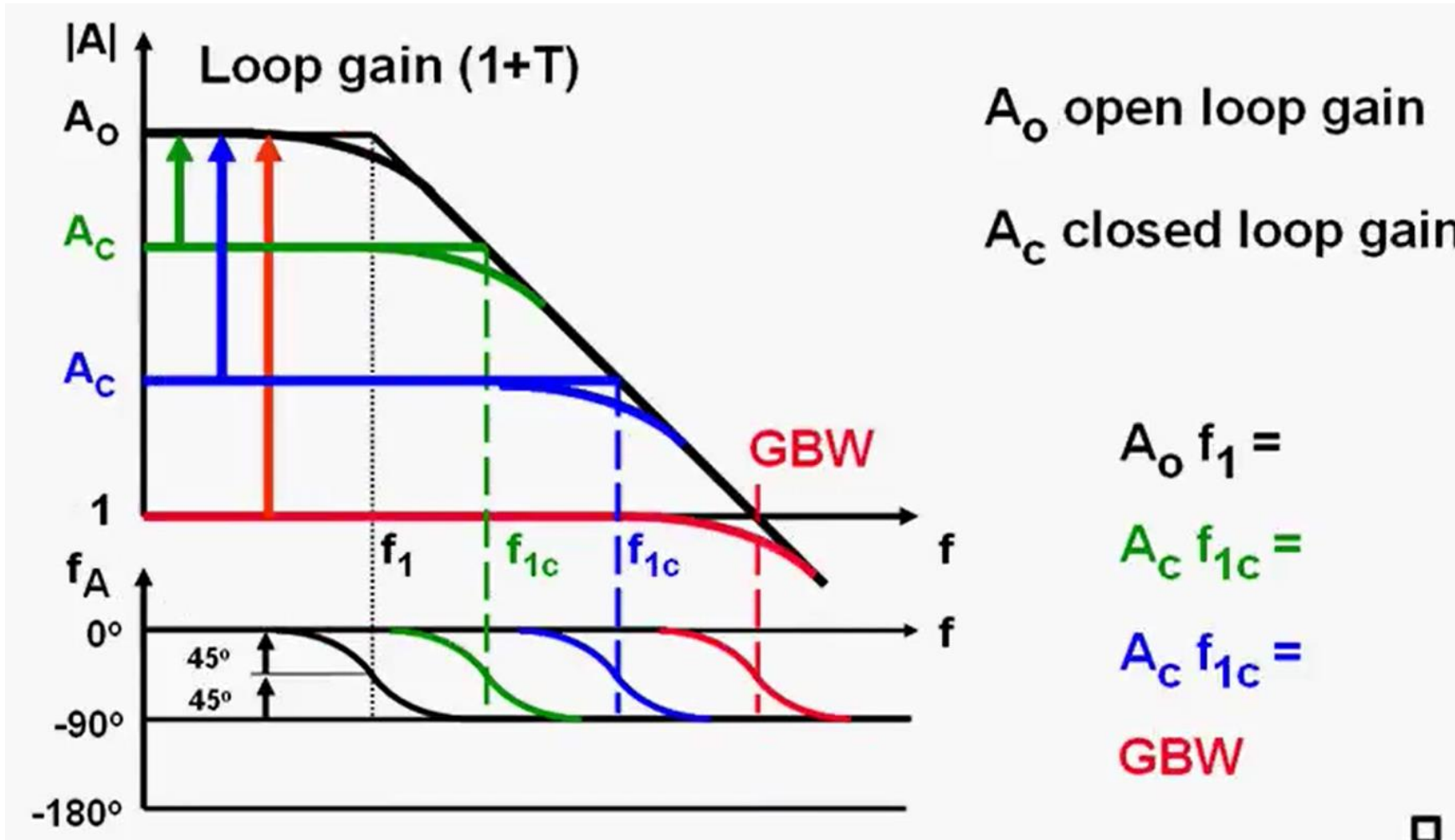
$$A_V = 1$$

$$R_{IN} = \infty$$

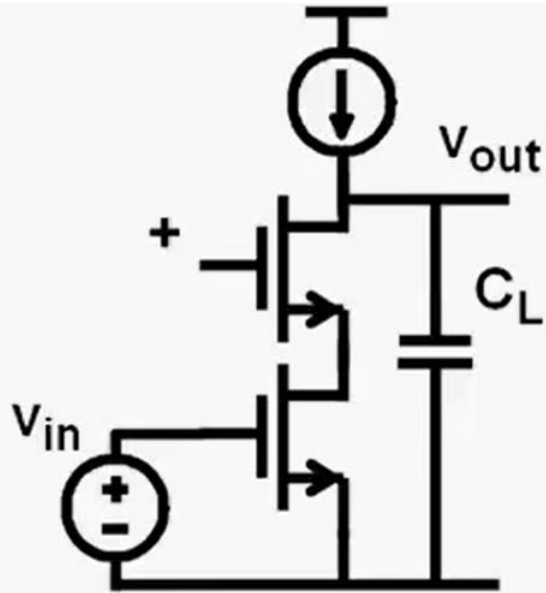
Basics of opamp



Basics of opamp

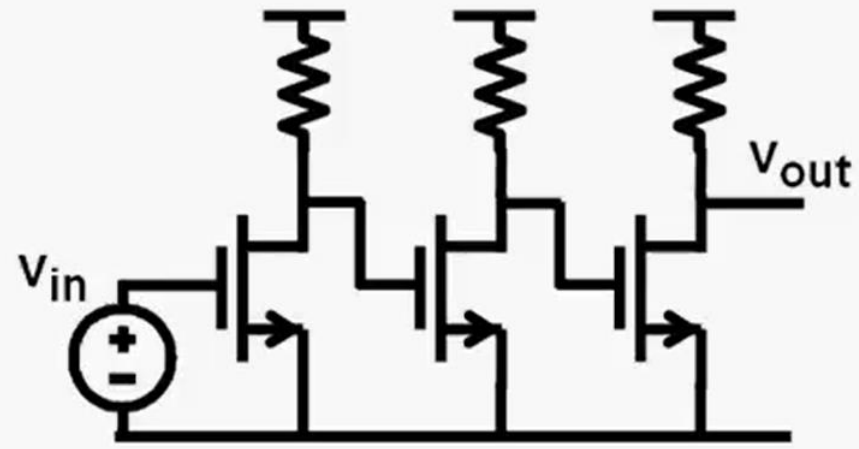


Basics of opamp



Operational amplifier :

Single-pole amplifier
High impedance = high gain
Exchange Gain-Bandwidth
Stable for all gain values

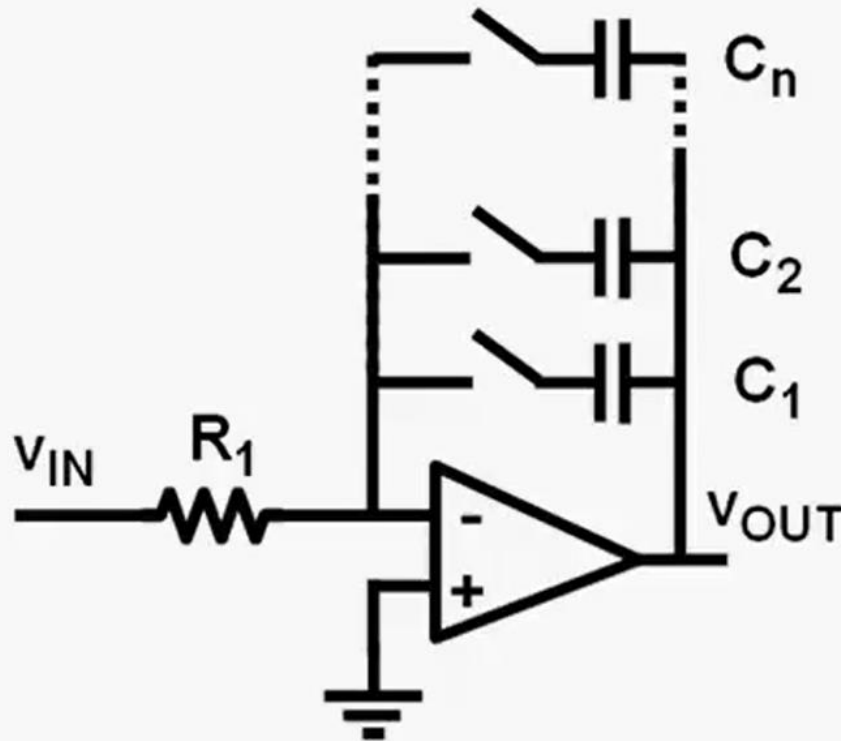


Wideband amplifier :

Multiple-pole amplifier
Low impedances at nodes
Wide Bandwidth
Stable for one gain only

Basics of opamp

Opamps and passive components (R, C)



Advantages :

S/N up to 100 dB

THD very low < -90 dB

Disadvantages :

Opamps :

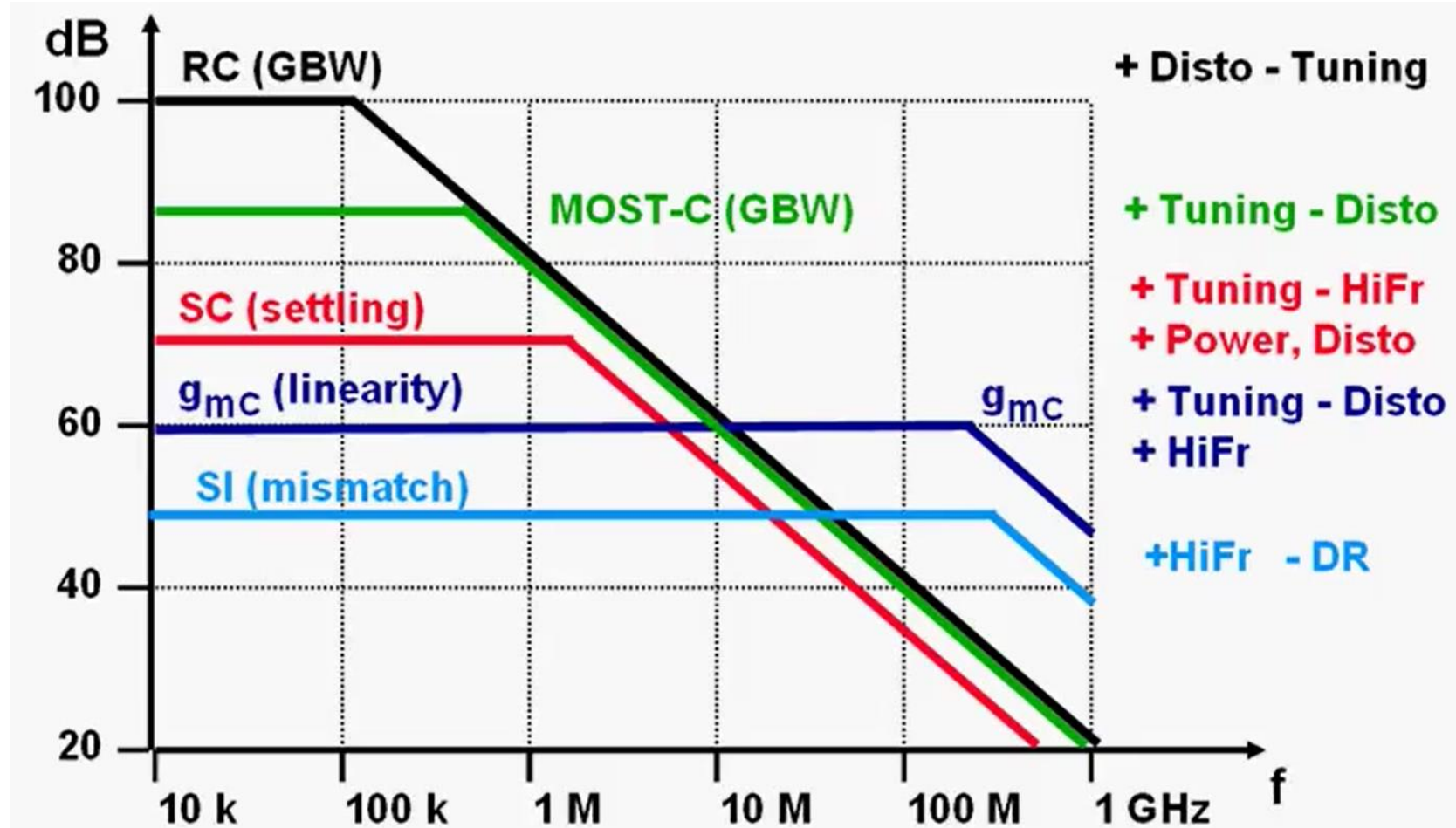
only for low frequencies

Errors on R, C $\approx 20\%$

$\gg$ tune C's

Ref. Hollman, JSSC July 01, pp.1148-1153

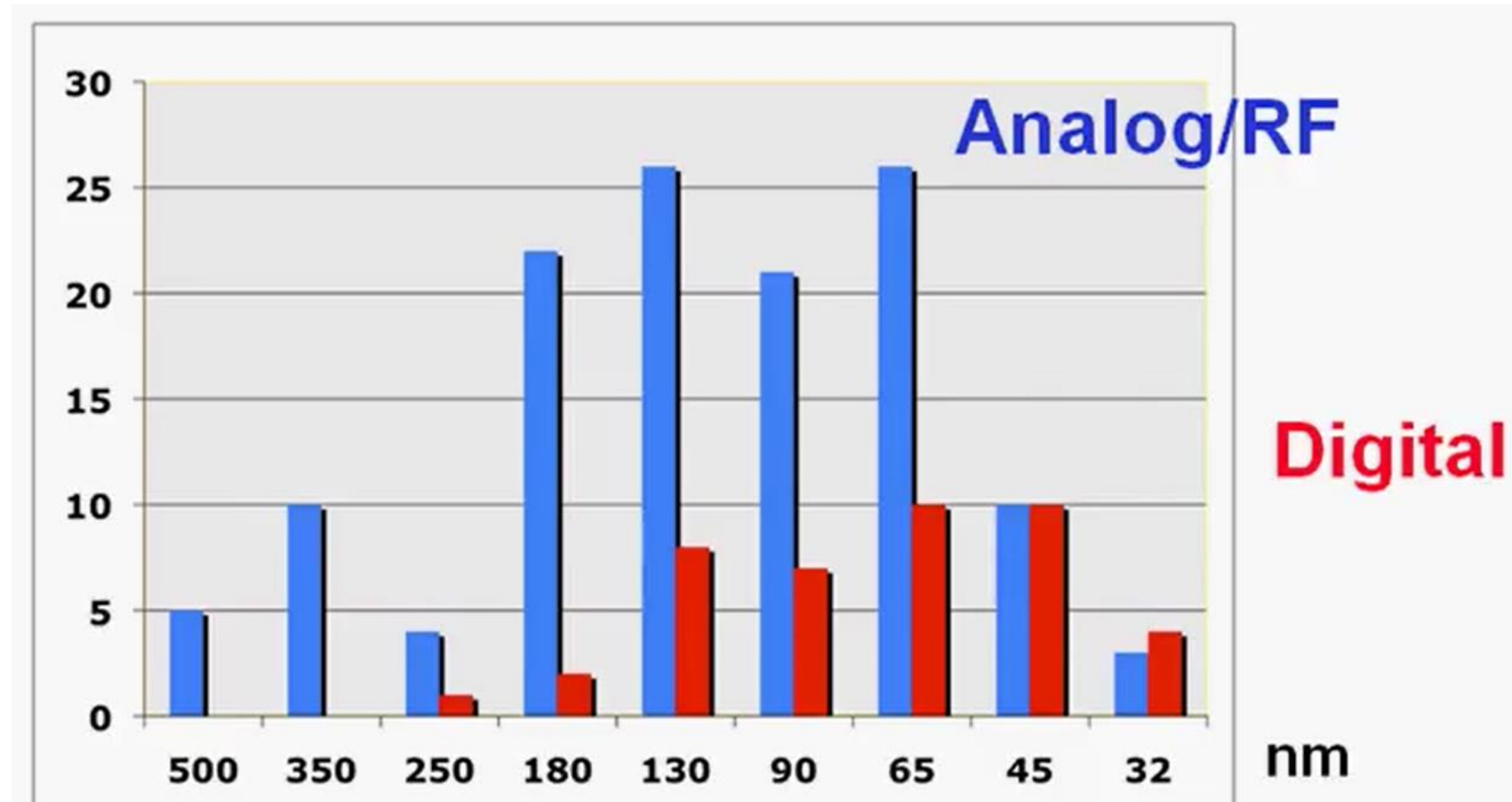
Basics of opamp



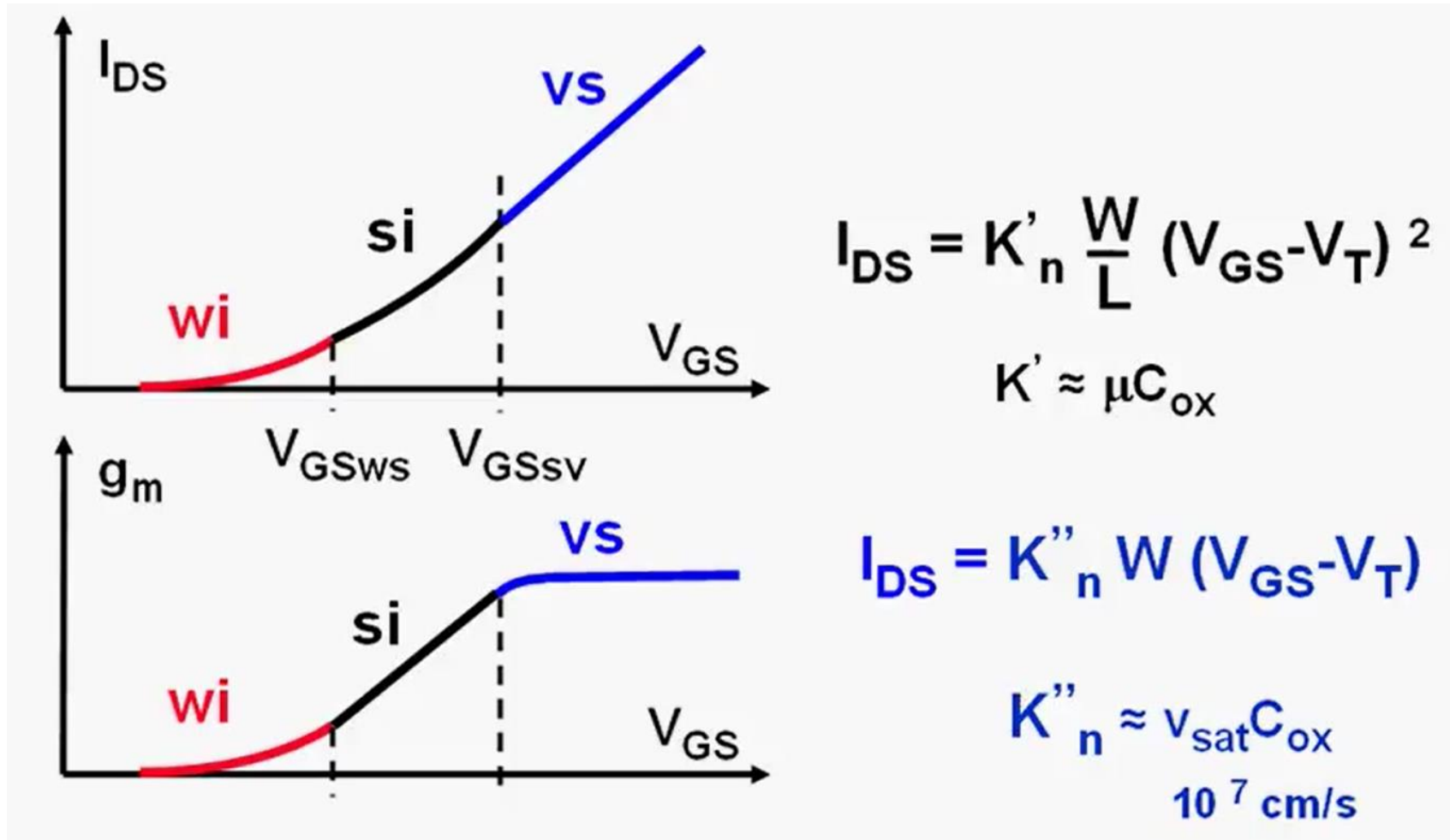
CMOS technologies Vs opamp

Nanometer CMOS technologies are leading to smaller channel lengths along with supply voltage **below or equal to 1V !!!!**

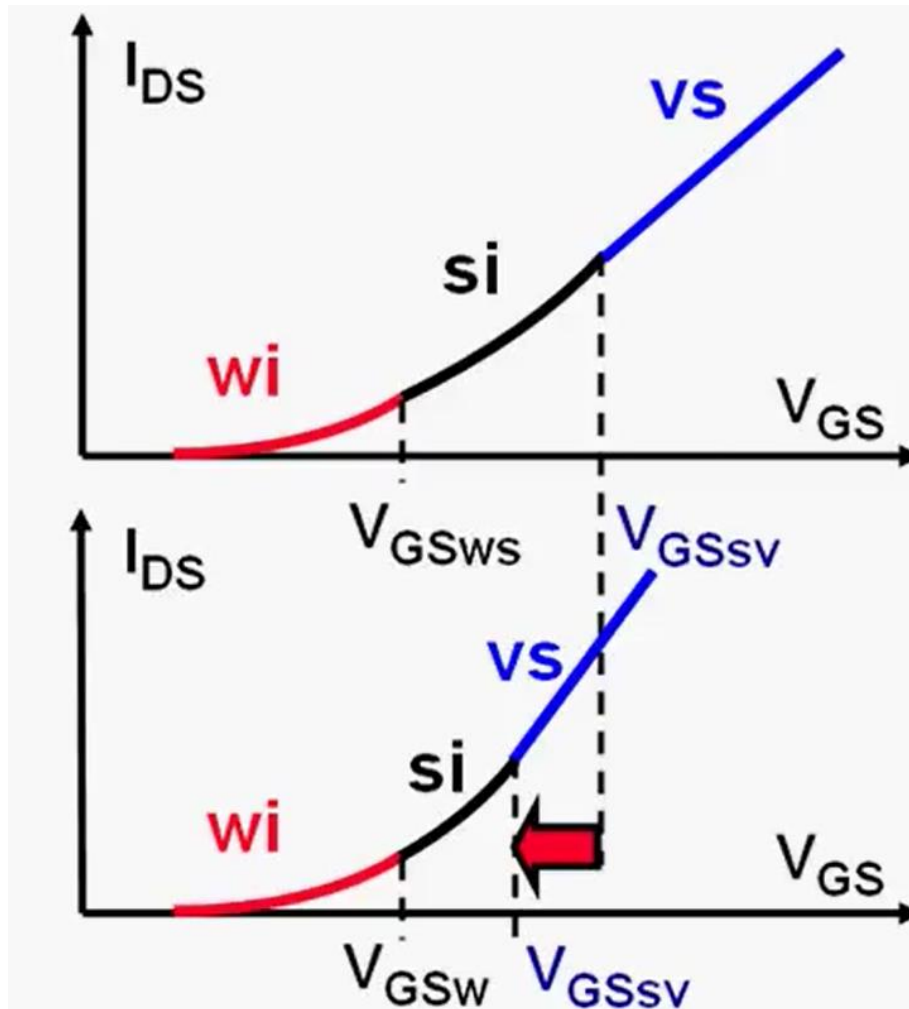
CMOS technologies Vs opamp



CMOS technologies Vs opamp



CMOS technologies Vs opamp

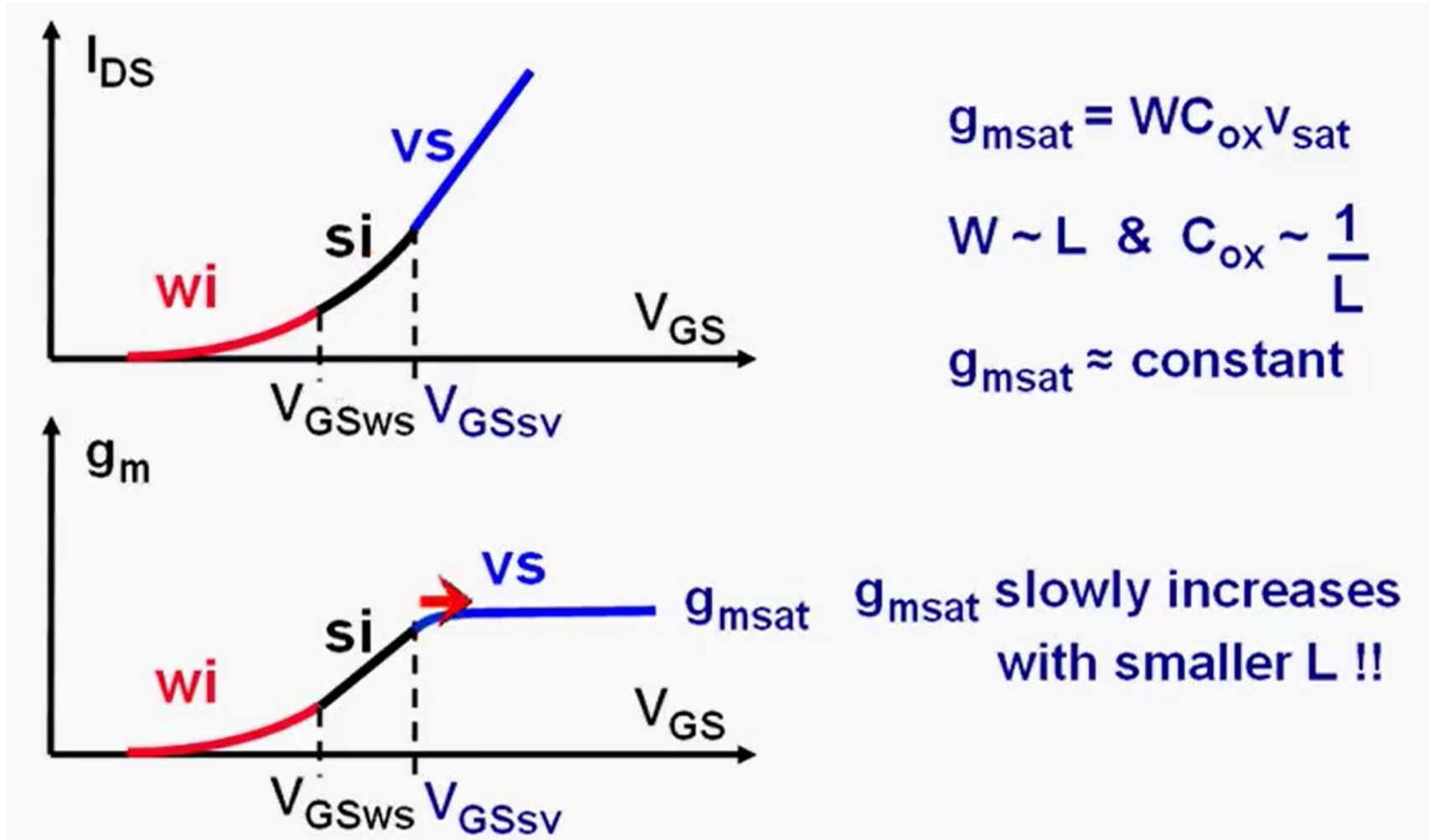


$$V_{GSws} - V_T = 2n \frac{kT}{q}$$

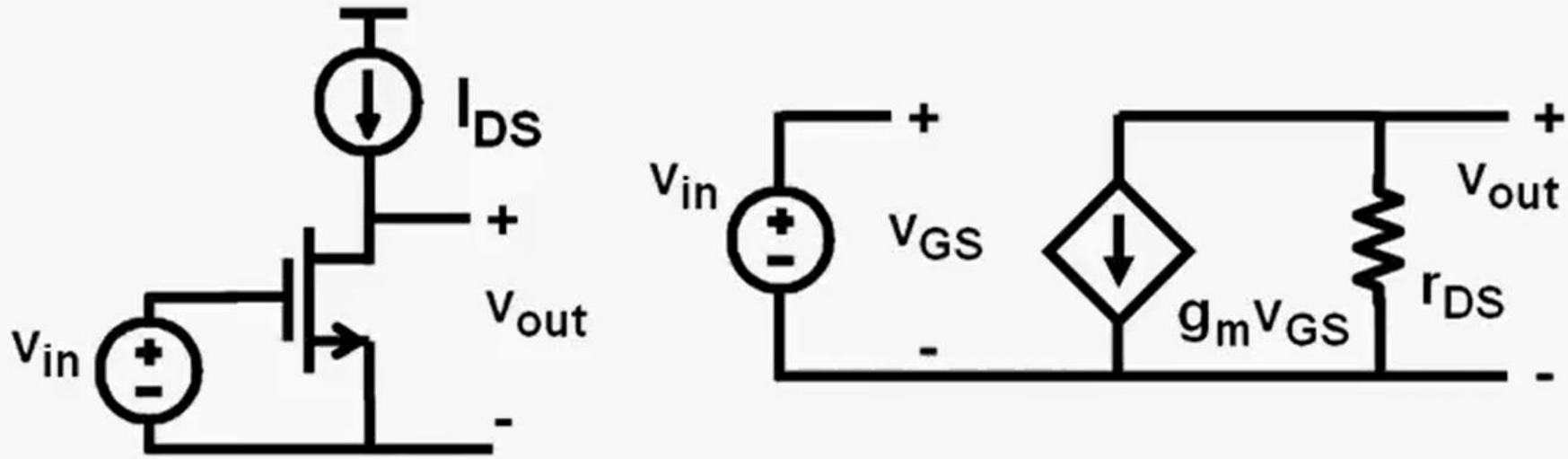
$$V_{GSvs} - V_T = 4nL \frac{v_{sat}}{\mu}$$

$\sim L !!$

CMOS technologies Vs opamp



CMOS technologies Vs opamp



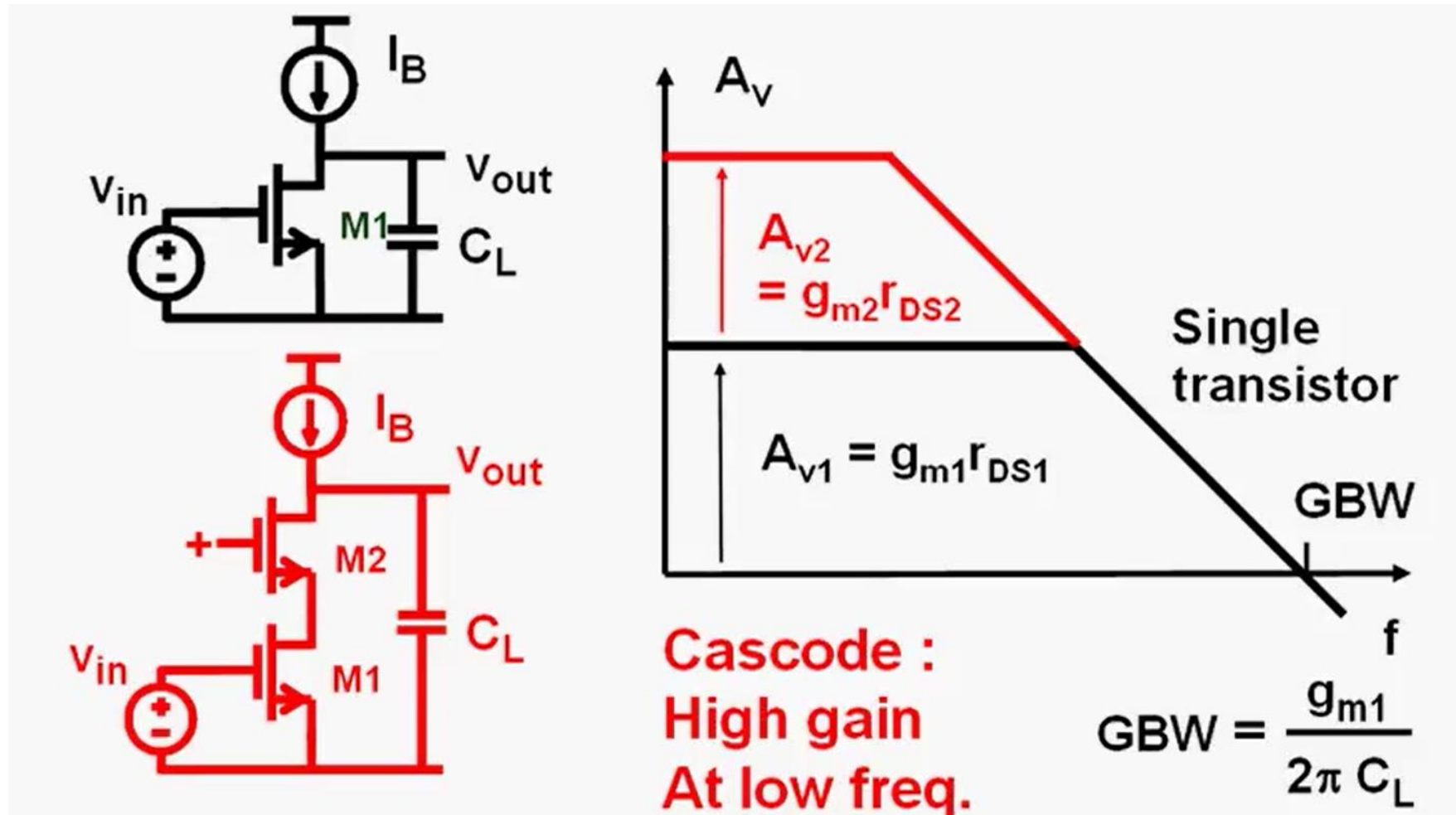
$$A_v = g_m r_{DS} = \frac{2 I_{DS}}{V_{GS} - V_T} \frac{V_E L}{I_{DS}} = \frac{2 V_E L}{V_{GS} - V_T}$$

For $L = 65 \text{ nm}$ ($V_E \approx 5 \text{ V}/\mu\text{m}$ & $V_{GS} - V_T \approx 0.2 \text{ V}$) : $A_v \approx 3.2 !!!$

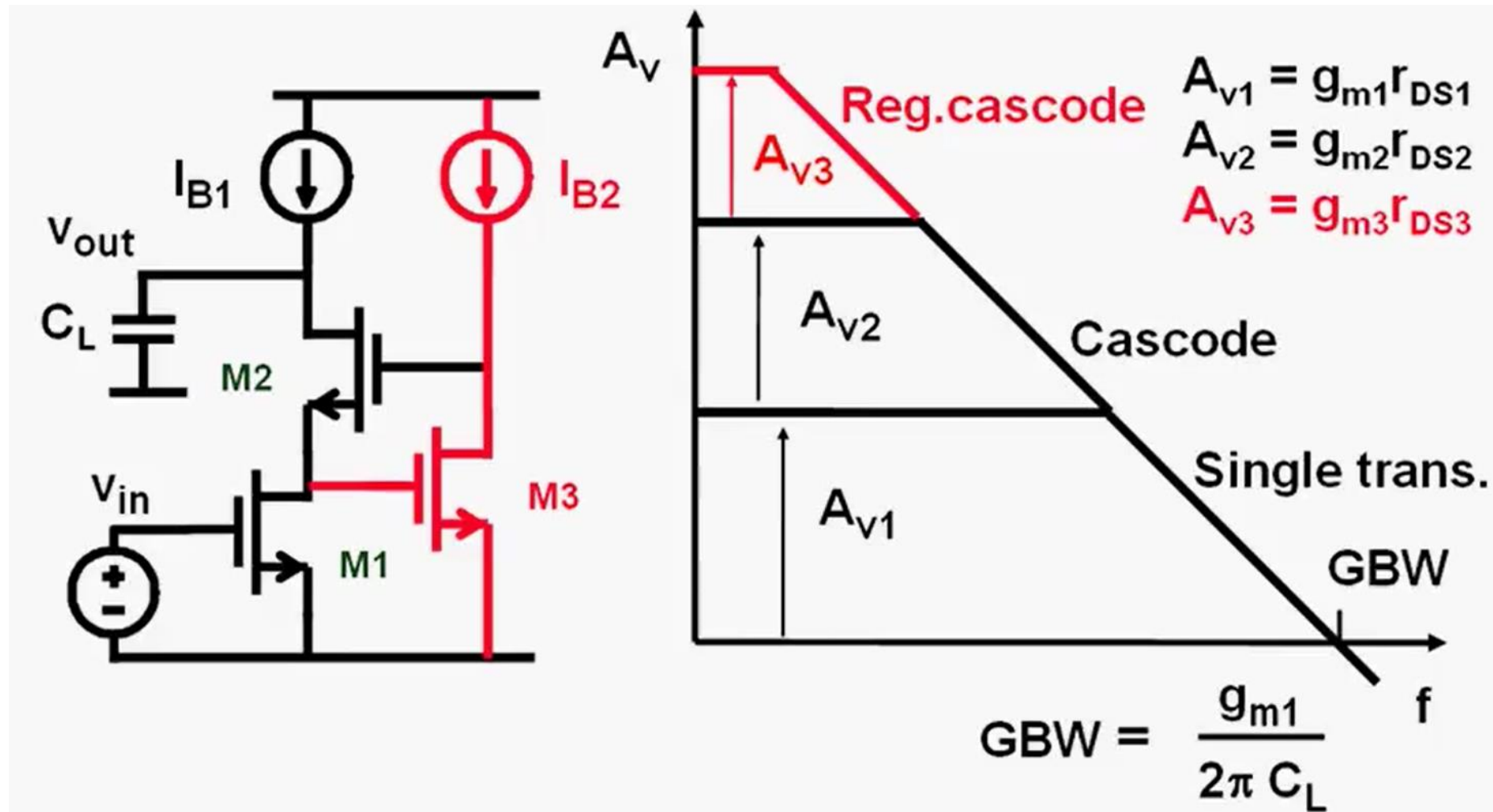
**As CMOS technology node reduces
opamp gain reduces significantly**

Sol : Gain Boosting !!!!

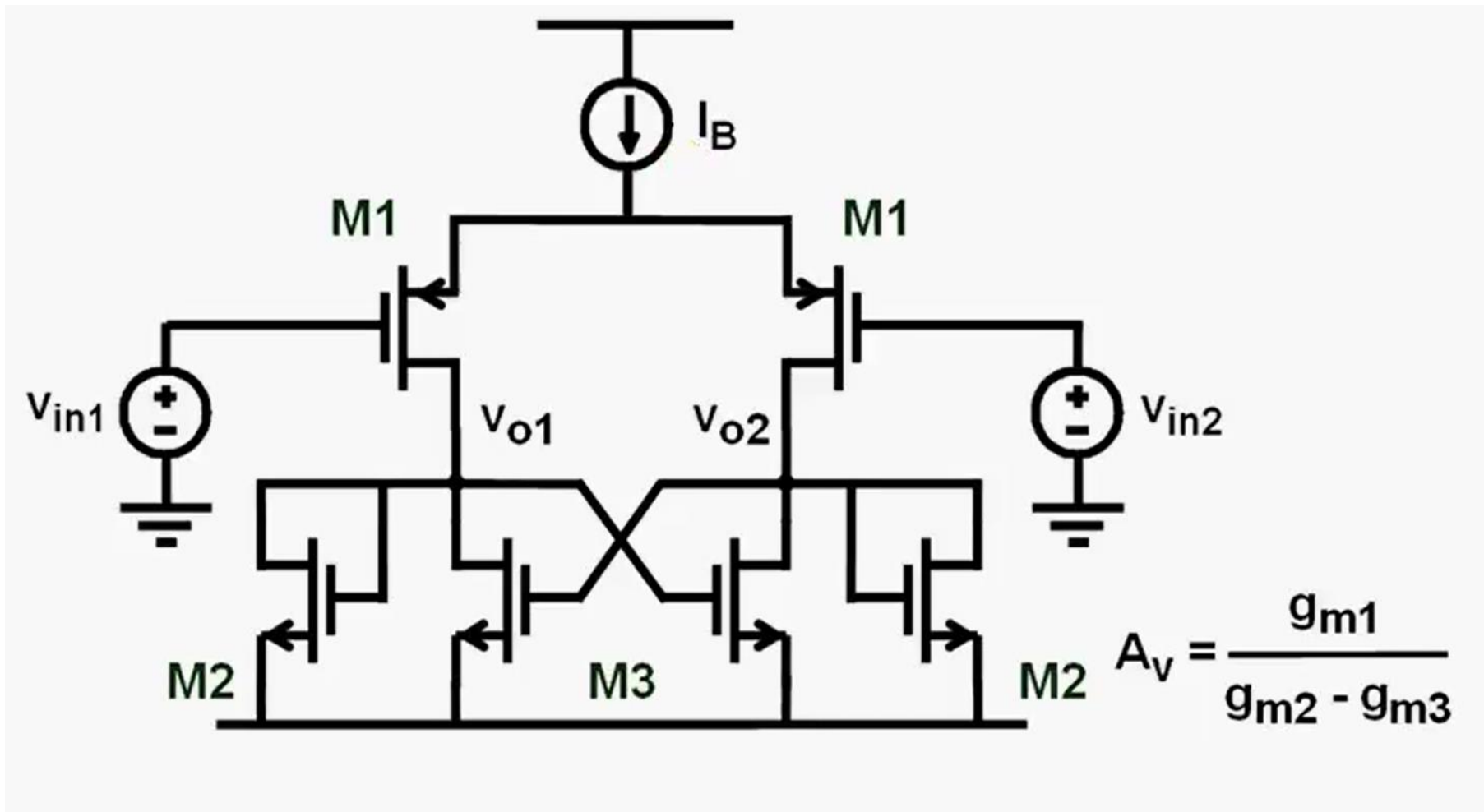
Idea 1



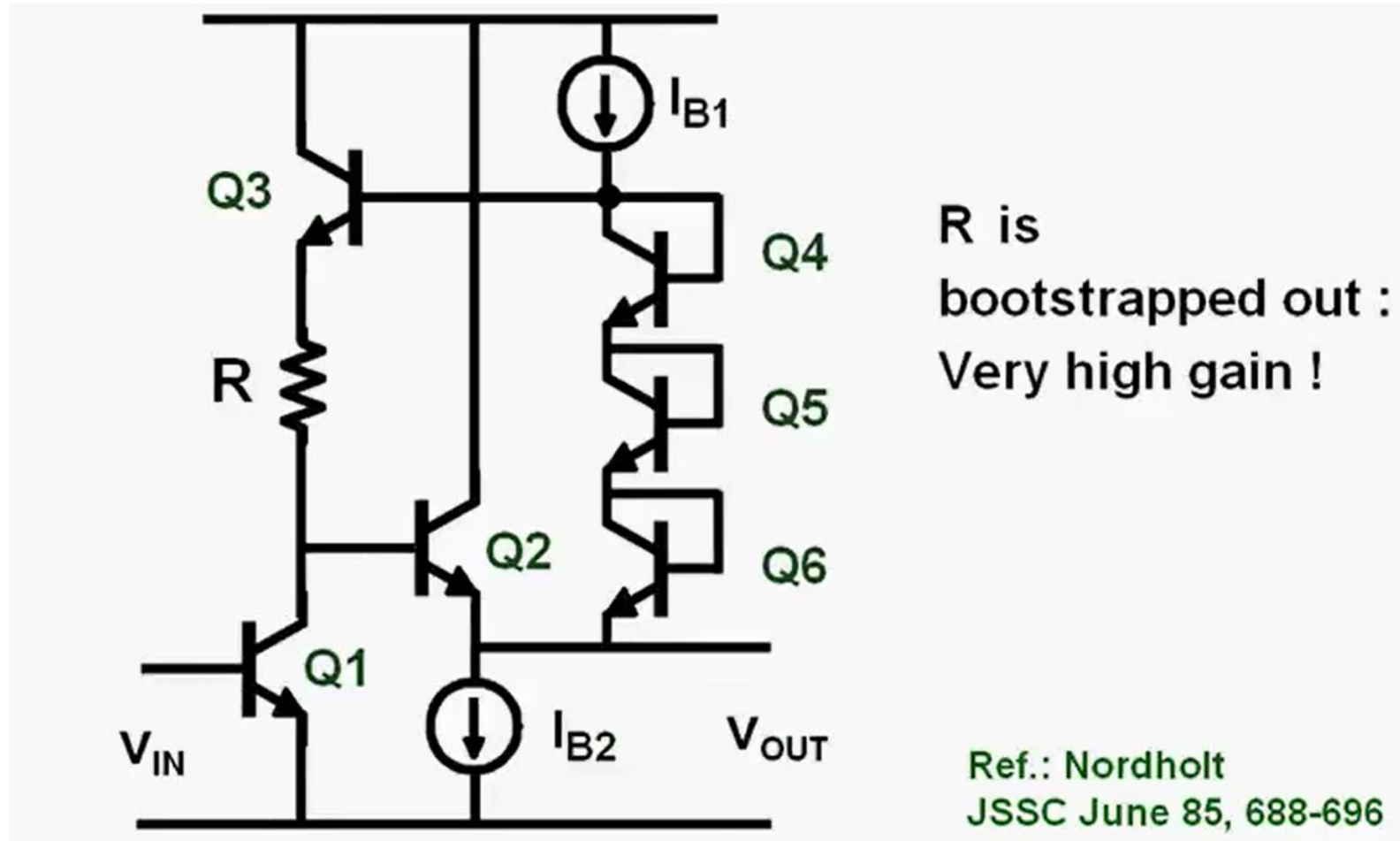
Idea 2



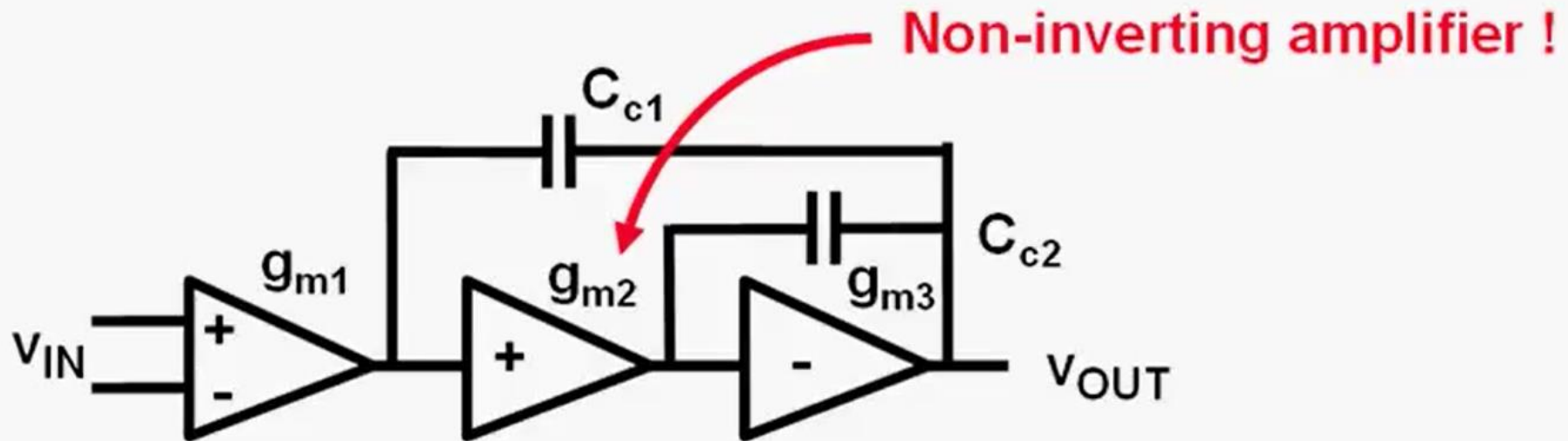
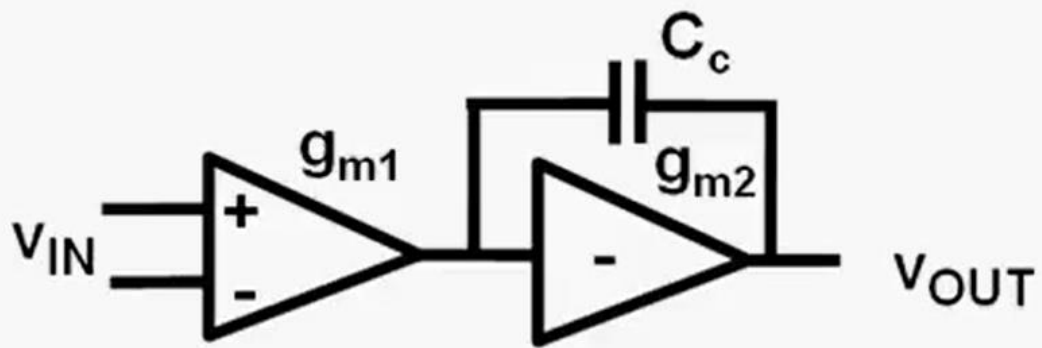
Idea 3



Idea 4

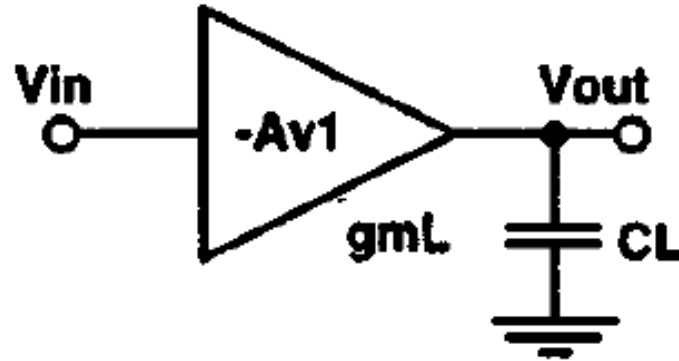


Idea 5



Speed, Noise and Power !!!

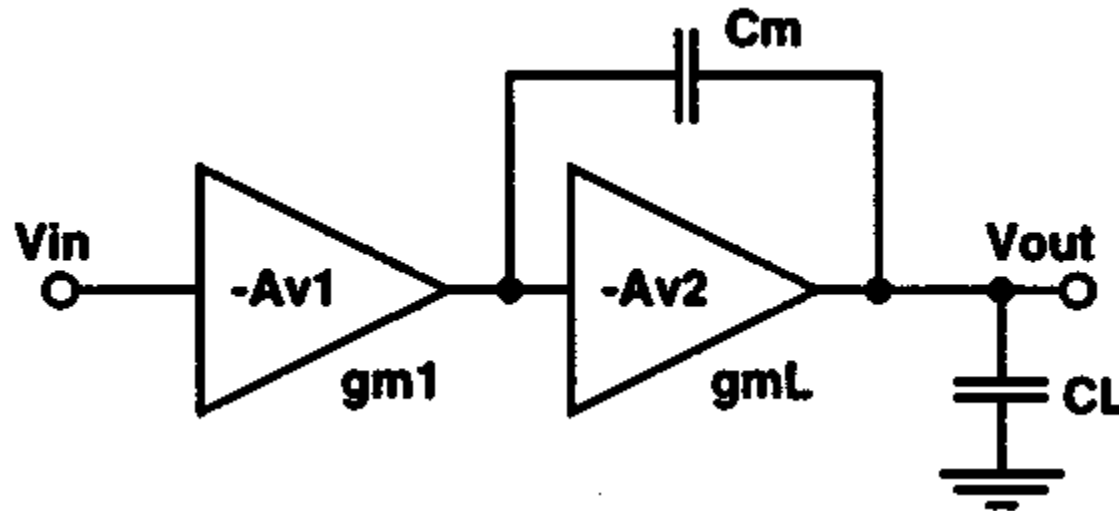
Quick Revision



$$A_{v_{single}}(s) = \frac{g_{mL}R_L}{1 + sC_LR_L}$$

$$GBW = \frac{g_{mL}}{C_L}$$

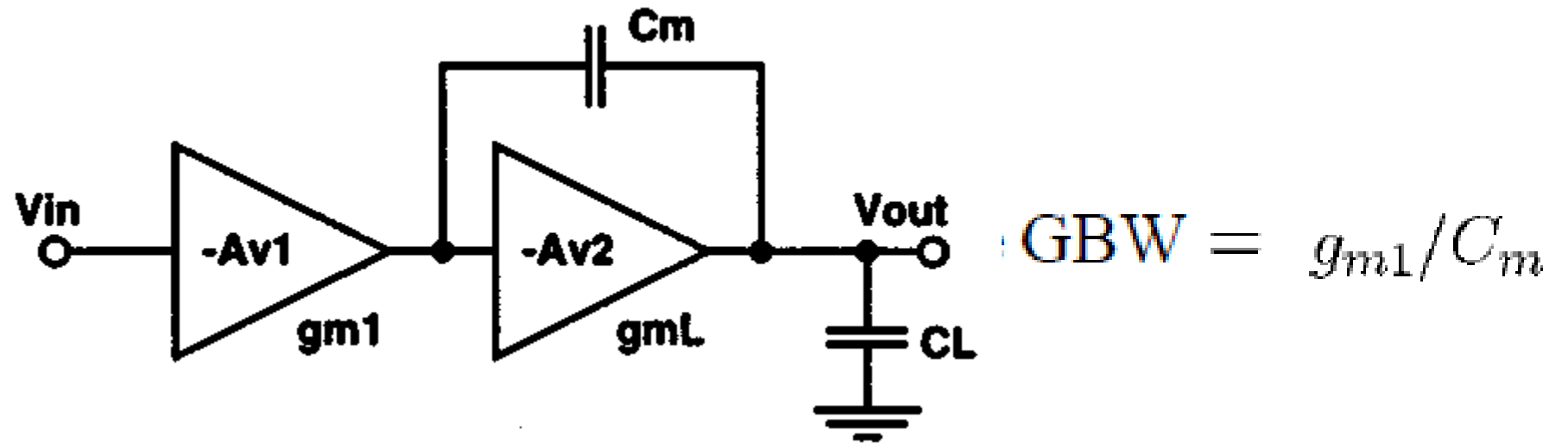
Quick Revision



$$A_{v(\text{SMC})}(s) = \frac{g_{m1}g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L(1 - s\frac{C_m}{g_{mL}})}{(1 + sC_mg_{mL}R_{o1}R_L)(1 + s\frac{C_L}{g_{mL}})}$$

$$\text{GBW} = g_{m1}/C_m$$

Quick Revision

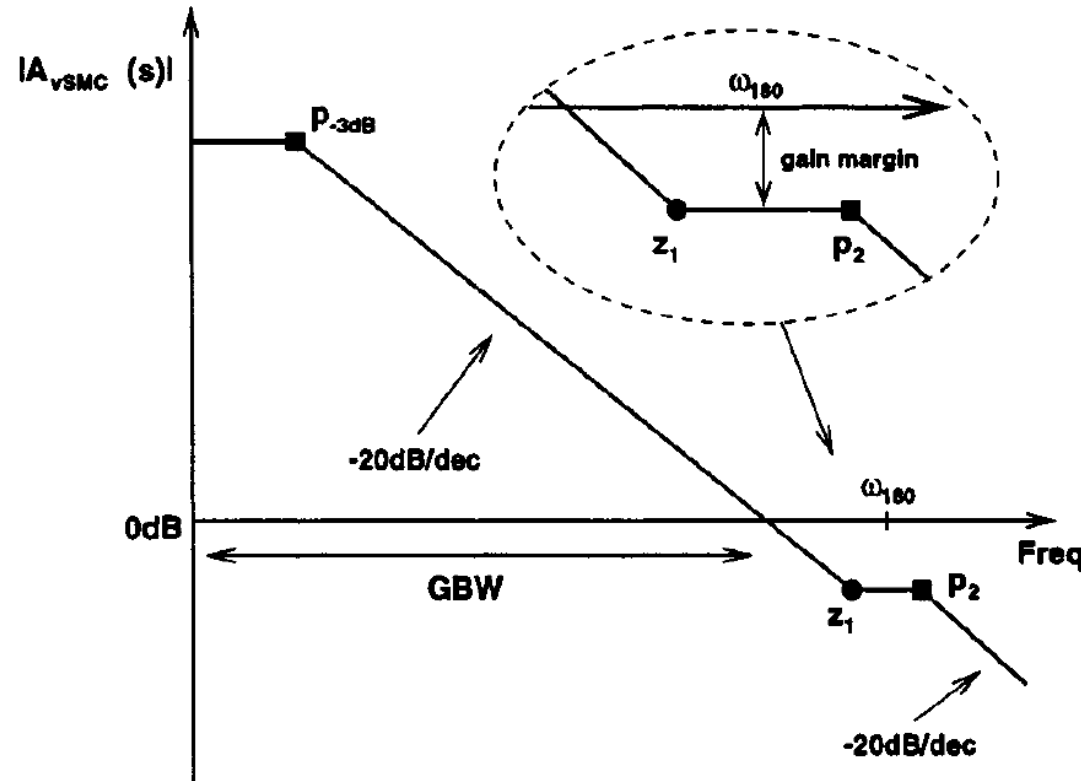


$$p_{-3 \text{ dB}} = 1/C_m g_{mL} R_{o1} R_L$$

$$p_2 = g_{mL}/C_L$$

$$z_1 = -g_{mL}/C_m$$

Quick Revision



GBW is generally set to be half of to obtain a good PM !!!

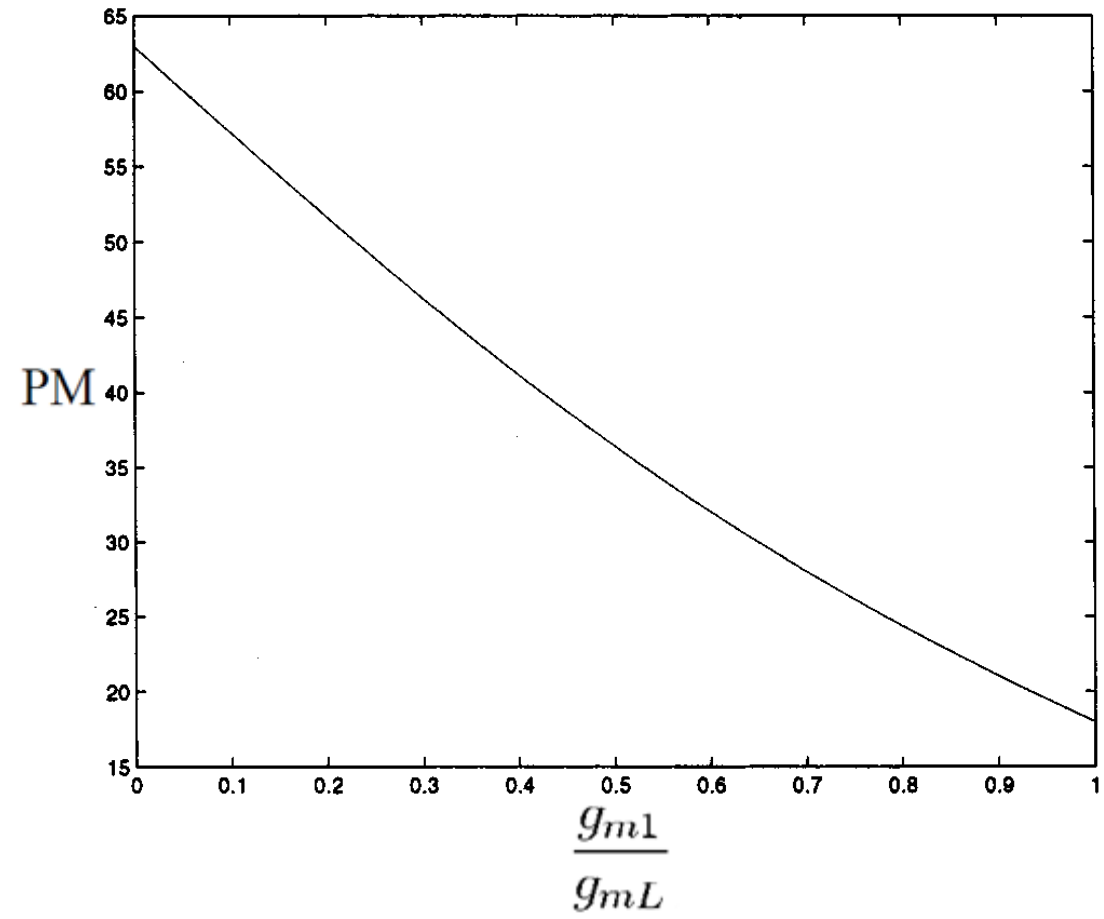
$$g_{mL}/C_L = 2g_{m1}/C_m$$

$$C_m = 2 \left(\frac{g_{m1}}{g_{mL}} \right) C_L$$

As Z1 locates before P2, the gain margin is small and the amplifier may be unstable !!!

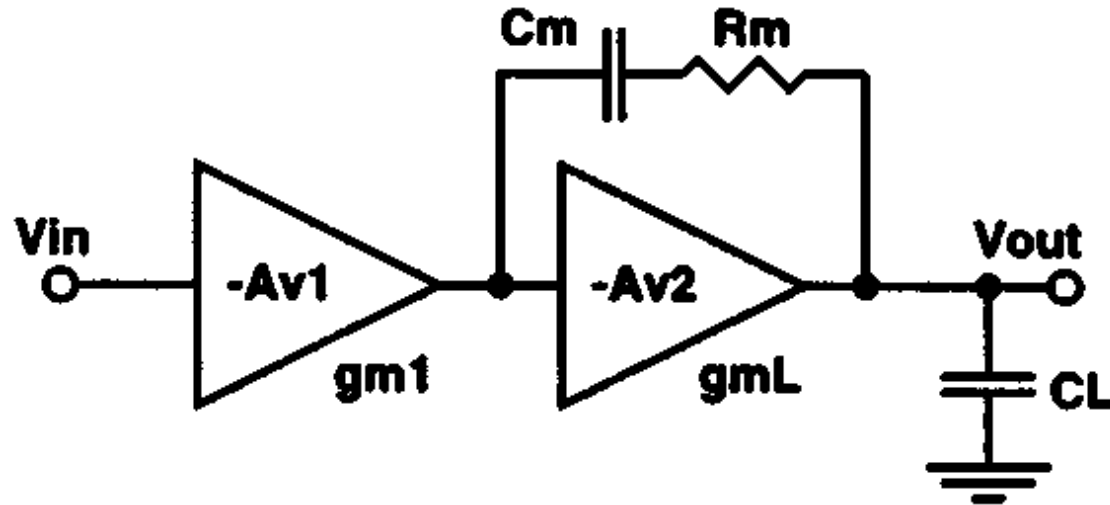
Quick Revision

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PM} &= 180^\circ - \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{\text{GBW}}{p_{-3 \text{ dB}}} \right) - \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{\text{GBW}}{p_2} \right) - \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{\text{GBW}}{|z_1|} \right) \\ &\approx 63^\circ - \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{g_{m1}}{g_{mL}} \right) \end{aligned}$$



(Leung et al, TCAS1, 2001)

Quick Revision

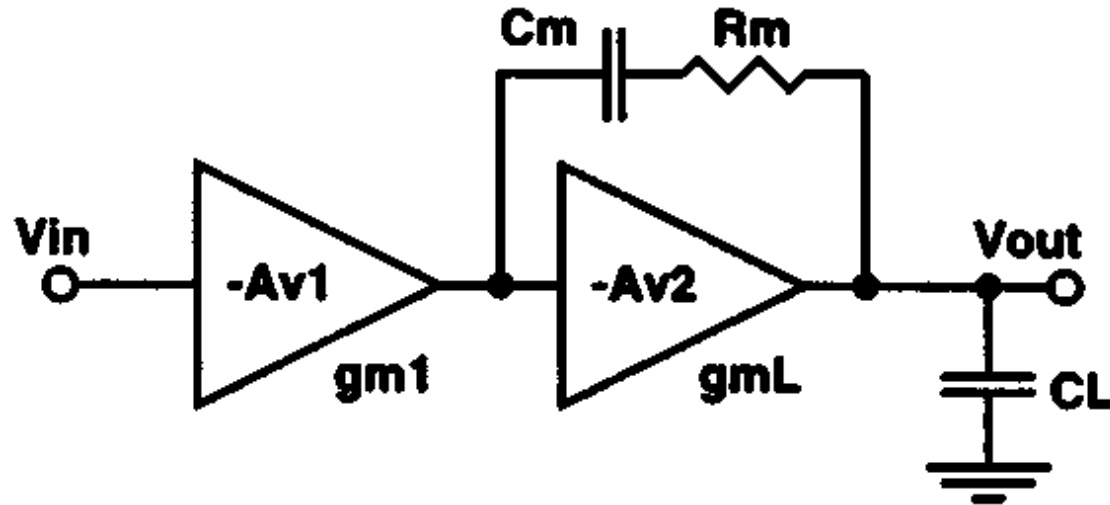


$$z_1 = 1/C_m (R_m - 1/g_{mL})$$

$$\text{GBW} = g_{m1}/C_m$$

$$A_{v(\text{SMCNR})}(s) = \frac{g_{m1}g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L \left[1 + sC_m \left(R_m - \frac{1}{g_{mL}} \right) \right]}{\left[1 + sC_m(R_m + g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L) \right] \left[1 + s \frac{C_L(R_{o1} + R_m)R_L}{R_m + g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L} \right]}$$

Quick Revision

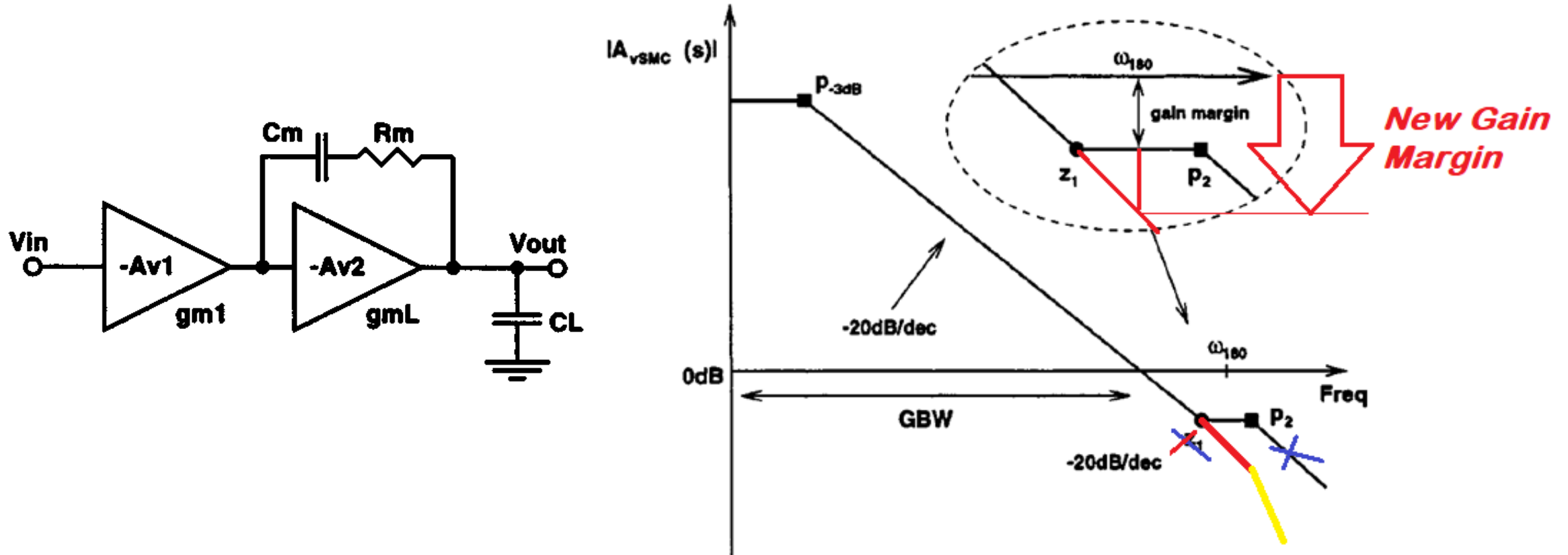


$$z_1 = 1/C_m (R_m - 1/g_{mL})$$

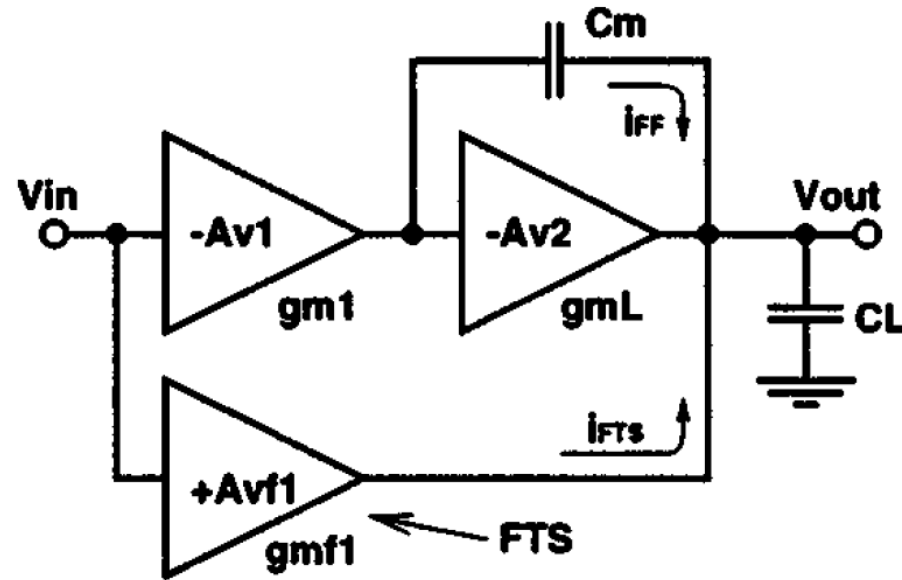
$$\text{GBW} = g_{m1}/C_m$$

$$A_{v(\text{SMCNR})}(s) = \frac{g_{m1}g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L \left[1 + sC_m \left(R_m - \frac{1}{g_{mL}} \right) \right]}{\left[1 + sC_m(R_m + g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L) \right] \left[1 + s \frac{C_L(R_{o1} + R_m)R_L}{R_m + g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L} \right]}$$

Quick Revision



Quick Revision



$$A_{v(MZC)}(s) = \frac{g_{m1}g_{mL}R_{o1}R_L \left[1 + s \frac{C_m(g_{mf1} - g_{m1})}{g_{m1}g_{mL}} \right]}{(1 + sC_mg_{mL}R_{o1}R_L) \left(1 + s \frac{C_L}{g_{mL}} \right)}$$

Speed, Noise and Power !!!

Speed, Noise and Power

Thermal noise :

$$\overline{dv_{ieq}}^2 = 4kT \left(\frac{2/3}{g_m} \right) df \sim \frac{L}{W} \quad \text{Increases for smaller } W/L !$$

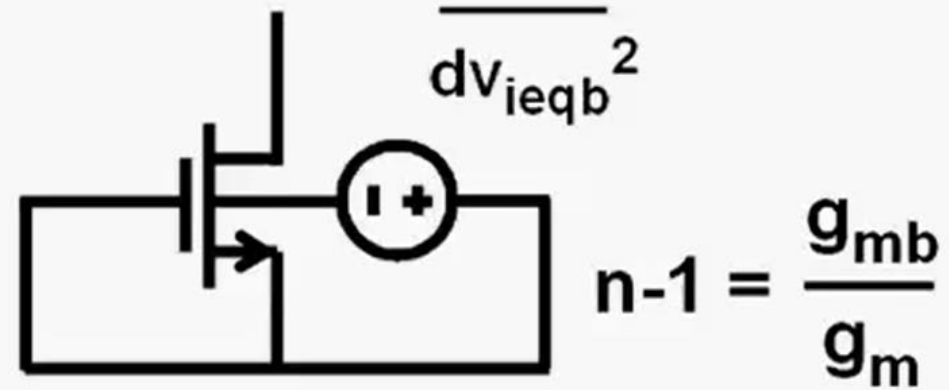
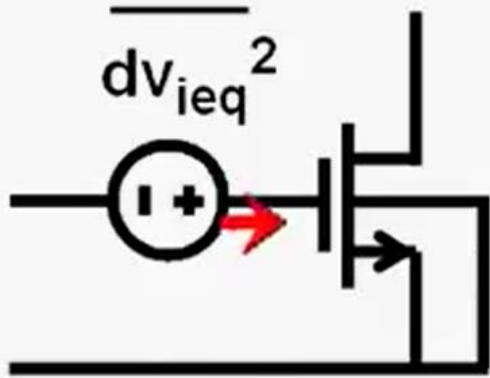
no v_{sat}

1/f noise

$$\overline{dv_{ieqf}}^2 = \frac{KF_F}{WL C_{ox}^2} \frac{df}{f} \sim \frac{1}{WLC_{ox}^2} \quad \text{Increases for smaller } W \text{ and } L ?$$

SNR decreases for smaller W and L !

Speed, Noise and Power



$$n-1 = \frac{g_{mb}}{g_m}$$

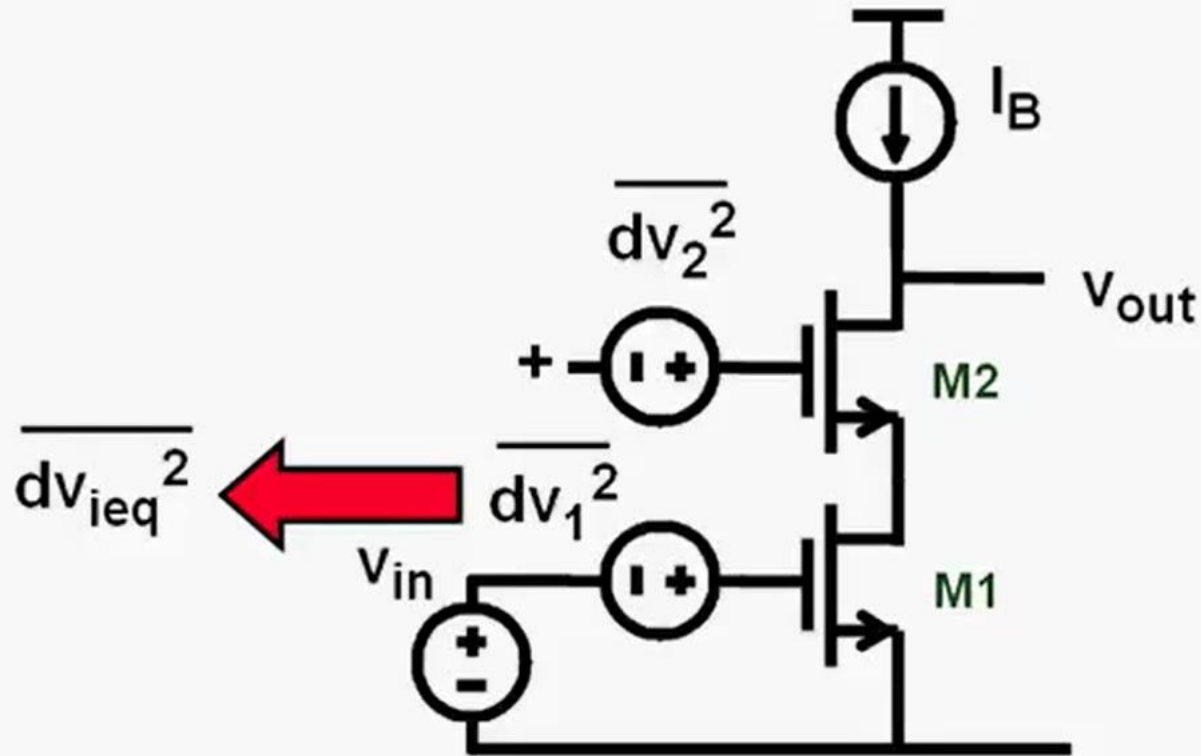
$$\overline{dv_{ieq}^2} = 4kT \left(\frac{2/3}{g_m} \right) df$$

$$\overline{dv_{ieqb}^2} = 4kT \left(\frac{2/3 g_m}{g_{mb}^2} \right) df$$

$$\overline{dv_{ieqf}^2} = \frac{KF_F}{WL C_{ox}^2} \frac{df}{f}$$

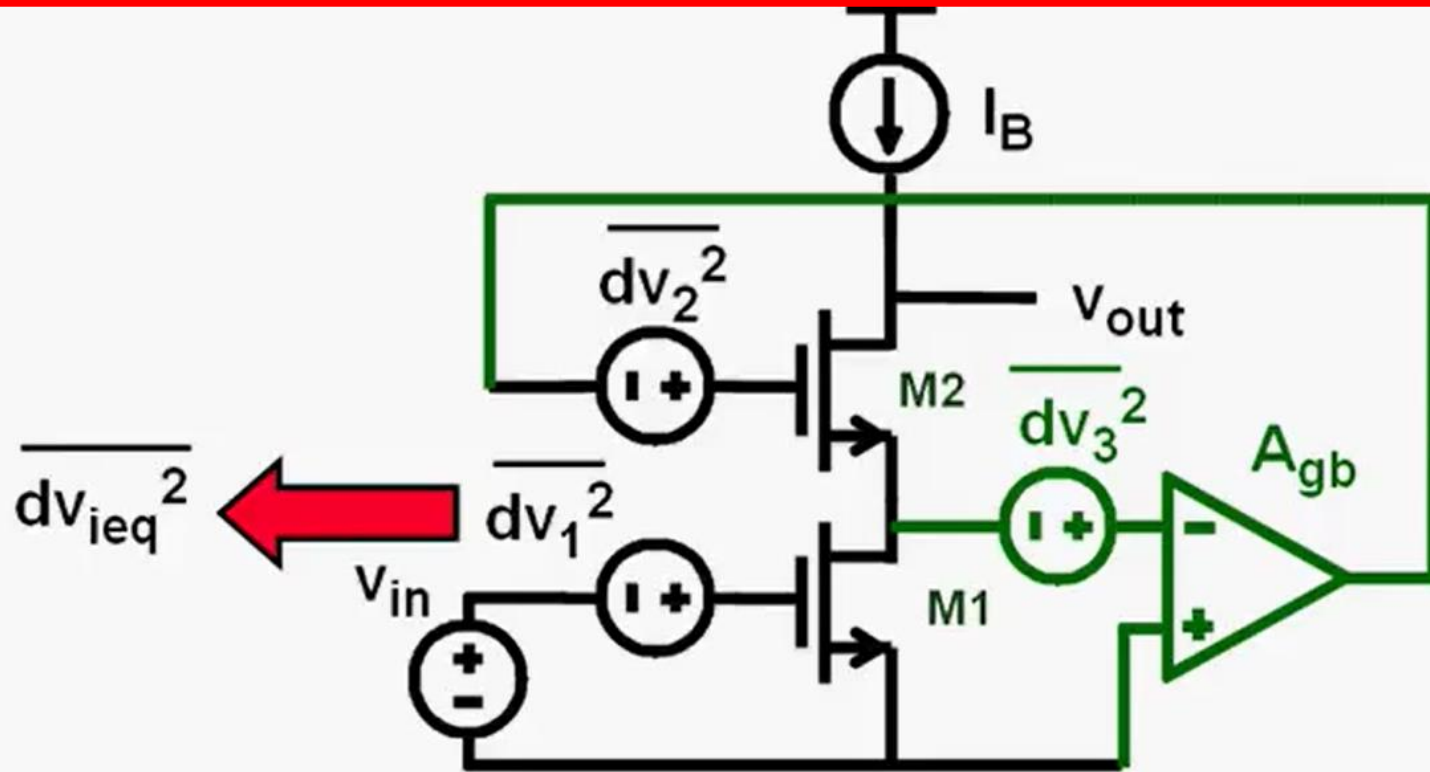
$$\overline{dv_{ieqfb}^2} = \frac{KF_F}{WL C_{ox}^2} \frac{g_m^2}{g_{mb}^2} \frac{df}{f}$$

Speed, Noise and Power



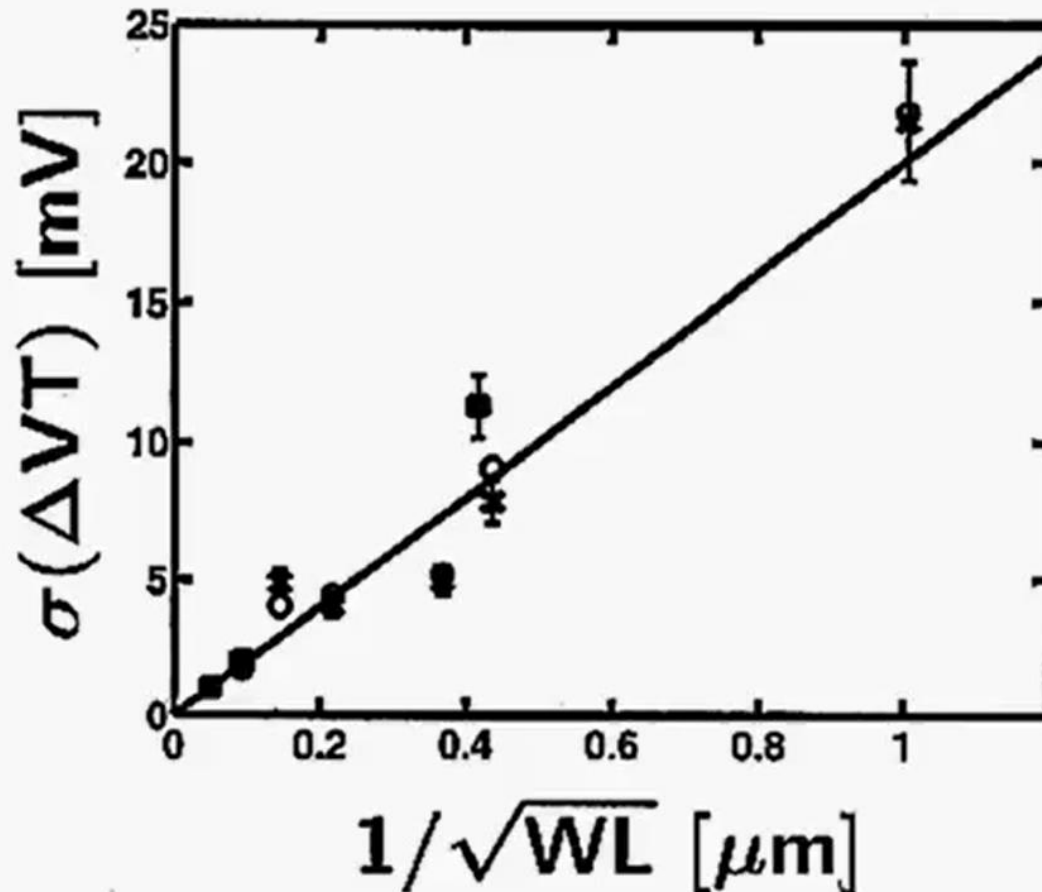
$$\overline{dv_{ieq}^2} = \overline{dv_1^2} + \overline{dv_2^2} \frac{1}{(g_{m1} r_{o1})^2} \approx \overline{dv_1^2}$$

Speed, Noise and Power



$$\overline{dv_{ieq}^2} = \overline{dv_1^2} + \overline{dv_2^2} \frac{1}{(g_{m1} r_{o1})^2} + \overline{dv_3^2} \frac{1}{(g_{m1} r_{o1})^2} \approx \overline{dv_1^2}$$

Speed, Noise and Power

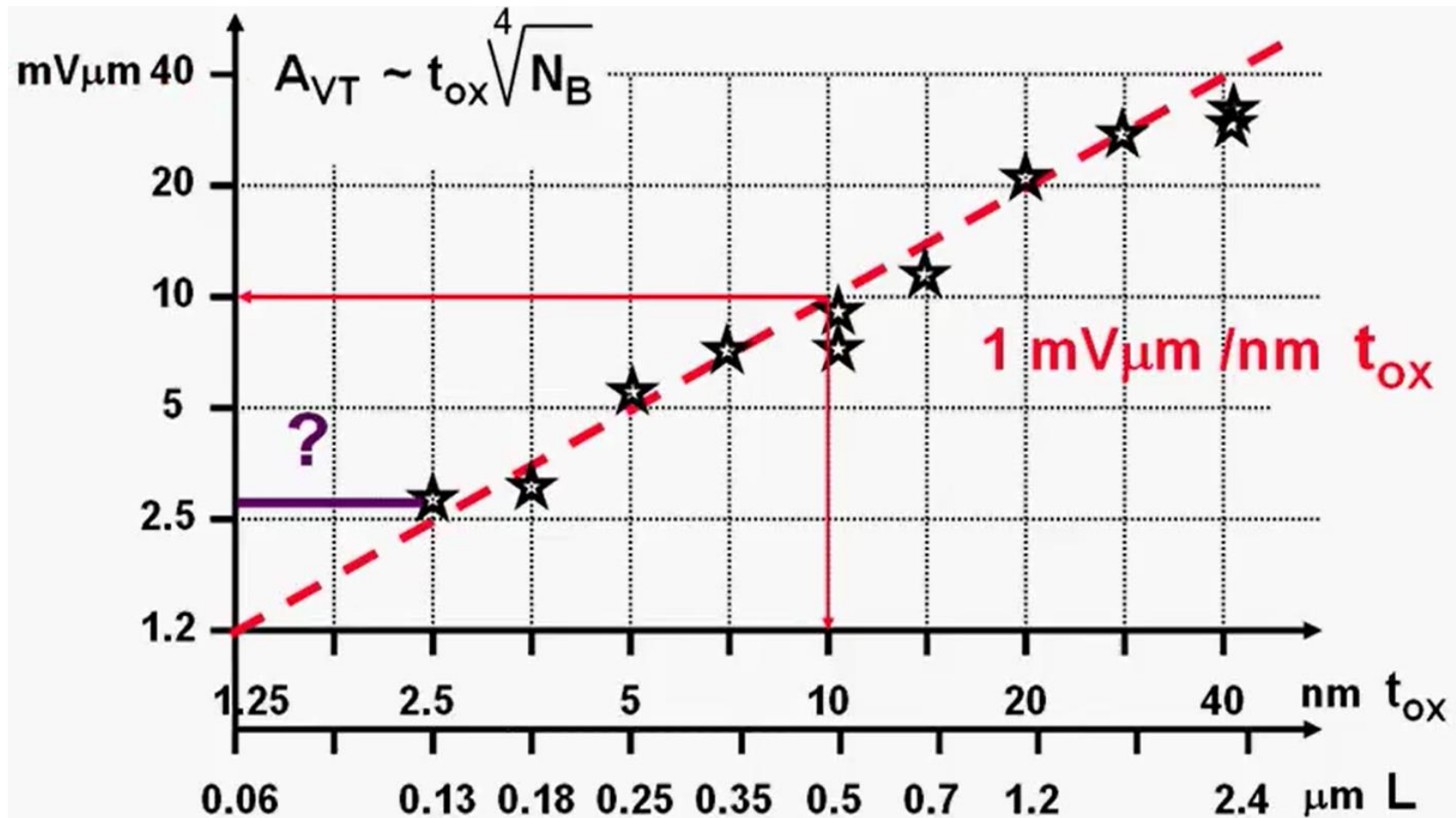


$$\sigma^2(\Delta V_T) \approx \frac{A_{VT}^2}{WL}$$

$$A_{VT} \sim t_{ox} \sim L$$

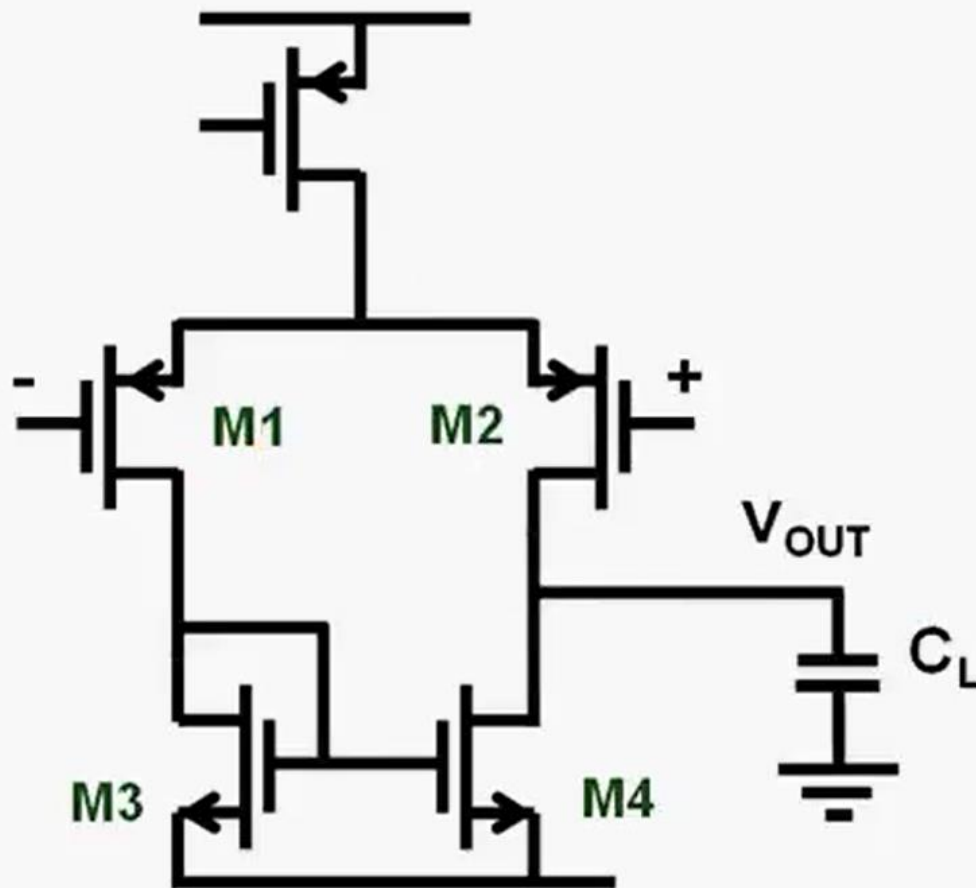
$A_{VT} \approx 10 \text{ mV}\mu\text{m}$
in $0.5 \mu\text{m}$ CMOS
 $\sigma(\Delta V_T) \approx 3.2 \text{ mV}$
for $W = 10$ & $L = 1 \mu\text{m}$

Speed, Noise and Power



Comparison of few fundamental AMP Configurations

Speed and f_T for simple Diff-amp



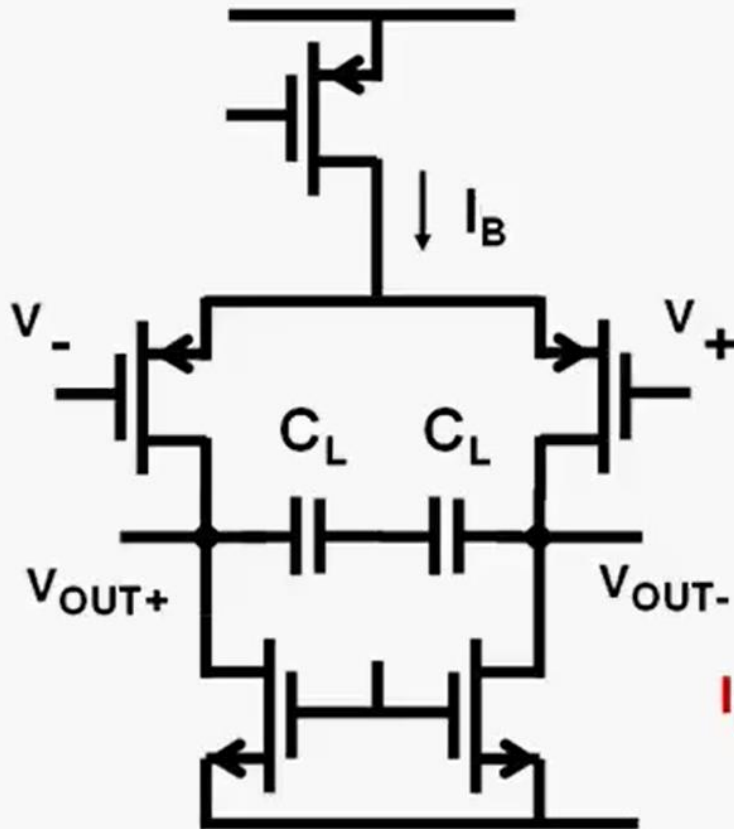
$$GBW = \frac{g_{m1}}{2\pi C_L}$$

$$GBW_{\max} \approx \frac{f_{nd}}{2}$$

$$f_{nd} = \frac{g_{m3}}{4\pi C_{GS3}} \approx \frac{f_{T3}}{4}$$

$$GBW_{\max} \approx \frac{f_{T3}}{8}$$

Maximum GBW and FOM



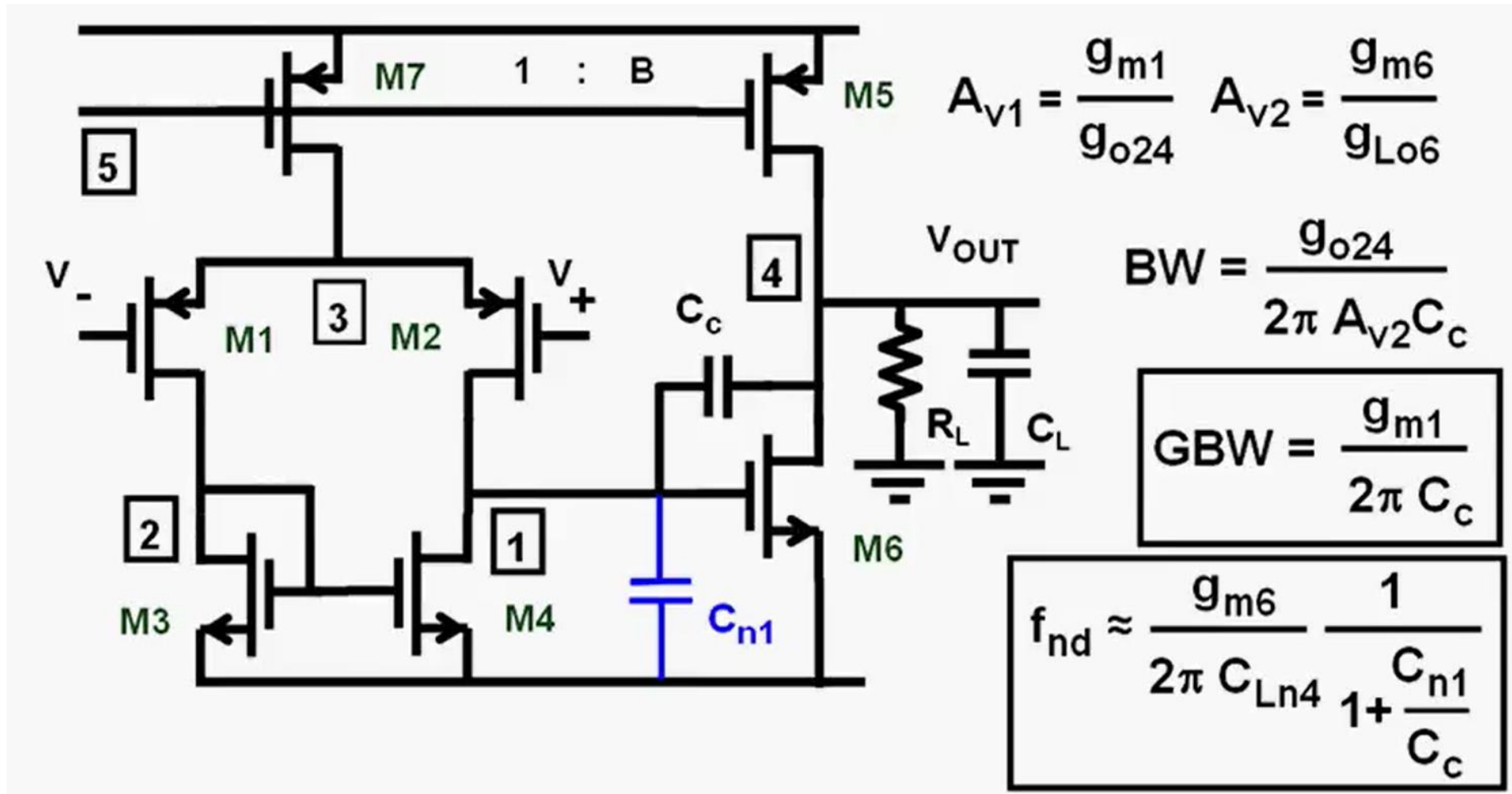
$$GBW = \frac{g_{m1}}{2\pi C_L} \quad g_{m1} = \frac{I_B}{V_{GS1} - V_T}$$

$$GBW_{max} = \frac{I_B}{V_{GS1} - V_T} \frac{1}{2\pi C_L}$$

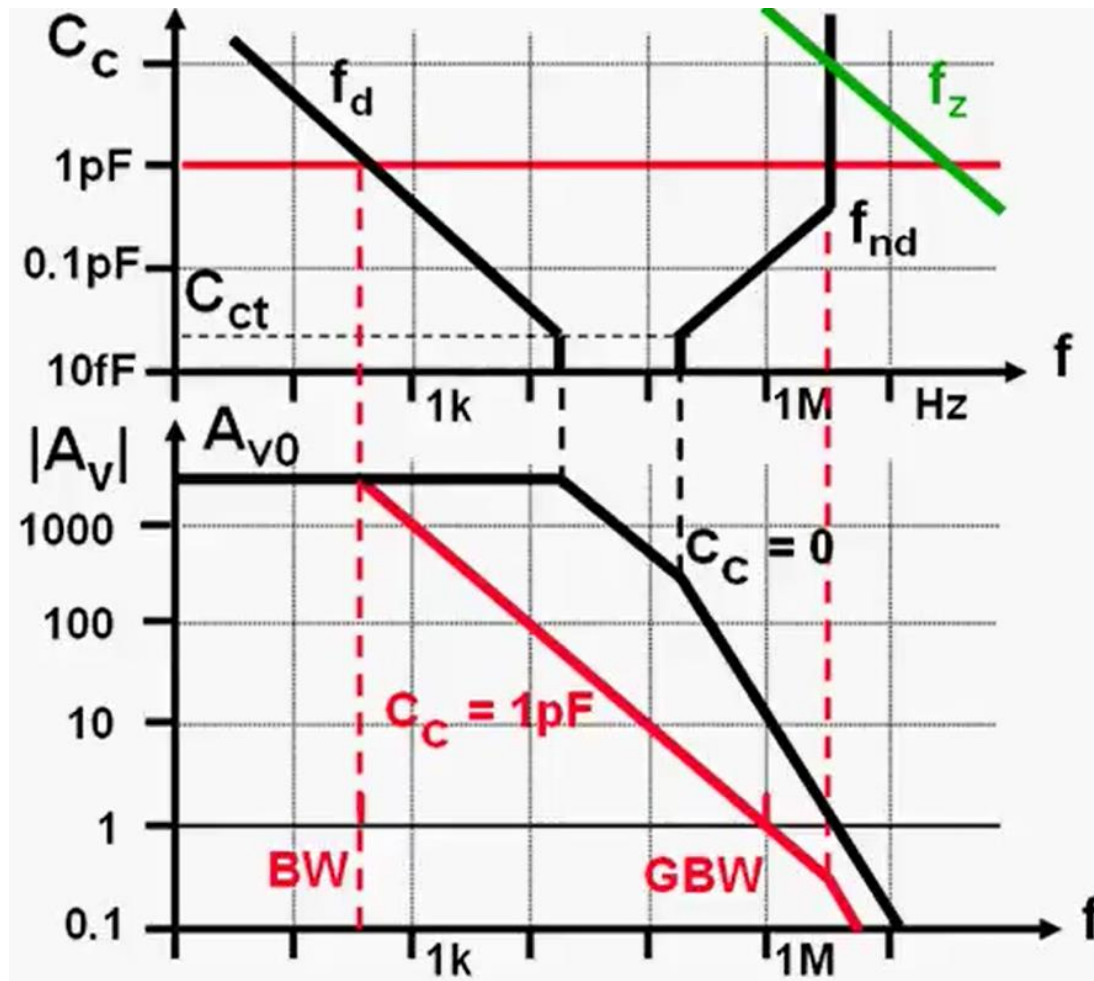
$$I_B = 10 \mu A \quad C_L = 1 \text{ pF} \quad GBW_{max} \approx 10 \text{ MHz}$$

$$FOM = \frac{GBW \cdot C_L}{I_B} = 1000 \text{ MHzpF}/_{\mu A}$$

Two Stage AMP



Two Stage AMP



Pole splitting

is sufficient
for $C_c = 1\text{pF}$

$$f_z = \frac{g_{m6}}{2\pi C_c}$$

Two Stage AMP

$$GBW = \frac{g_{m1}}{2\pi C_c}$$

$$f_{nd} = \frac{g_{m6}}{2\pi C_L} \frac{1}{1 + C_{n1}/C_c}$$

$$C_L = \alpha C_c \quad \alpha \approx 2$$

$$C_c = \beta C_{n1} = \beta C_{GS6} \quad \beta \approx 3$$

$$f_{nd} = \gamma GBW \quad \gamma \approx 2$$

$$C_{GS} = kW \quad k = 2 \cdot 10^{-11} \text{ F/cm}$$

$$GBW = \frac{f_{nd}}{\gamma} = \frac{g_{m6}}{2\pi C_L} \frac{1}{\gamma (1 + 1/\beta)} = \frac{f_{T6}}{\alpha\beta\gamma (1 + 1/\beta)}$$

$$C_L = \alpha C_c = \alpha \beta C_{n1} = \alpha \beta C_{GS6} = \alpha \beta kW_6$$

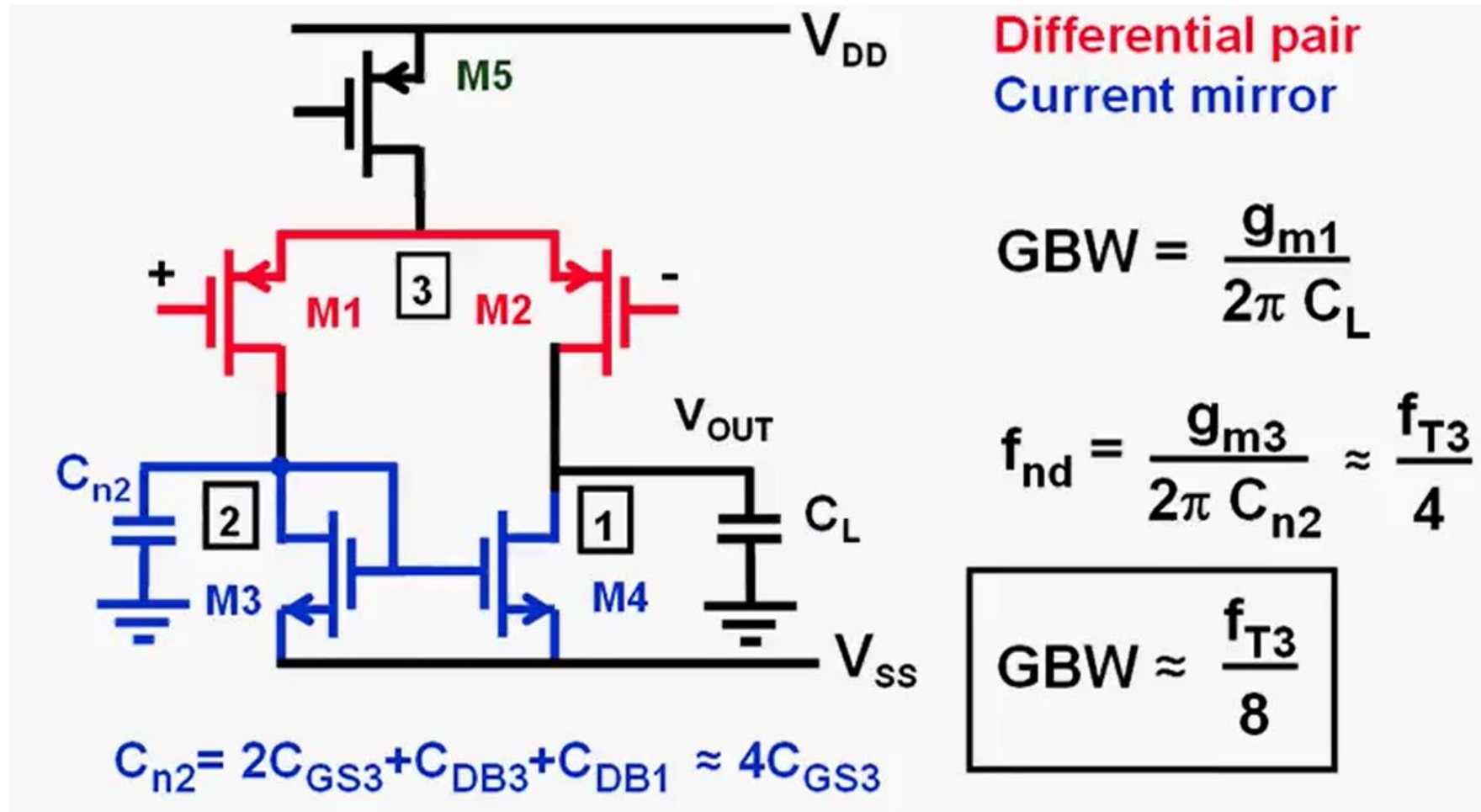
$W_6 \uparrow$ if $C_L \uparrow$

FOM of Two Stage AMP

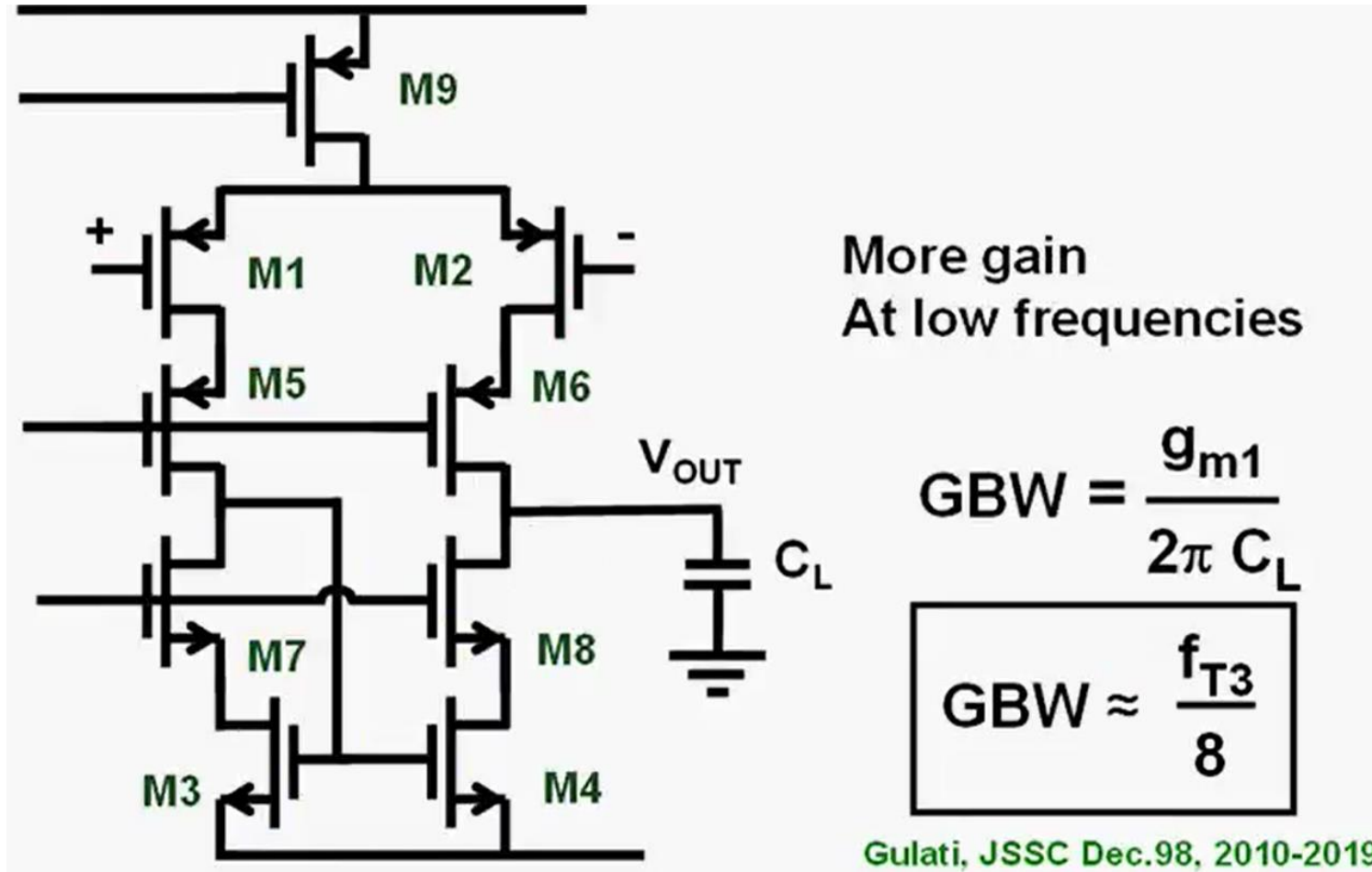
$$GBW_{\max} \approx \frac{f_{T6}}{16}$$

$$FOM = \frac{GBW.C_L}{B I_B} = \frac{1000}{1.5 * 2} \text{ MHzpF/mA}$$

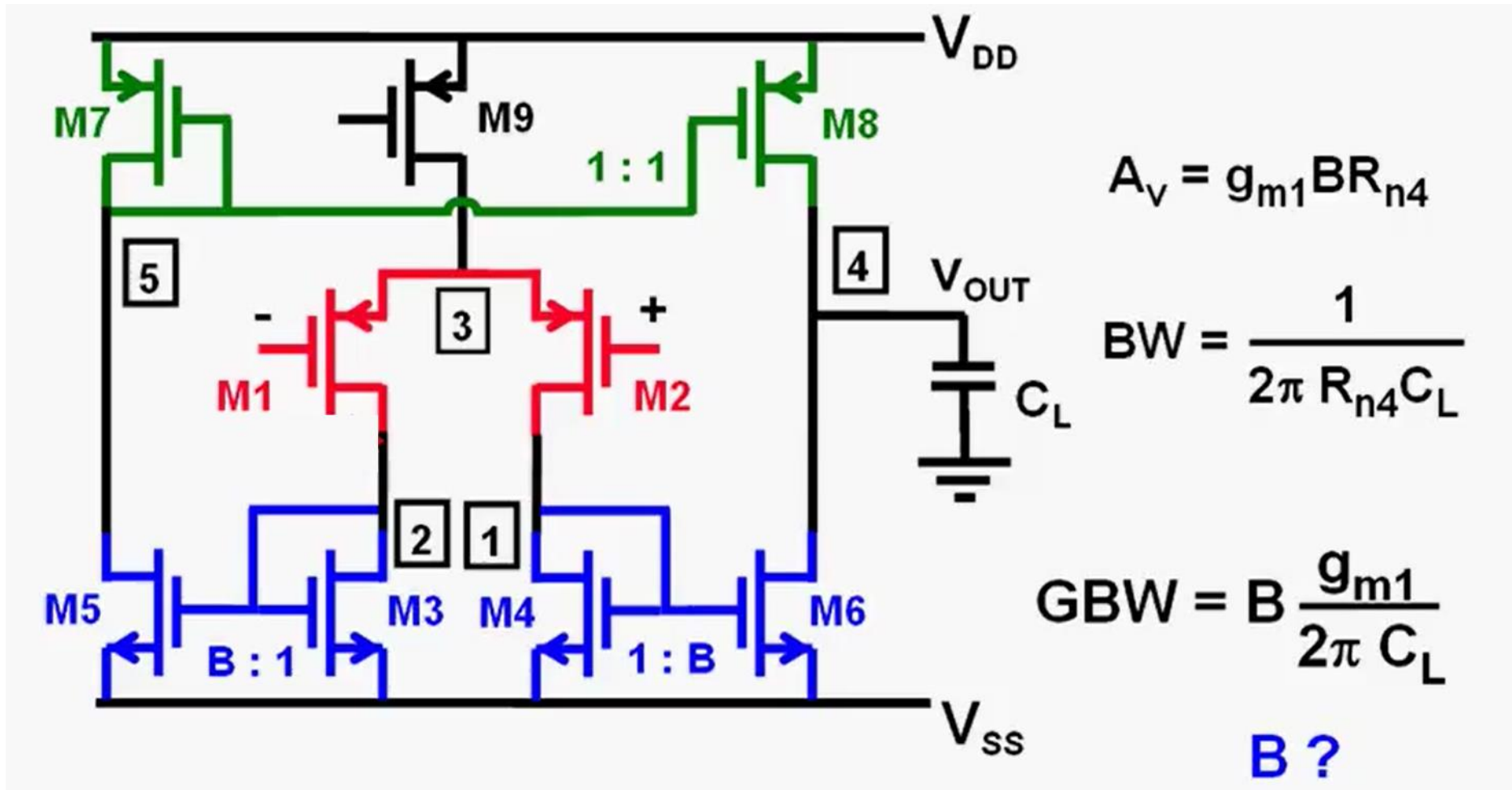
FOM of Single Stage AMP



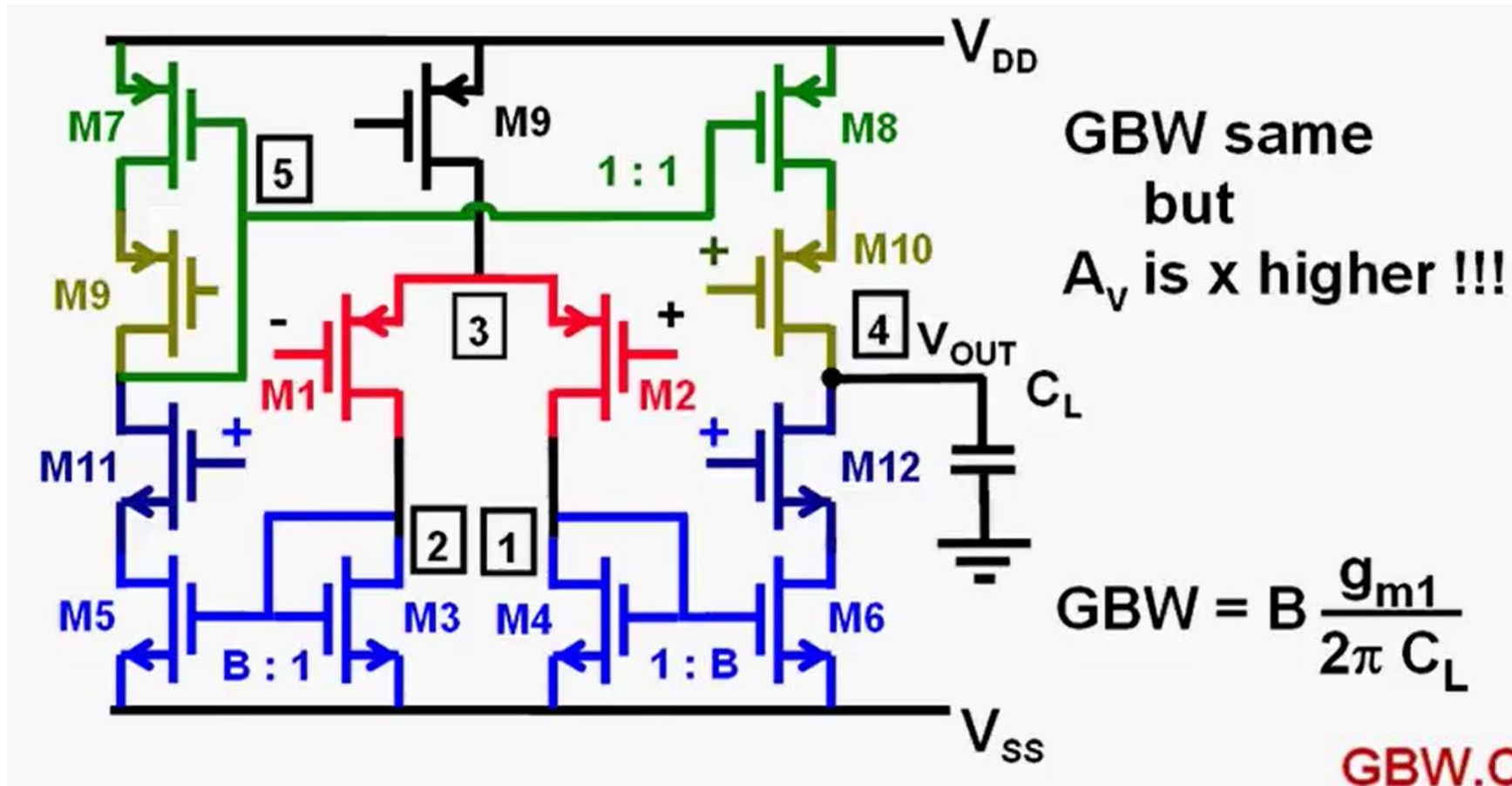
FOM of Telescopic AMP



Symmetric AMP

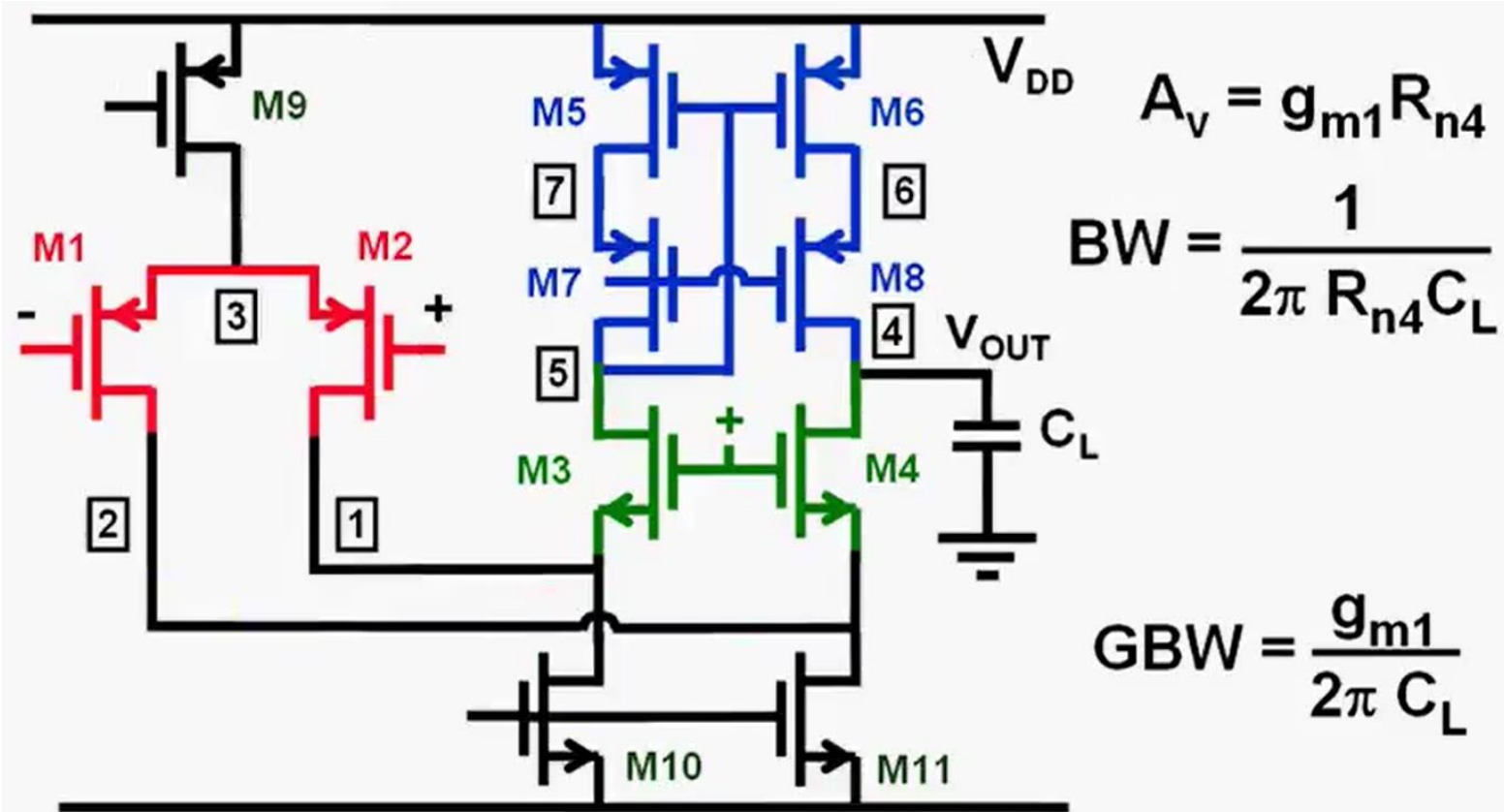


FOM of Symmetric AMP



$$FOM = \frac{GBW \cdot C_L}{B I_B} = \frac{1000}{3 * 2 \text{ MHzpF/mA}}$$

FOM of FC



$$FOM = \frac{GBW \cdot C_L}{B I_B} = \frac{1000}{2 \text{ MHzpF}/\mu\text{A}}$$

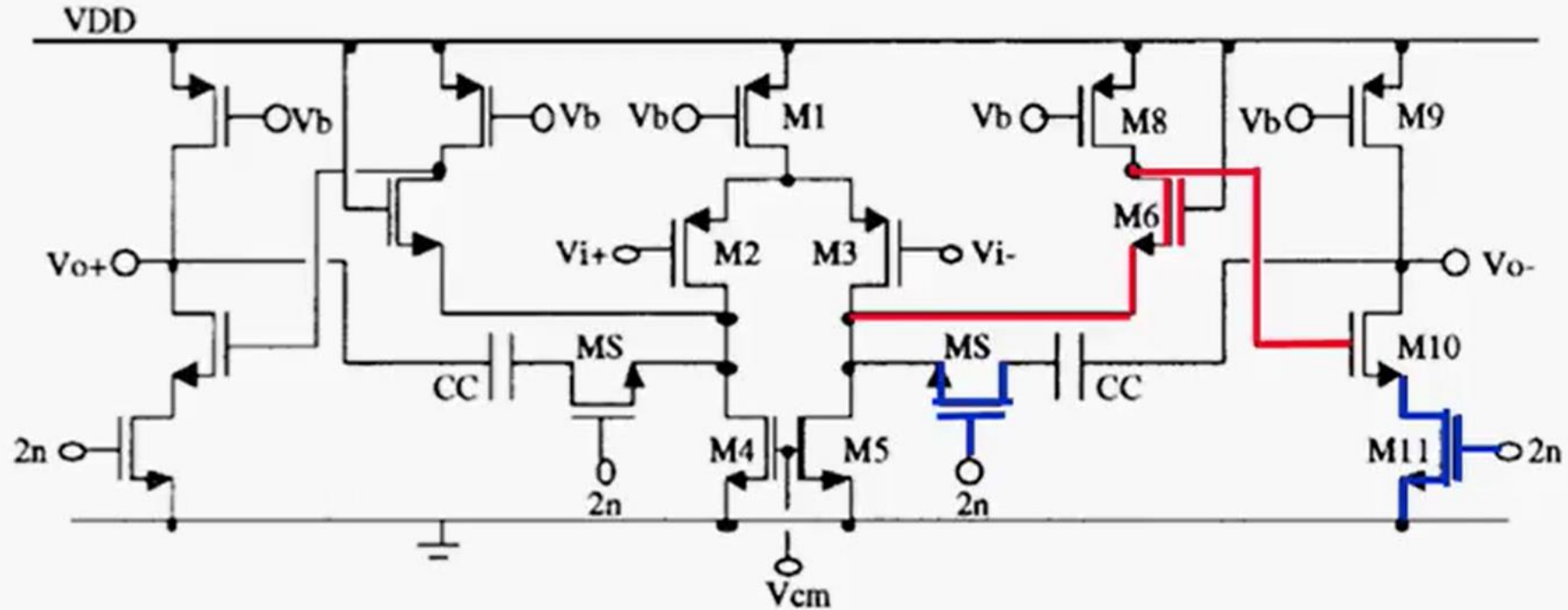
Comparison

	I_{TOT} mA	$\frac{dv_{in,eq}^2}{\frac{8/3 kT}{g_{m1}} df}$	Speed <u>FOM</u>	Swing
Telescopic casc.	0.25	4	1	small
Symmetrical (B= 3)	0.33	16	6	avg.
Folded cascode	0.5	4	2	avg.
Miller 2-stage*	1.1	4	3	max.

* $C_L/C_c = 2.5$

Sub 1V Configurations

JSSC'97

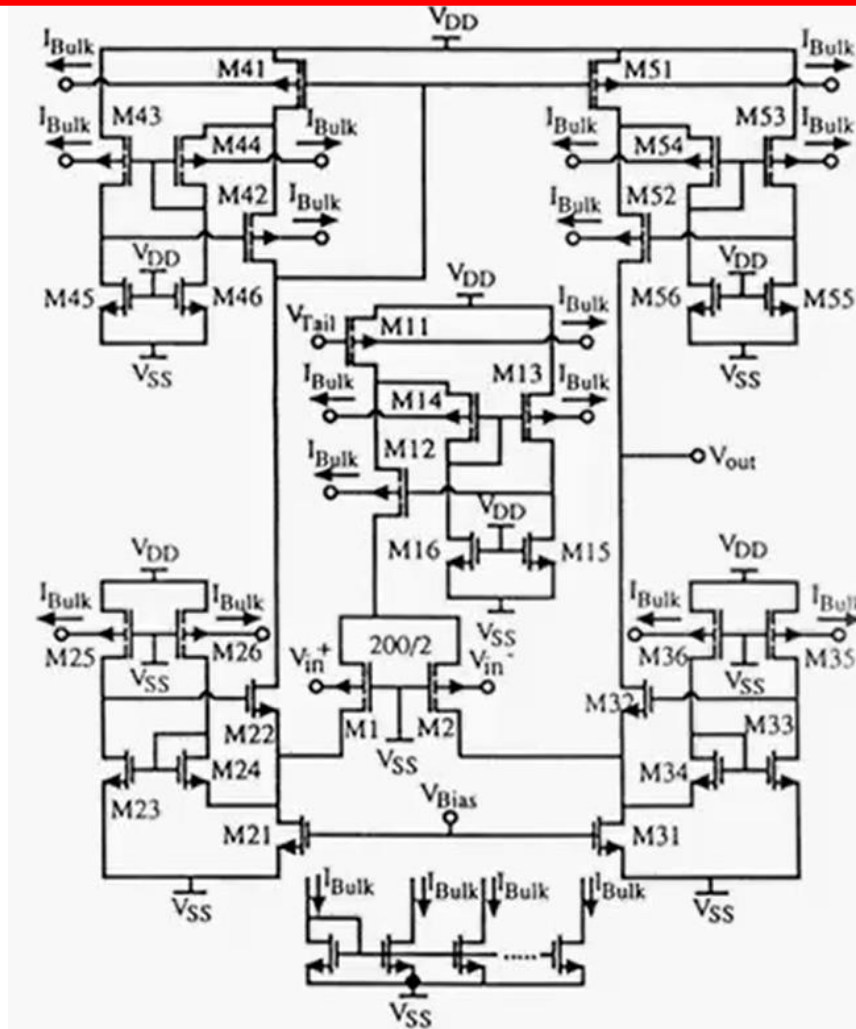


1 V 80 μ W (min: $V_T + 2V_{DSsat}$)
 Fully differential
 75 dB 30 MHz

4 Switches 2n :
 Only 2nd stage switched off !

Baschirotto, .. JSSC Dec.97, pp.1979-1986

ISSCC'95



$V_T \approx 0.7 \text{ V}$ (n-well CMOS)

Bulk input :

At 0.4 V only 0.1 pA

$$\frac{g_{mB}}{g_m} = n - 1 = \frac{C_D}{C_{ox}}$$

GBW = 0.6 MHz (15 pF)

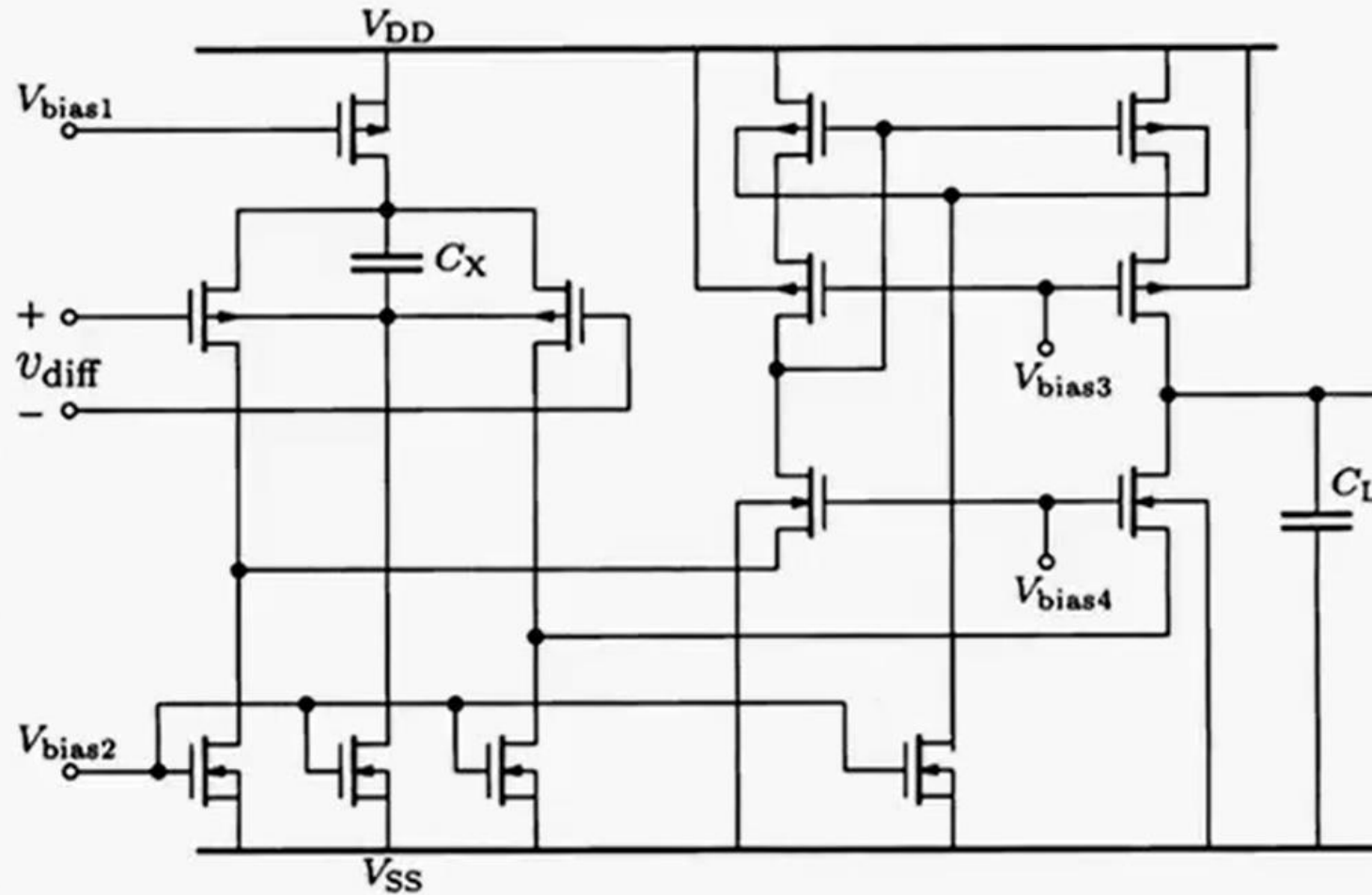
1 V 45 μ A

In & Output range:

0.2 ... 0.88 V

Allen, .. ISSCC Febr.95, 192-193

JSSC'00



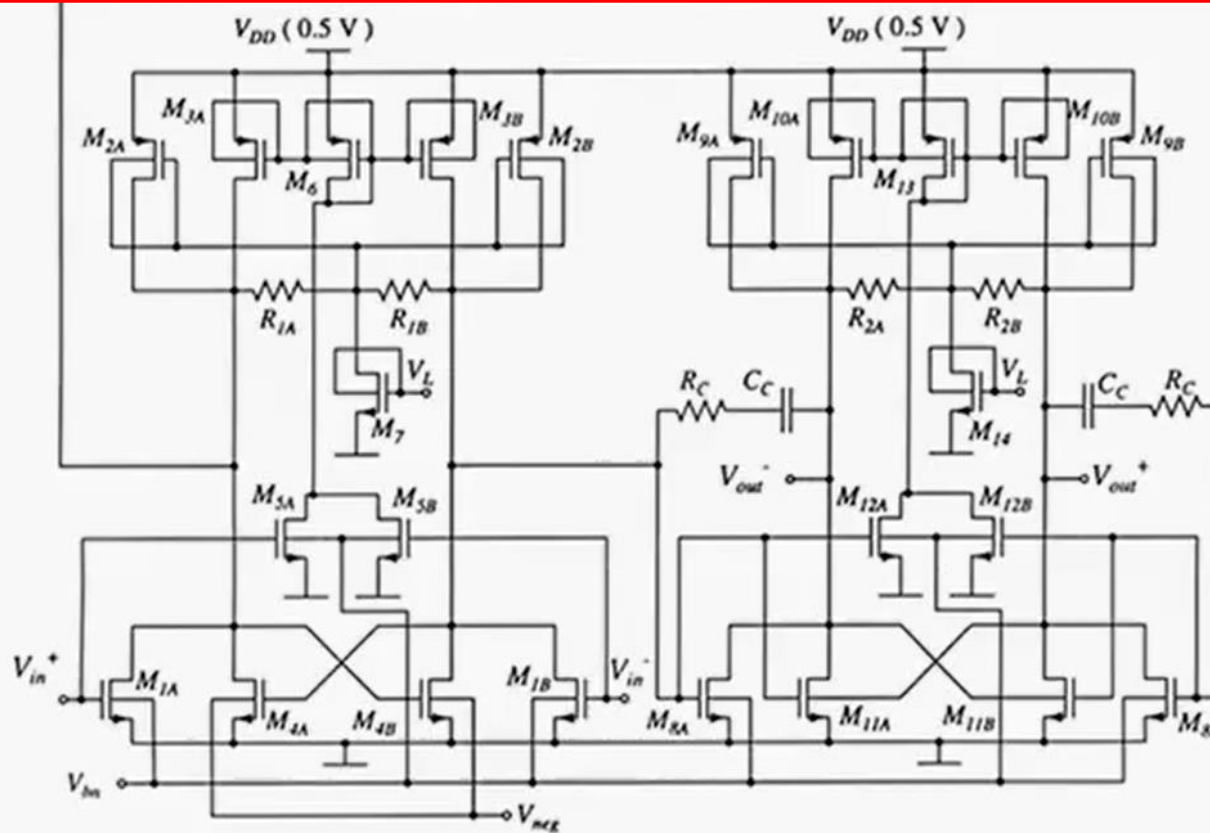
V_T reduced
from 0.6 V
to 0.4 V
by bulk-bias !

$$V_{DD,SS} = 1 \text{ V}$$

$$V_{in, CM} = 0 - 0.65 \text{ V}$$

$$V_{out} = 0.1 - 0.9 \text{ V}$$

JSSC'05



$V_T \approx 0.5 \text{ V}$ (n-well
0.18 μm CMOS)

Pseudo-differential
Cross-coupling
for higher gain !

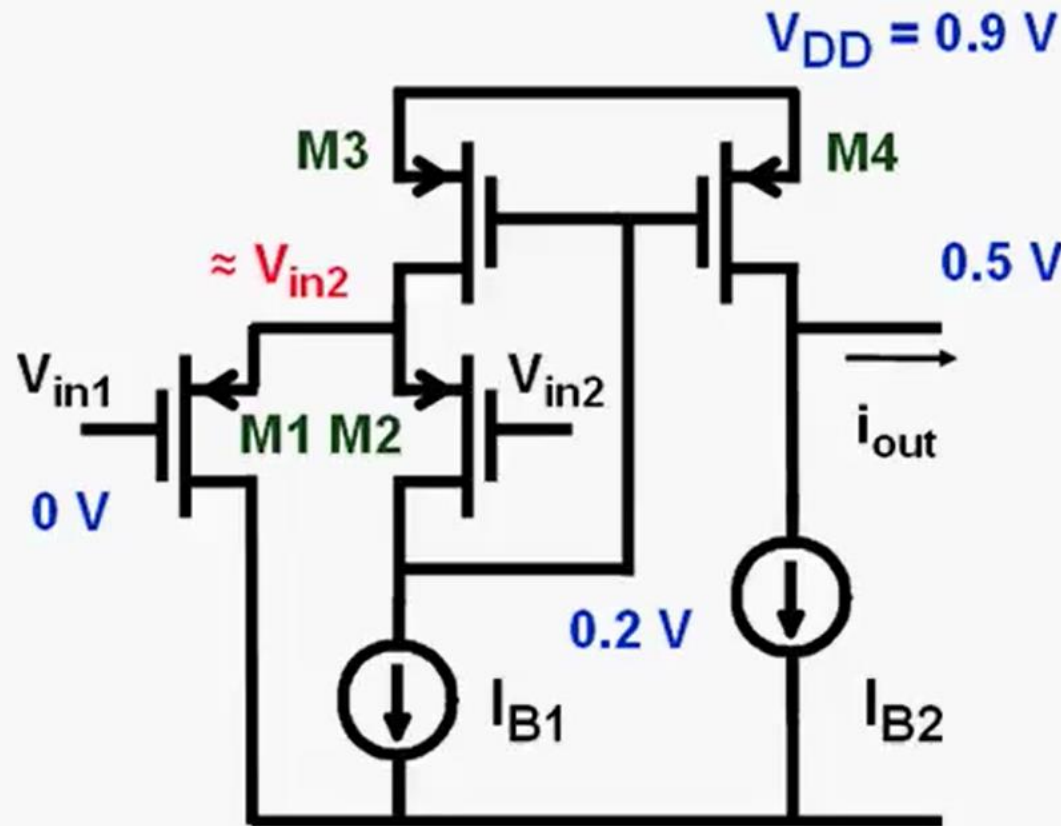
GBW = 15 MHz (10 pF)
0.5 V 0.4 mA

$V_{in, DC} = V_{GS1} = V_{GS8} \approx 0.4 \text{ V}$
 $V_{DS7} \approx 0.1 \text{ V}$

V_{bn} sets $V_{outDC} \approx 0.25 \text{ V}$
 V_{neg} sets gain

Chatterjee, JSSC
Dec.05, 2373-2387

JSSC '98



M2 is source follower

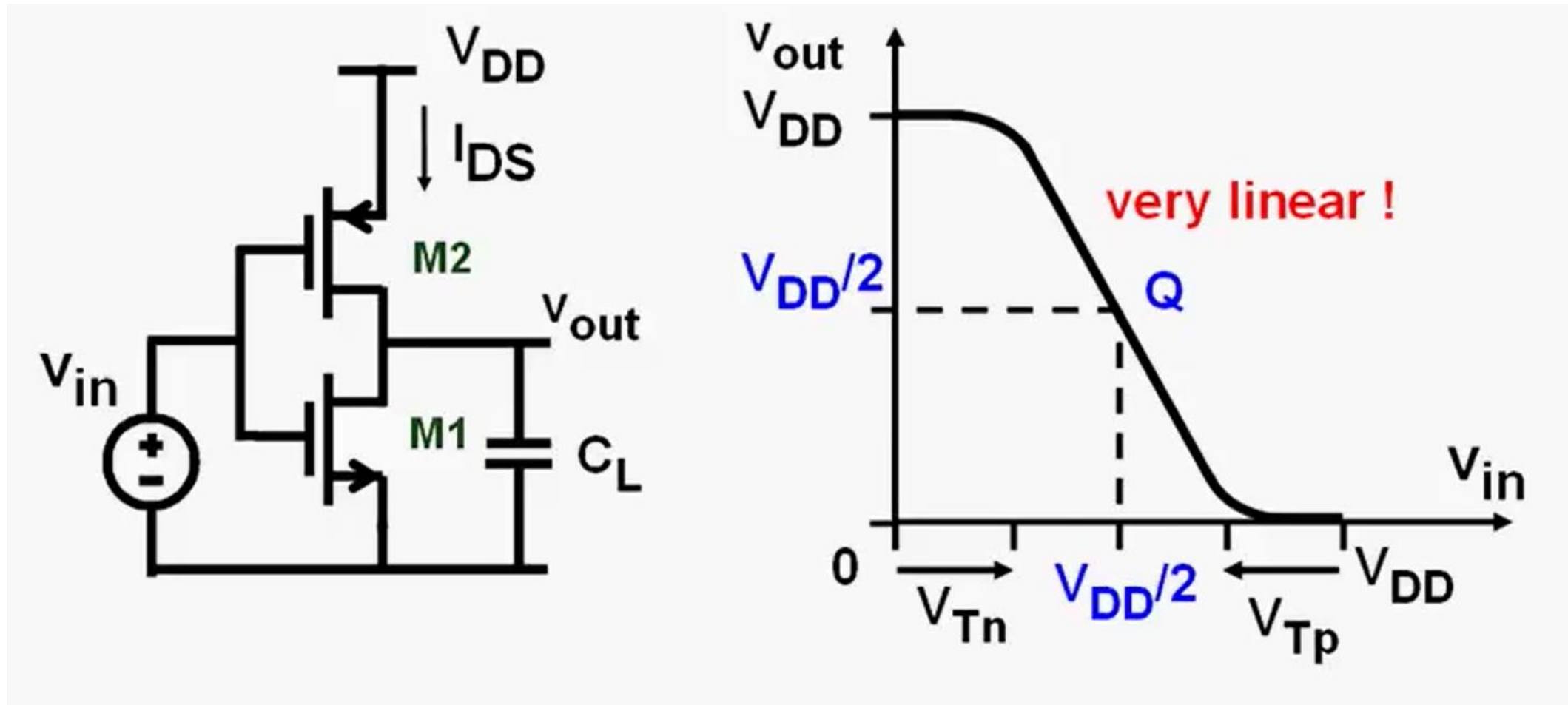
$$V_{GS1} = V_{in1} - V_{in2}$$

$$i_{out} \sim (V_{in1} - V_{in2})^2$$

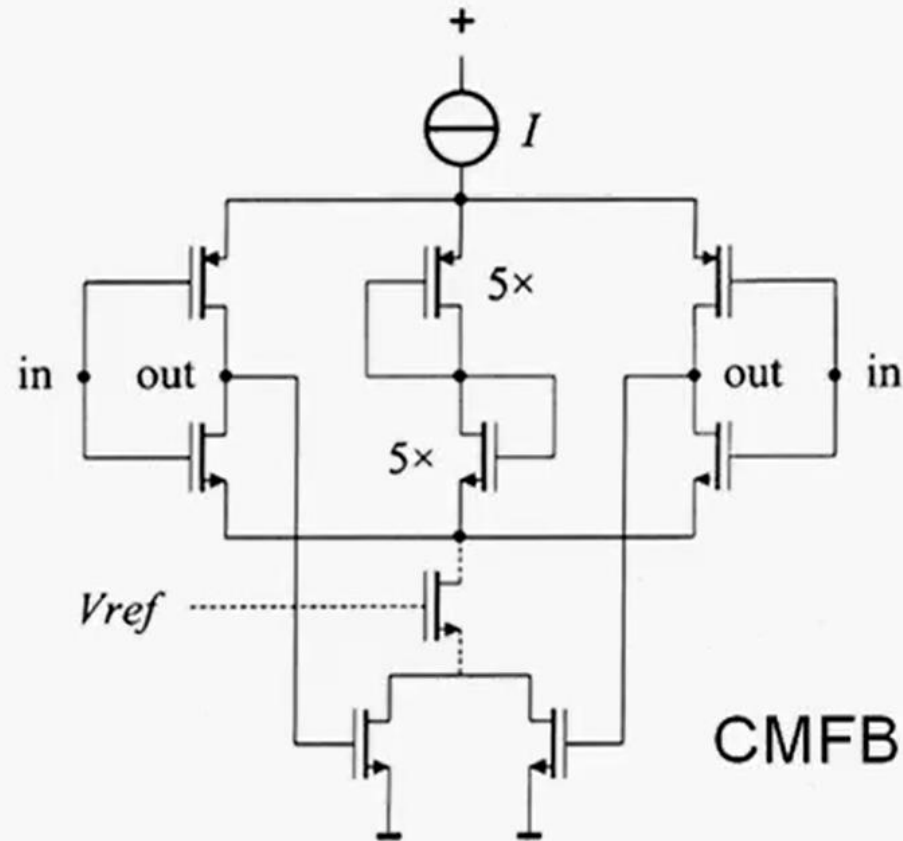
>>> Class AB

Peluso, ..., JSSC Dec.98, pp.1887-1896

Inverter for Analog



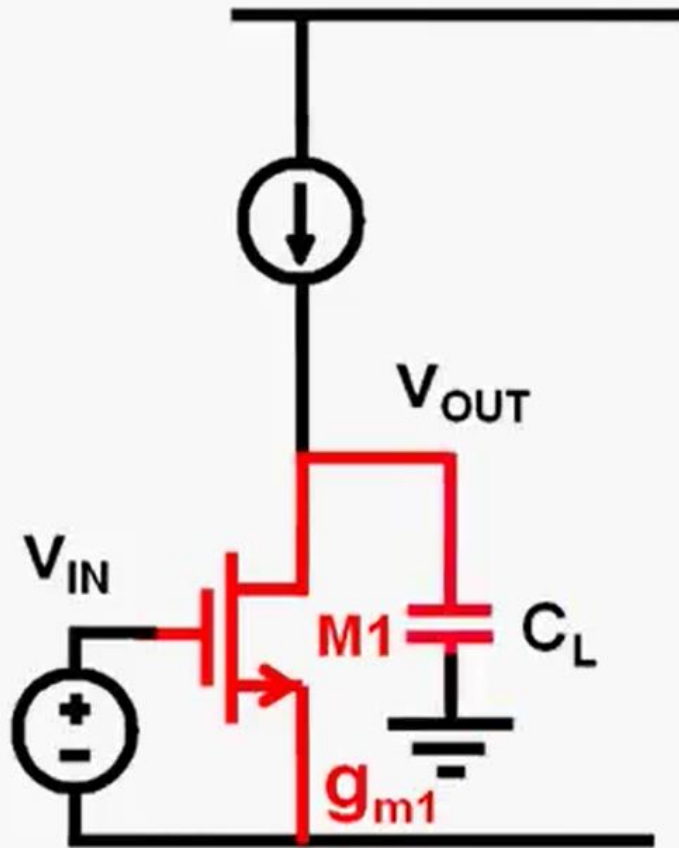
Inverter for Analog : JSSC'00



Ref. Voorman, JSSC, Aug.2000, 1097-1108

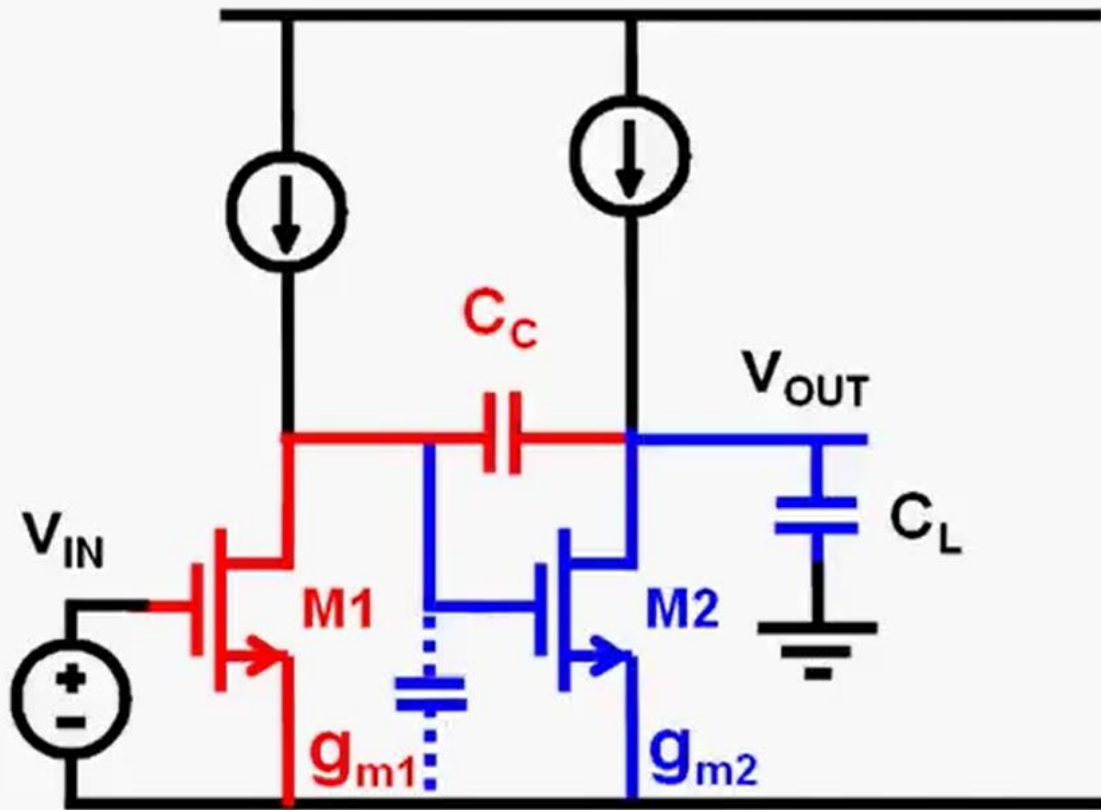
Multistage Amplifiers

Multistage Amplifier



$$GBW = \frac{g_{m1}}{2\pi C_L}$$

Multistage Amplifier

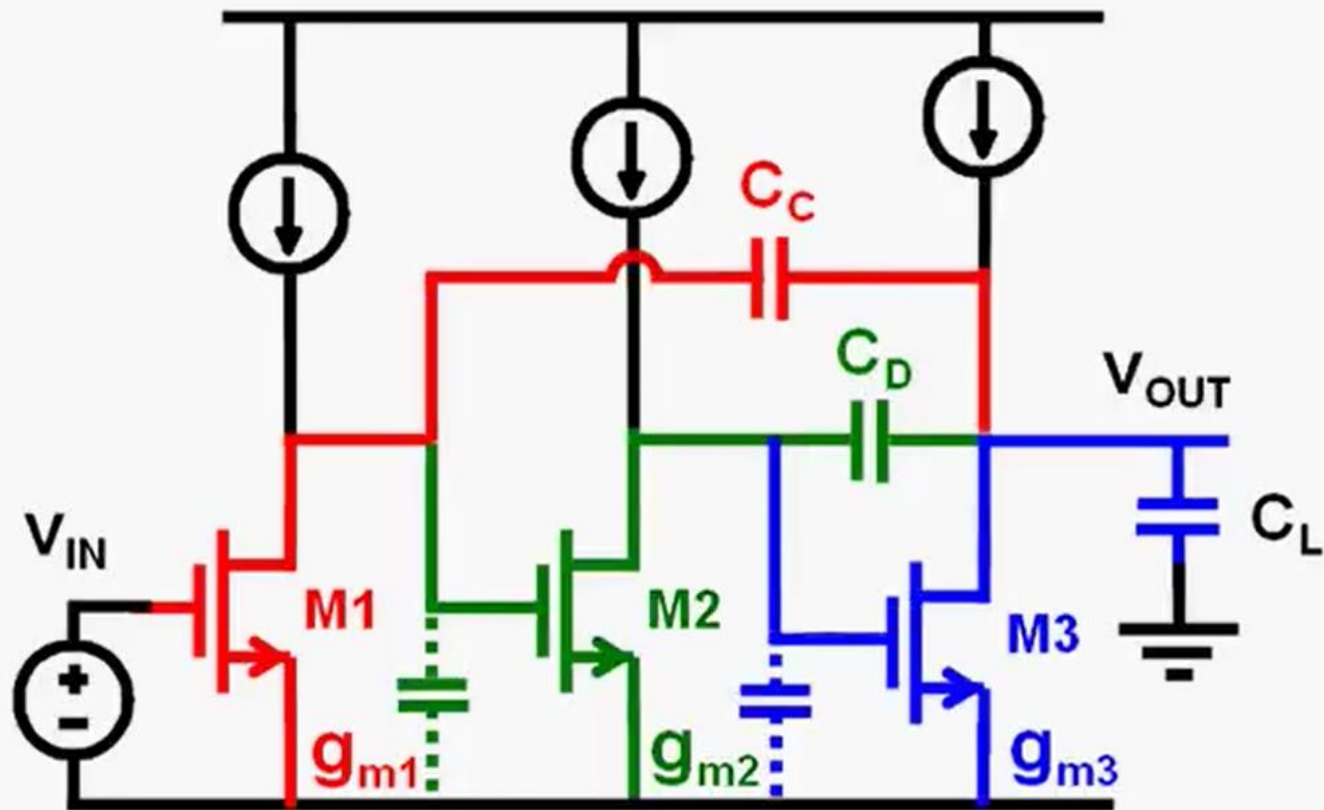


$$GBW = \frac{g_{m1}}{2\pi C_C}$$

$$f_{nd1} = \frac{g_{m2}}{2\pi C_L}$$

$$f_{nd1} = 3 GBW$$

Multistage Amplifier (NMC)



$$GBW = \frac{g_{m1}}{2\pi C_C}$$

$$f_{nd1} = \frac{g_{m2}}{2\pi C_D}$$

$$f_{nd2} = \frac{g_{m3}}{2\pi C_L}$$

$$f_{nd1} = 3 \text{ GBW}$$

$$f_{nd2} = 5 \text{ GBW}$$

Multistage Amplifier

GBW = 50 MHz for $C_L = 2$ pF

Find I_{DS1} ; I_{DS2} ; I_{DS3} ; C_C and C_D !

Choose $C_C = C_D = 1$ pF $> g_{m1} = 2\pi C_C \text{GBW} = 315 \mu\text{S}$

$$I_{DS1} = 31 \mu\text{A}$$

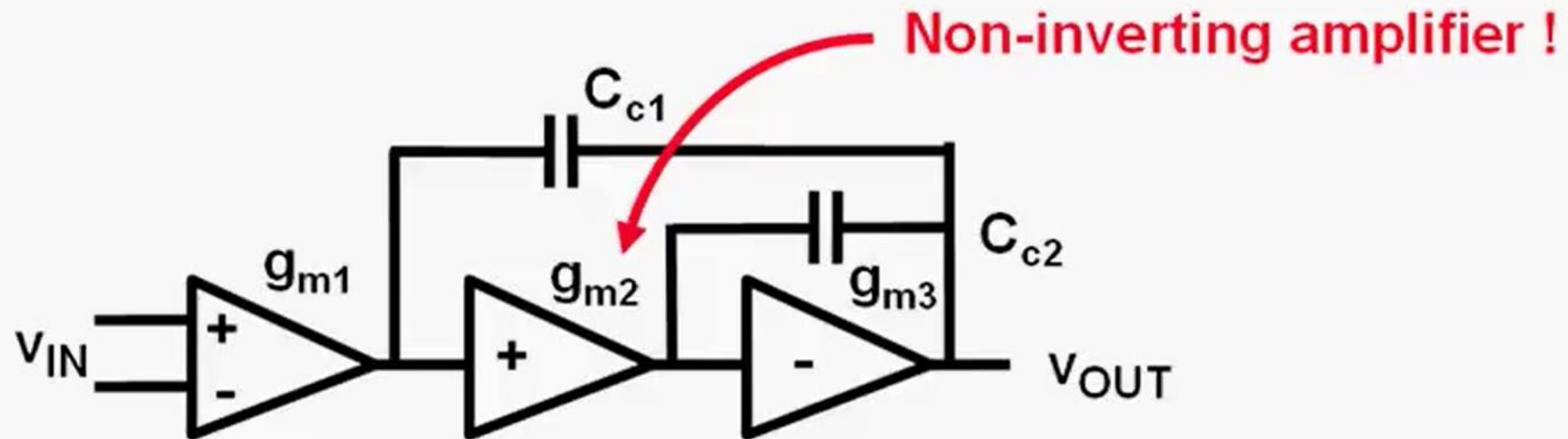
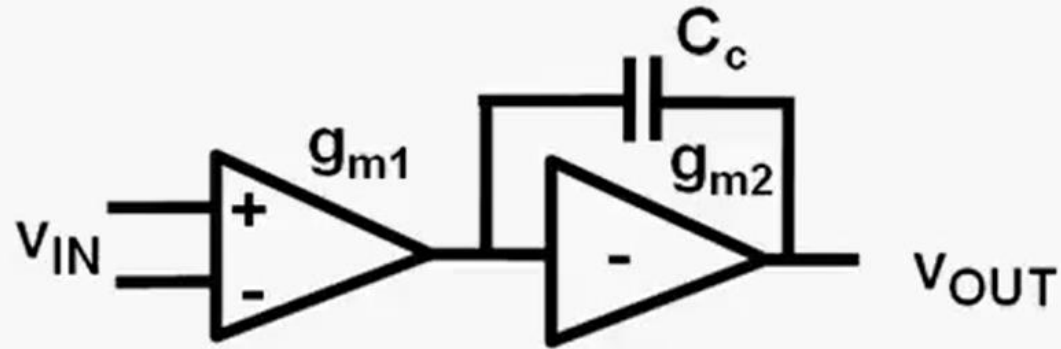
$f_{nd1} = 150$ MHz $> g_{m2} = 2\pi C_D 3\text{GBW} = 3g_{m1} = 945 \mu\text{S}$

$$I_{DS2} = 95 \mu\text{A}$$

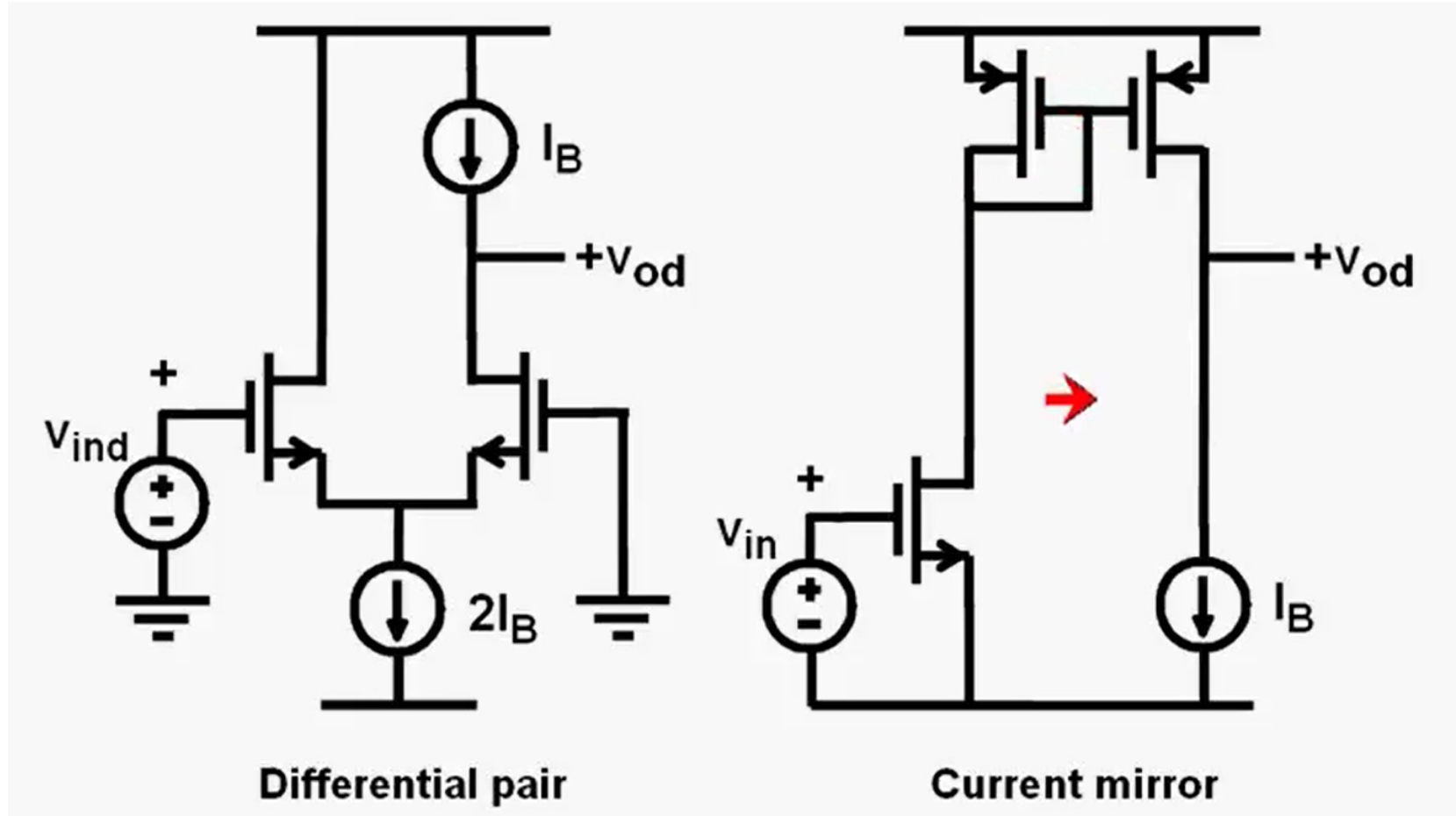
$f_{nd2} = 250$ MHz $> g_{m3} = 2\pi C_L 5\text{GBW} = 10g_{m1} = 3150 \mu\text{S}$

$$I_{DS3} = 315 \mu\text{A}$$

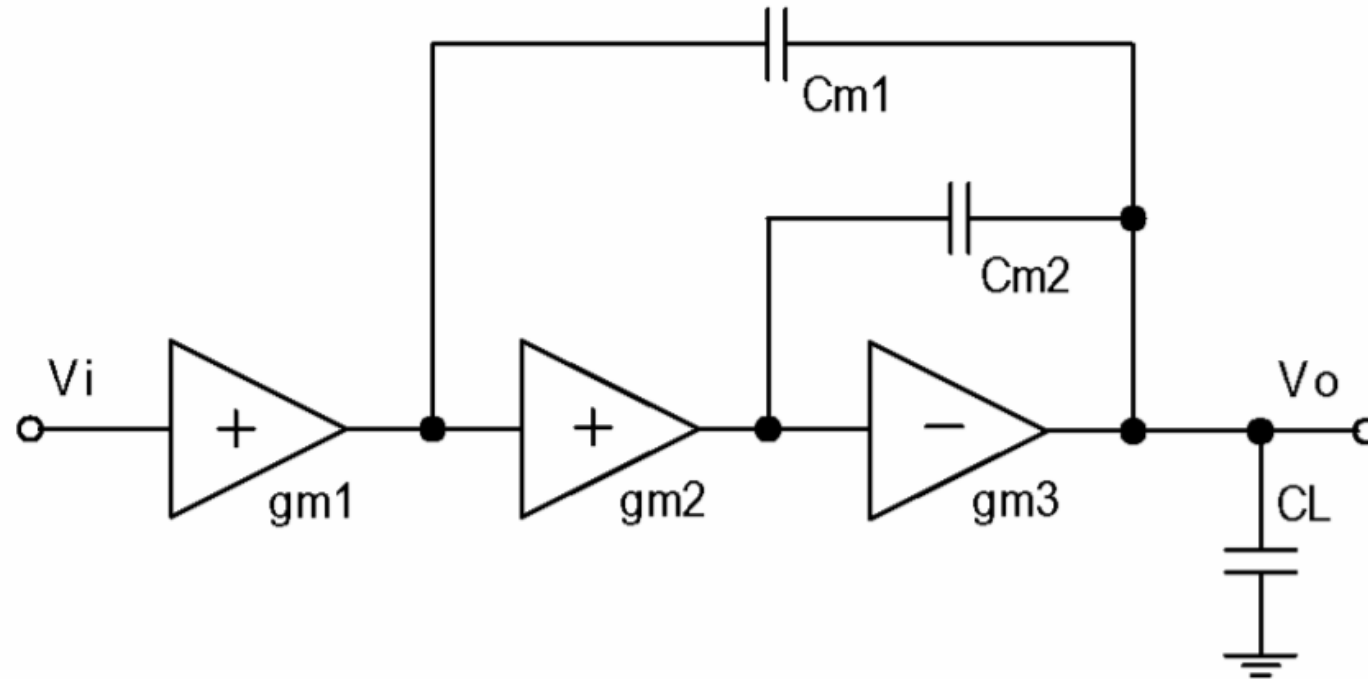
Multistage Amplifier



Multistage Amplifier : Non Inv AMP

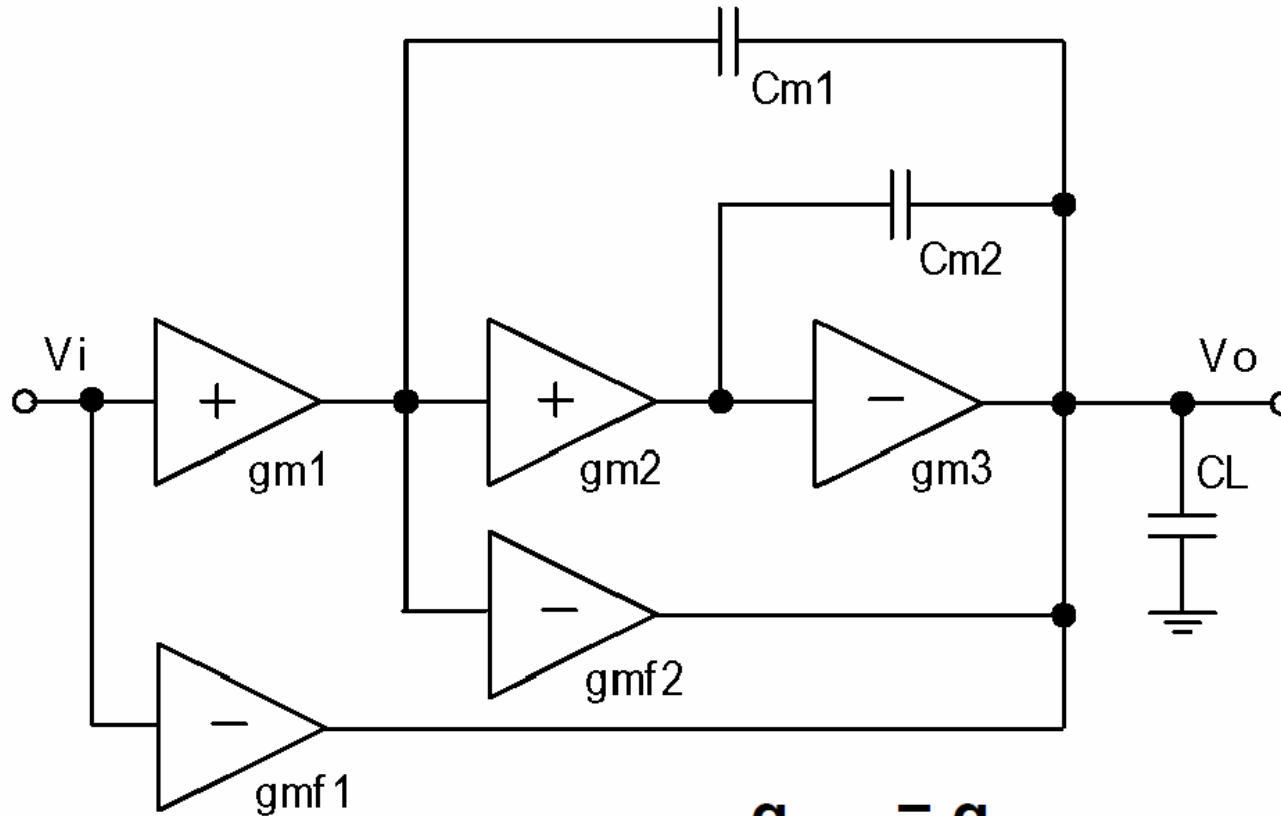


Multistage Amplifier : NMC



Huijsing, JSSC Dec.85, pp.1144-1150

Multistage Amplifier : NGCC



$$g_{mf1} = g_{m1}$$

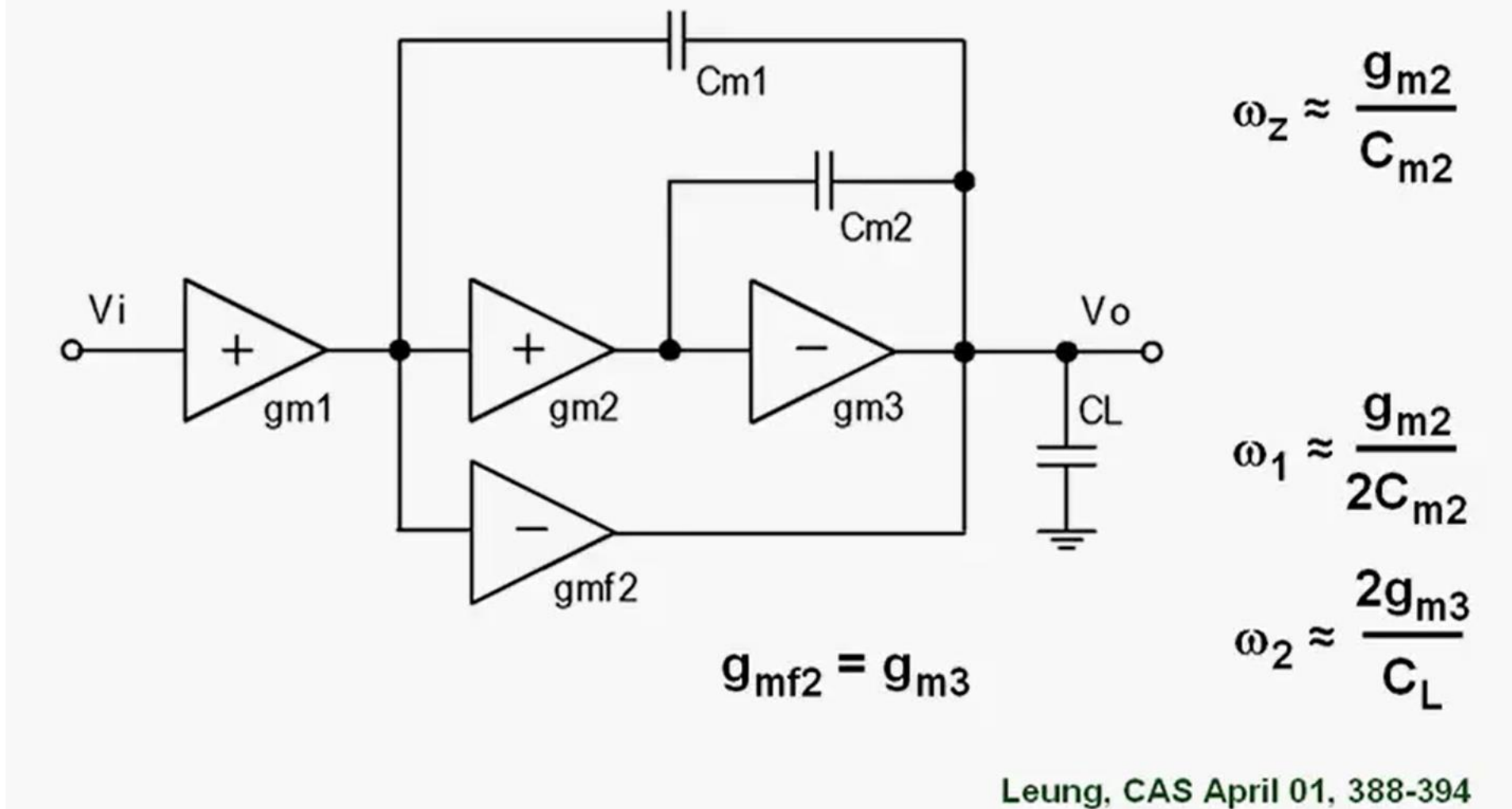
$$g_{mf2} = g_{m2}$$

$$\omega_1 \approx \frac{g_{m2}}{C_{m2}}$$

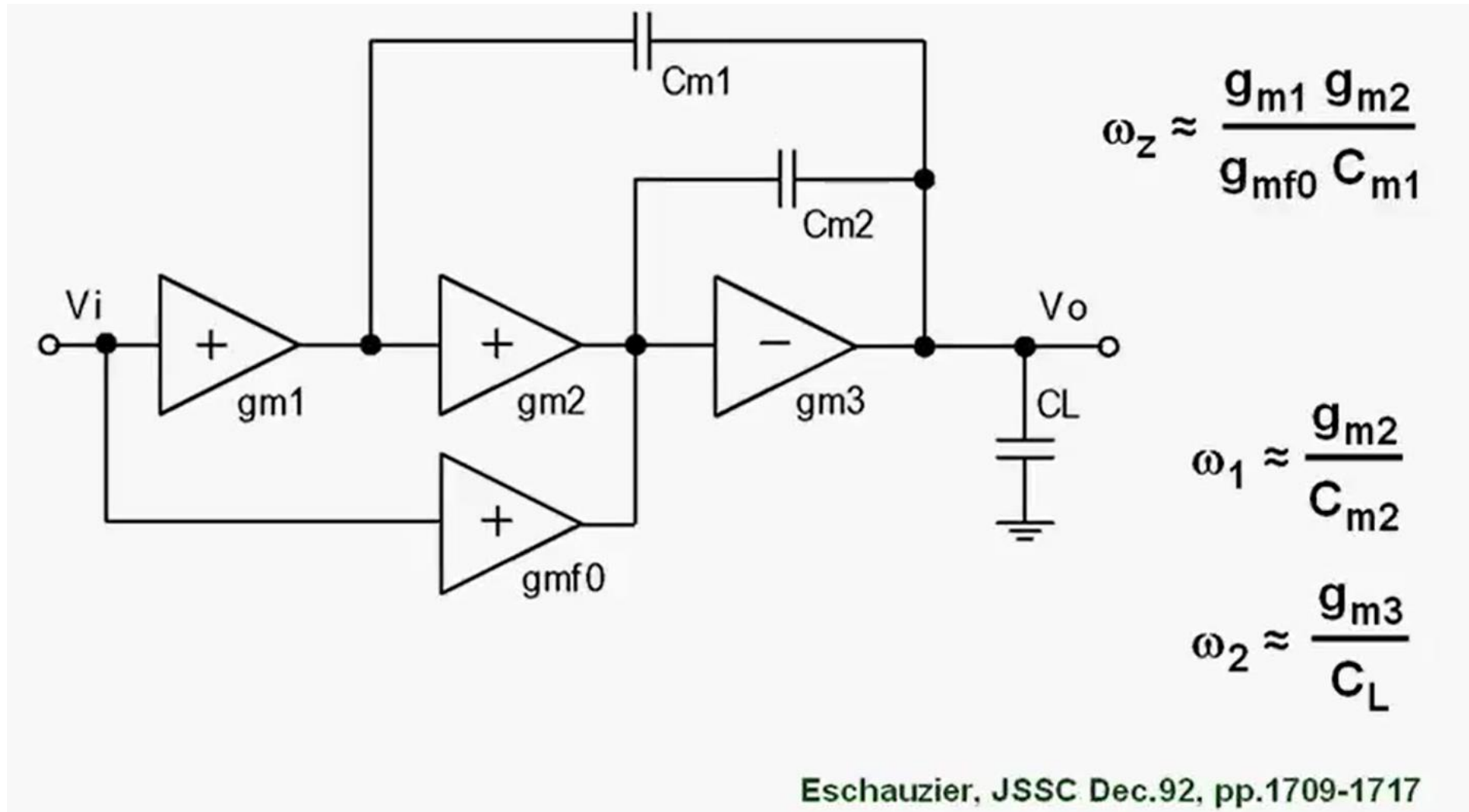
$$\omega_2 \approx \frac{g_{m3}}{C_L}$$

You, JSSC Dec.97, 2000-2011

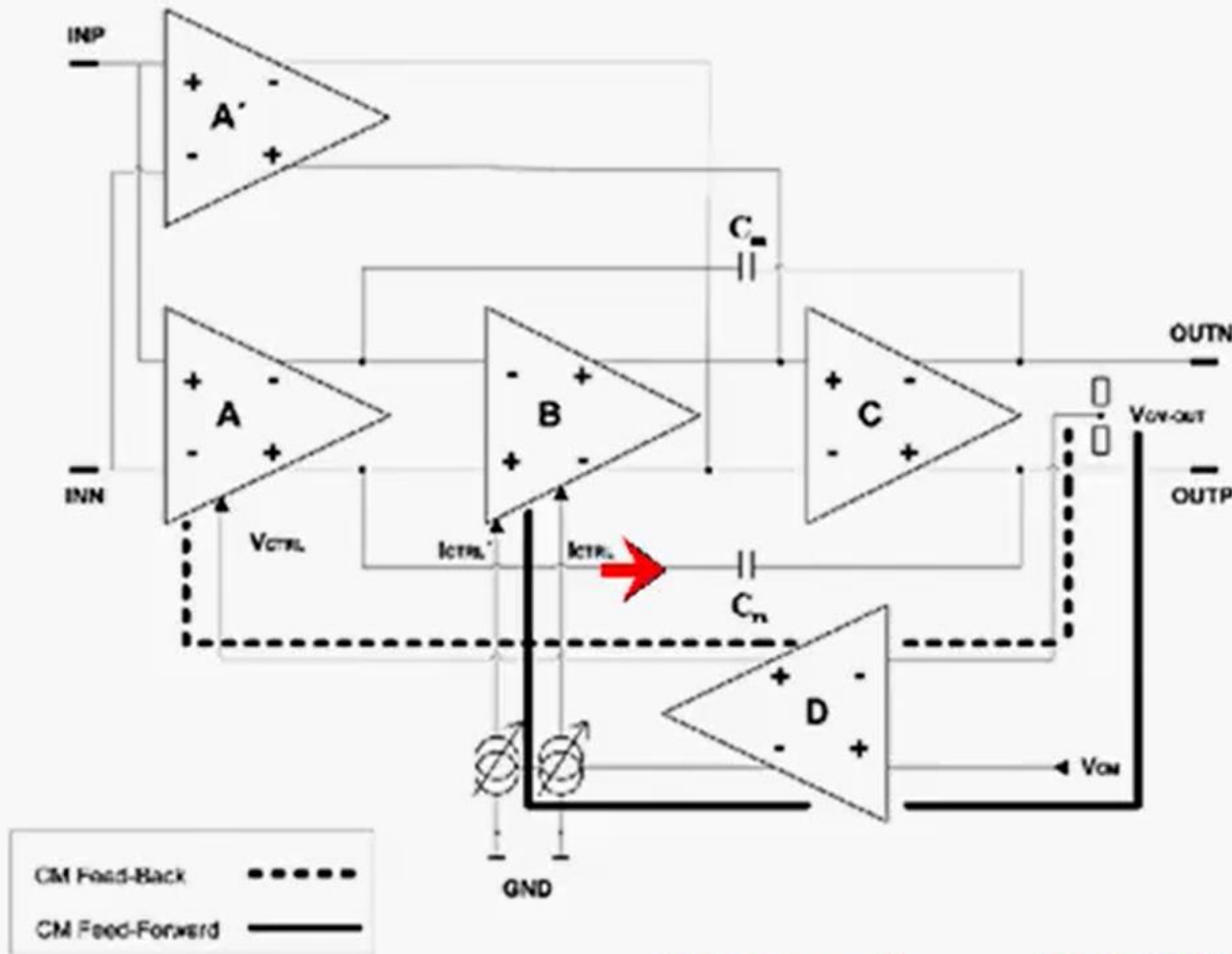
Multistage Amplifier : NMCF



Multistage Amplifier : MNMC

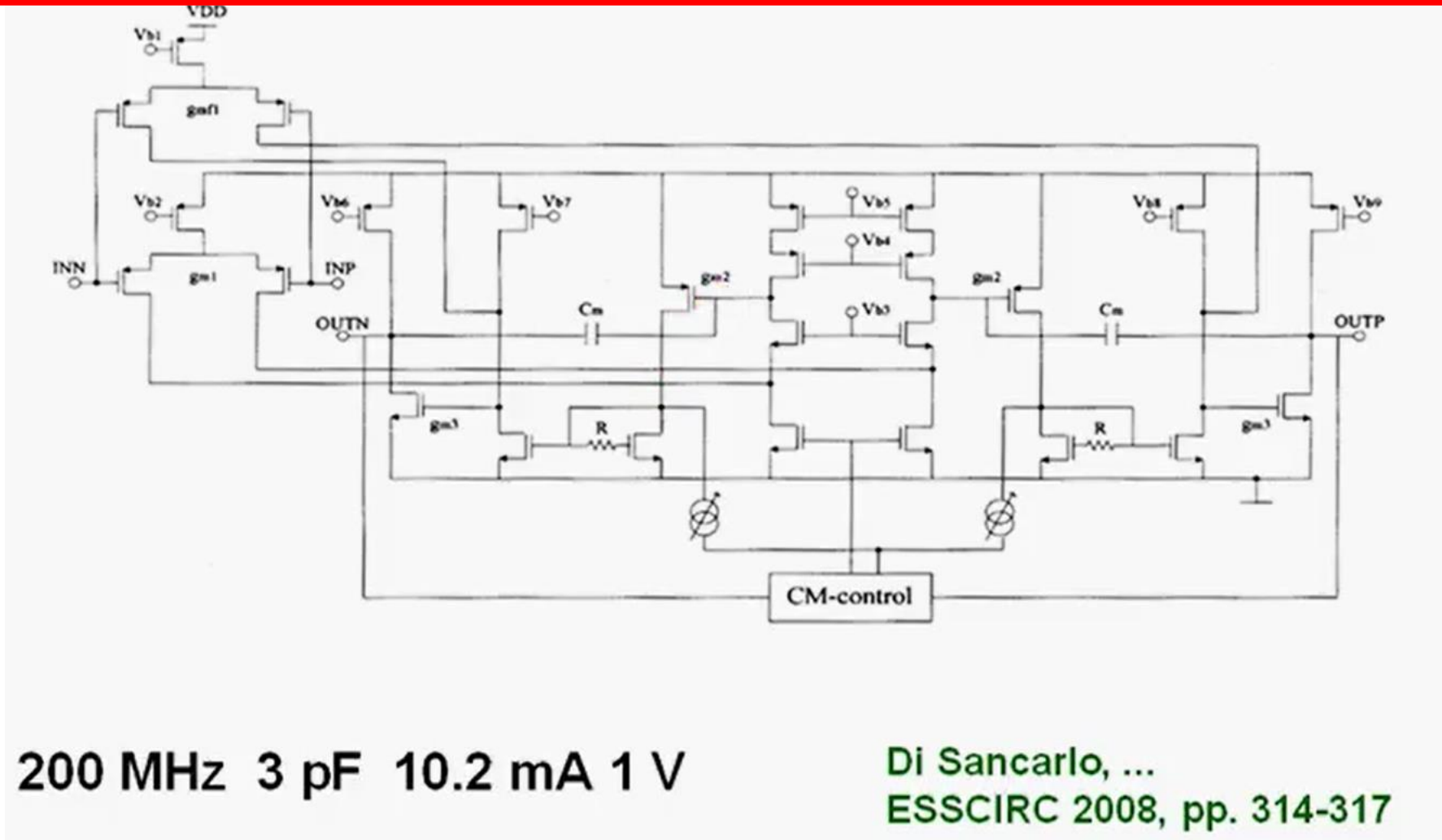


Multistage Amplifier : ESSCIRC' 08



Di Sancar, ... ESSCIRC 2008, pp. 314-317

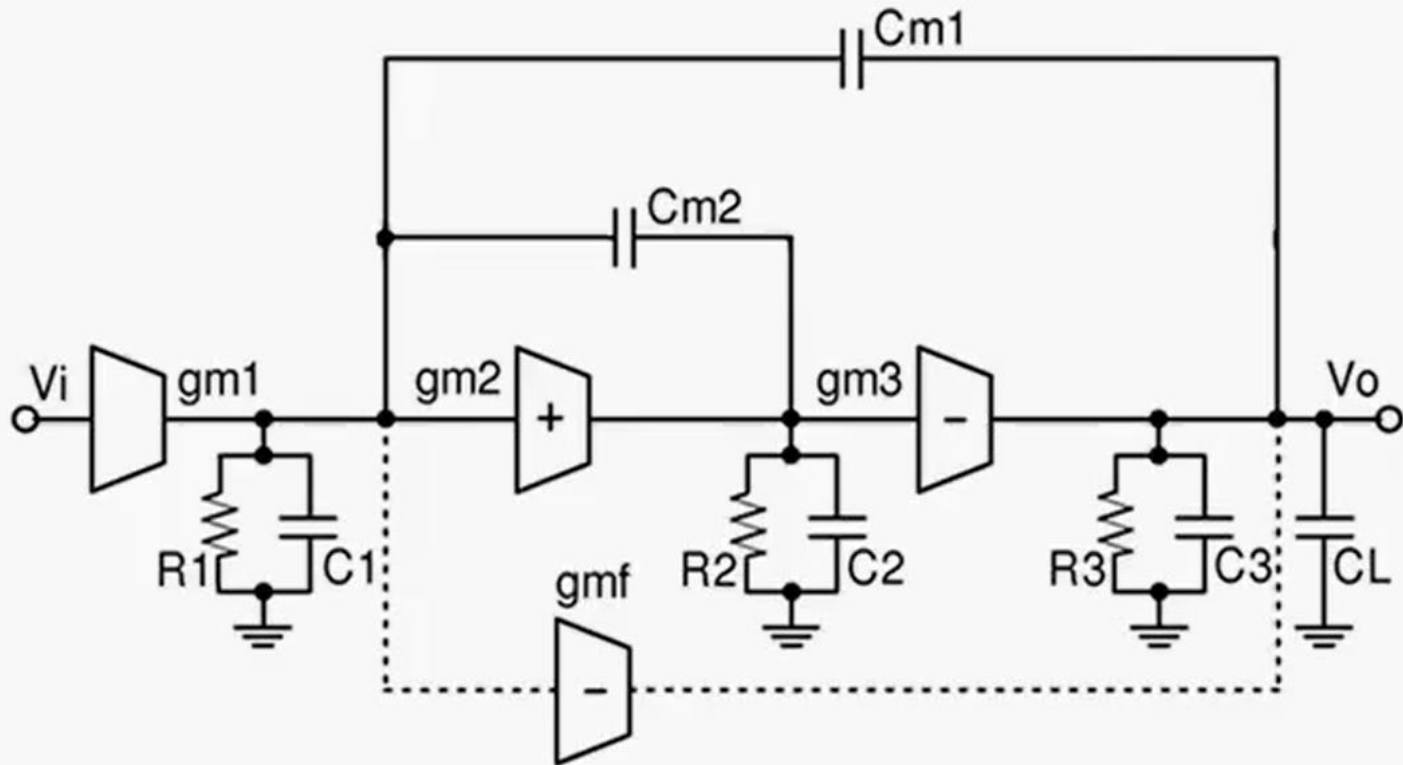
Multistage Amplifier : ESSCIRC' 08



Multistage Amplifier : Comparison

Topology	Stages	PM	GB=2 π GBW
Single	One	< 90°	(g_m/C_L)
SMC	Two	< 63°	0.5(g_{m2}/C_L)
NMC	Three	$\approx 60^\circ$	0.25(g_{m3}/C_L)
NGCC	Three	$\approx 60^\circ$	0.25(g_{m3}/C_L)
NMCF	Three	> 60°	< 0.5(g_{m3}/C_L)
MNMC	Three	$\approx 63^\circ$	$\approx 0.5(g_{m3}/C_L)$

CICC'02



$$GBW / GBW_{NMC} \approx 6$$

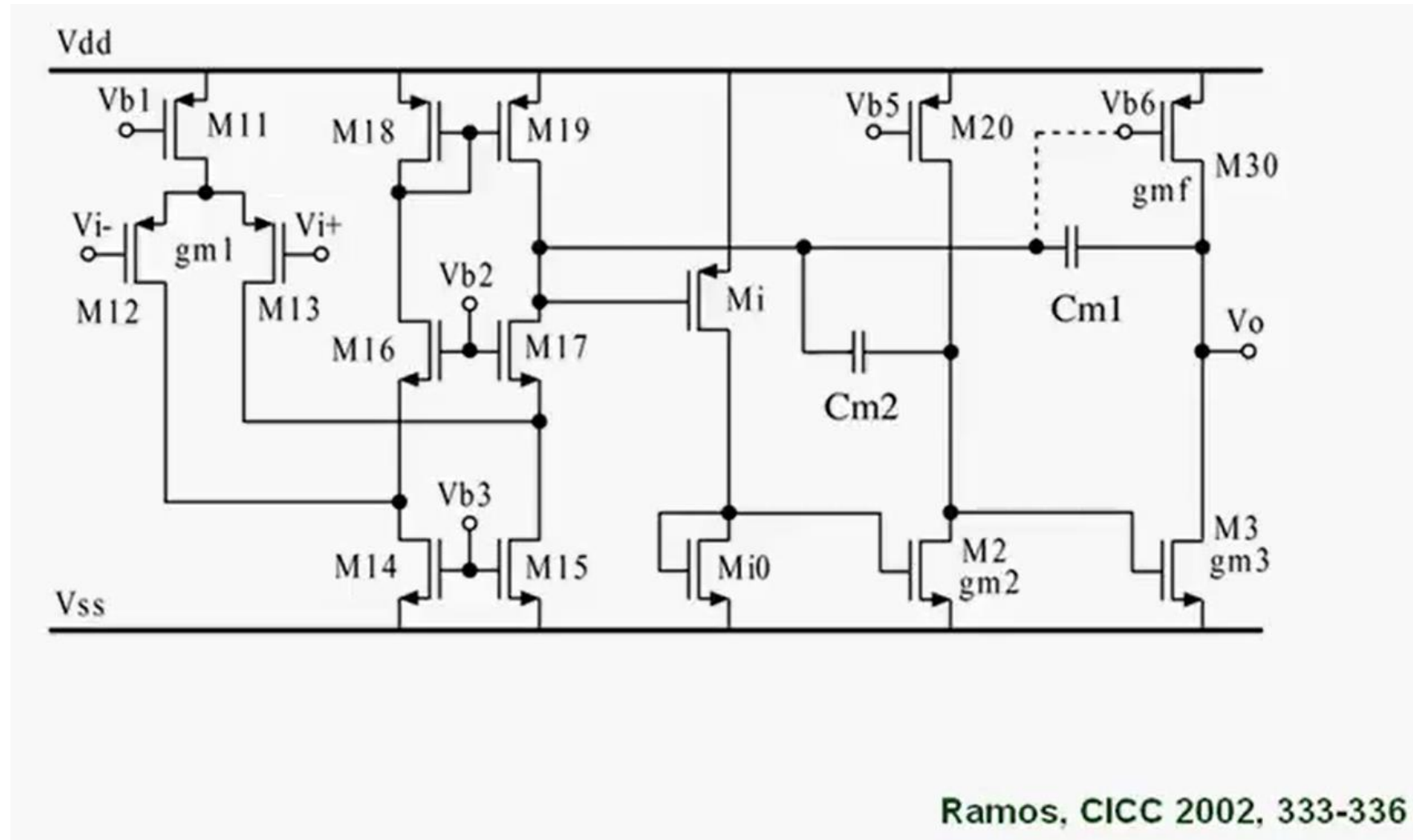
Ramos, CICC 2002, 333-336

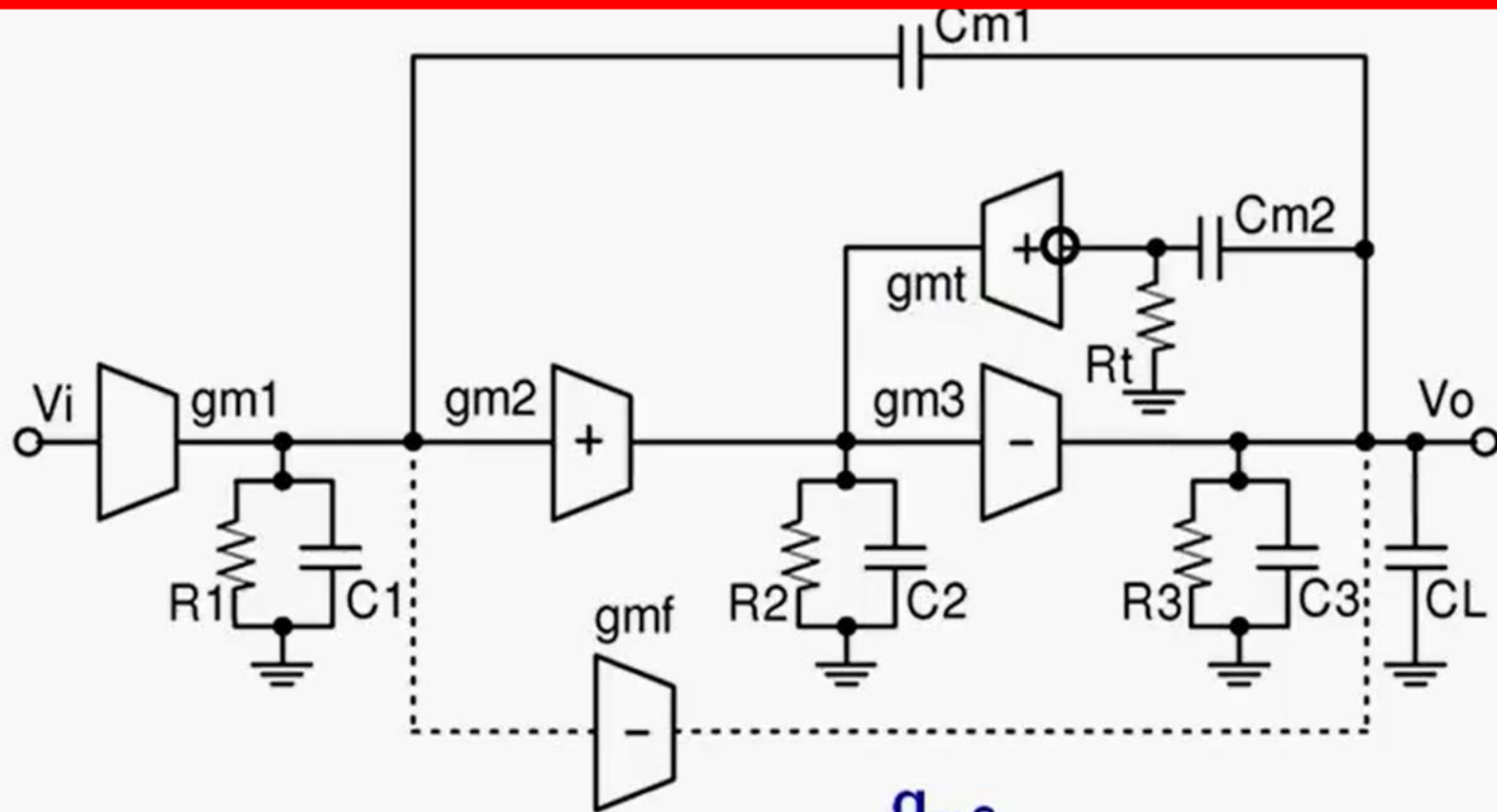
$$A_V(s) = \frac{A_{dc} \left(1 + \frac{s}{\omega_1} + \frac{s^2}{\omega_1 \omega_3} \right)}{\left(1 + \frac{s}{\omega_d} \right) \left(1 + \frac{s}{\omega_1} + \frac{s^2}{\omega_1 \omega_2} \right)}$$

$$A_{dc} = g_{m1} g_{m2} g_{m3} R_1 R_2 R_3$$

$$\omega_d = - \frac{1}{C_{m1} g_{m2} g_{m3} R_1 R_2 R_3}$$

CICC'02





$$k_t = \frac{g_{m2}}{g_{mt}}$$

$$GBW / GBW_{NMC} \approx 41$$

Peng, JSSC July 05, 1514-1520

$$A_V(s) = \frac{A_{dc} \left(1 + \frac{s}{\omega_2} + \frac{s^2}{\omega_2^2} + \frac{s^3}{\omega_2^2 \omega_4} \right)}{\left(1 + \frac{s}{\omega_d} \right) \left(1 + \frac{s}{\omega_1} + \frac{s^2}{\omega_1 \omega_2} + \frac{s^3}{\omega_1 \omega_2 \omega_3} \right)}$$

$$\omega_1 = \frac{1}{1+k_t} \frac{g_{m2}}{C_{m2}}$$

$$\omega_2 = \frac{1}{k_t} \frac{g_{m2}}{C_{m2}}$$

$$A_{dc} = g_{m1} g_{m2} g_{m3} R_1 R_2 R_3$$

$$\omega_d = - \frac{1}{C_{m1} g_{m2} g_{m3} R_1 R_2 R_3}$$

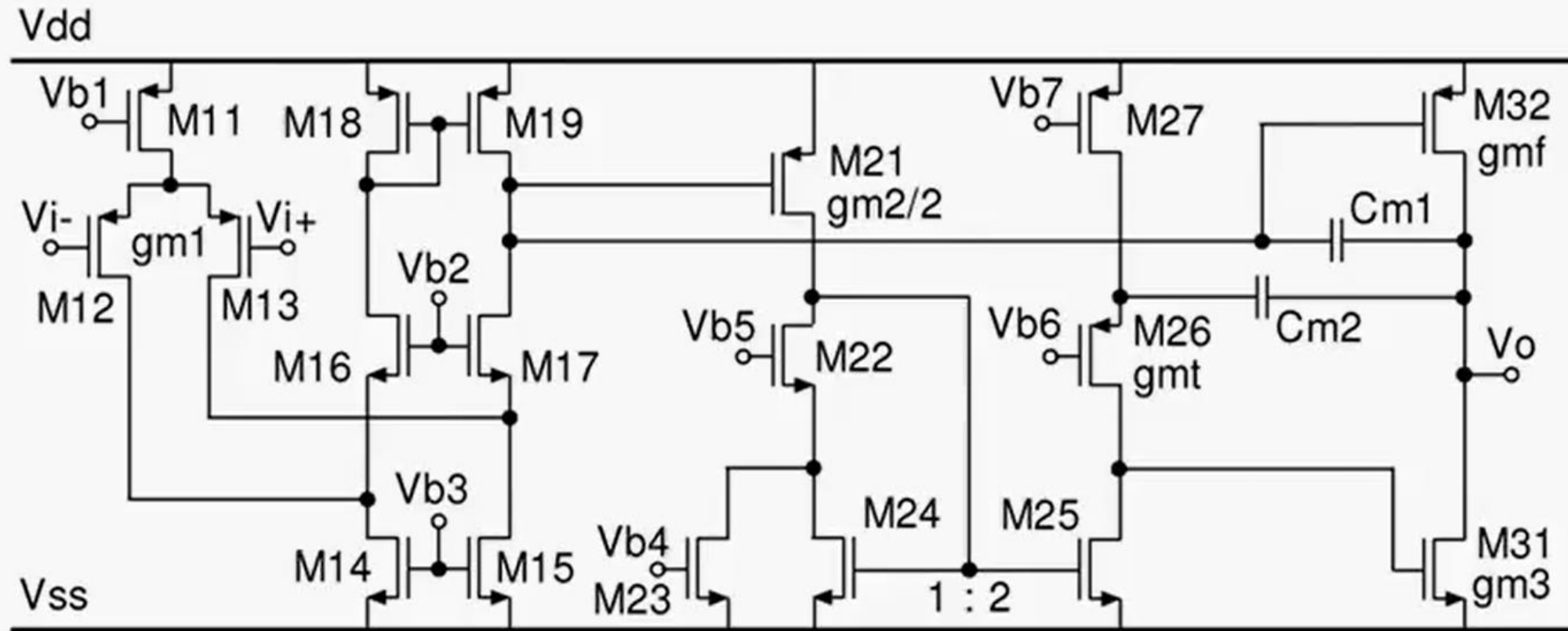
$$\omega_3 = (1+k_t) \frac{C_{m2}}{C_2} \frac{g_{m3}}{C_L}$$

$$\omega_{UG} = \frac{g_{m1}}{C_{m1}}$$

$$k_t = \frac{g_{m2}}{g_{mt}}$$

$$\omega_4 = - k_t \frac{C_{m2}}{C_2} \frac{g_{m3}}{g_{m1}} \omega_{UG}$$

JSSC'05

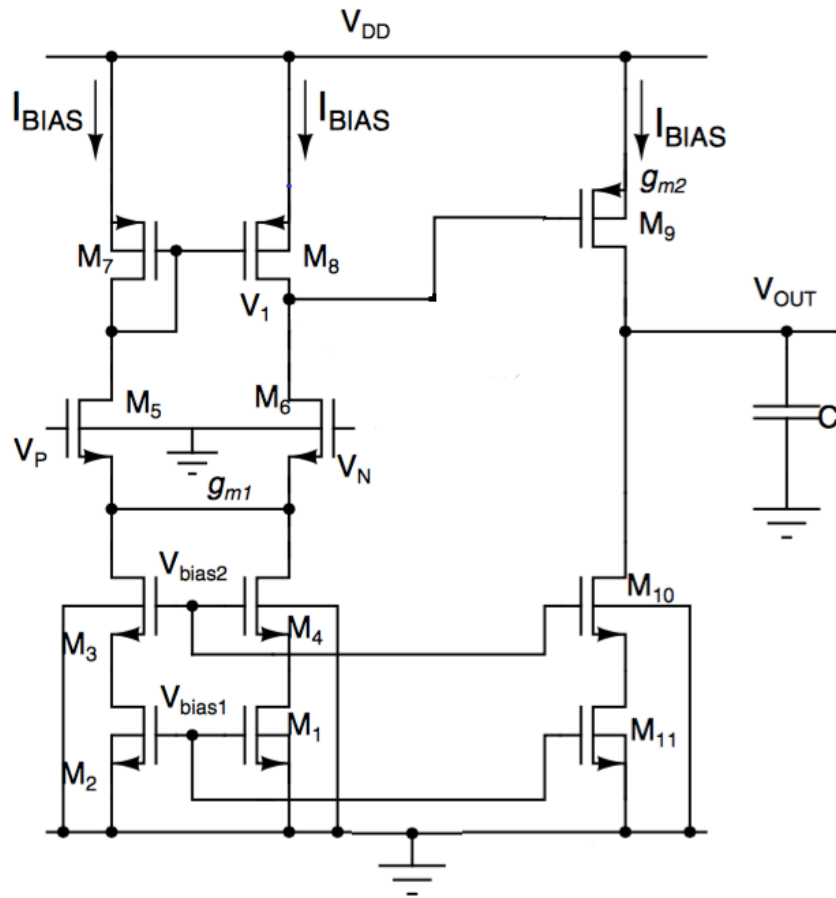


Case Study

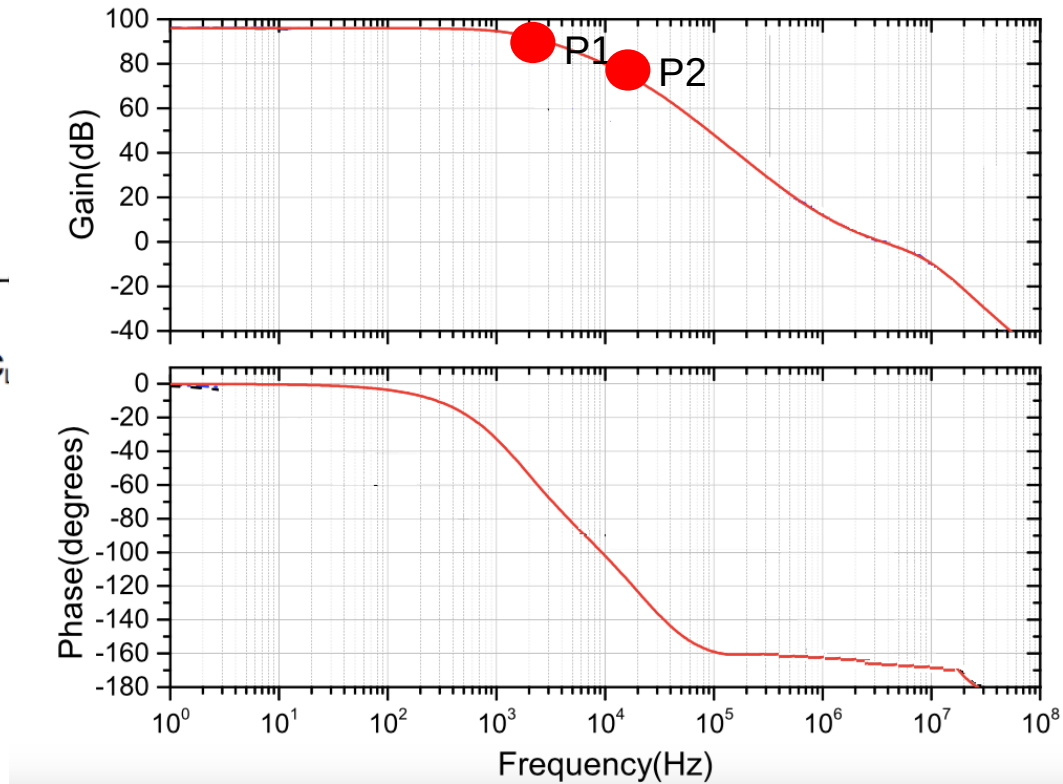
-3dB BW Enhancement Technique

(Hande et al, MWSCAS' 18)

-3dB BW Enhancement Technique



Two Stage Non-Compensated OTA



Phase Margin ~ 10

UNSTABLE !!

-3dB BW Enhancement Technique

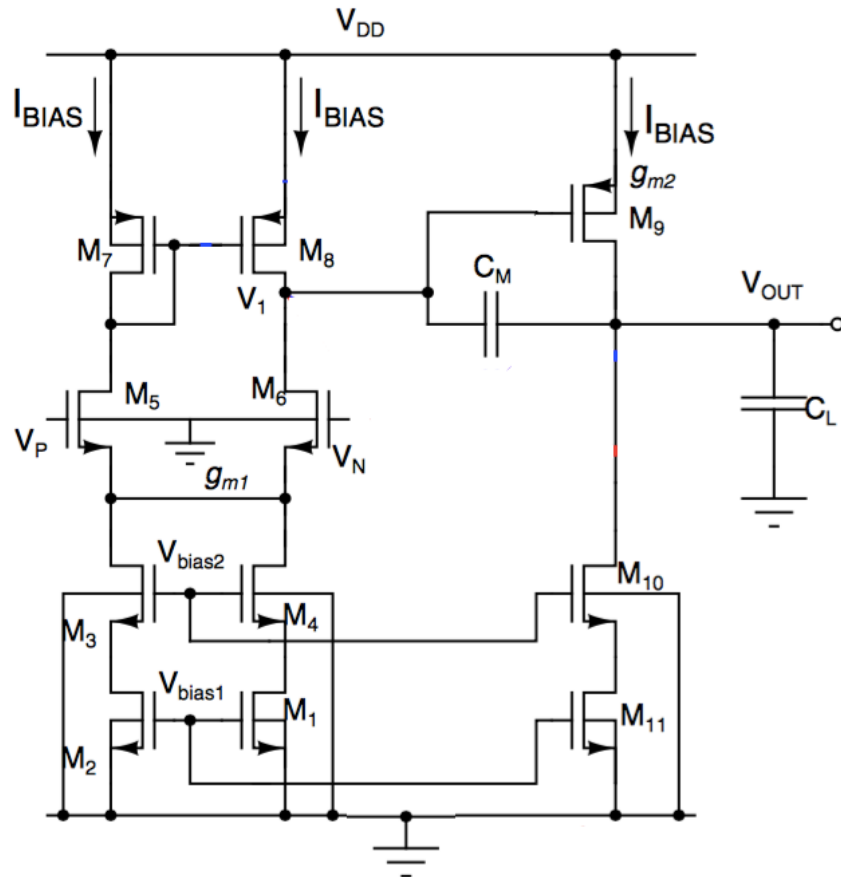
Solution :

Create a dominant pole in the system to make single pole system as it is inherently stable.

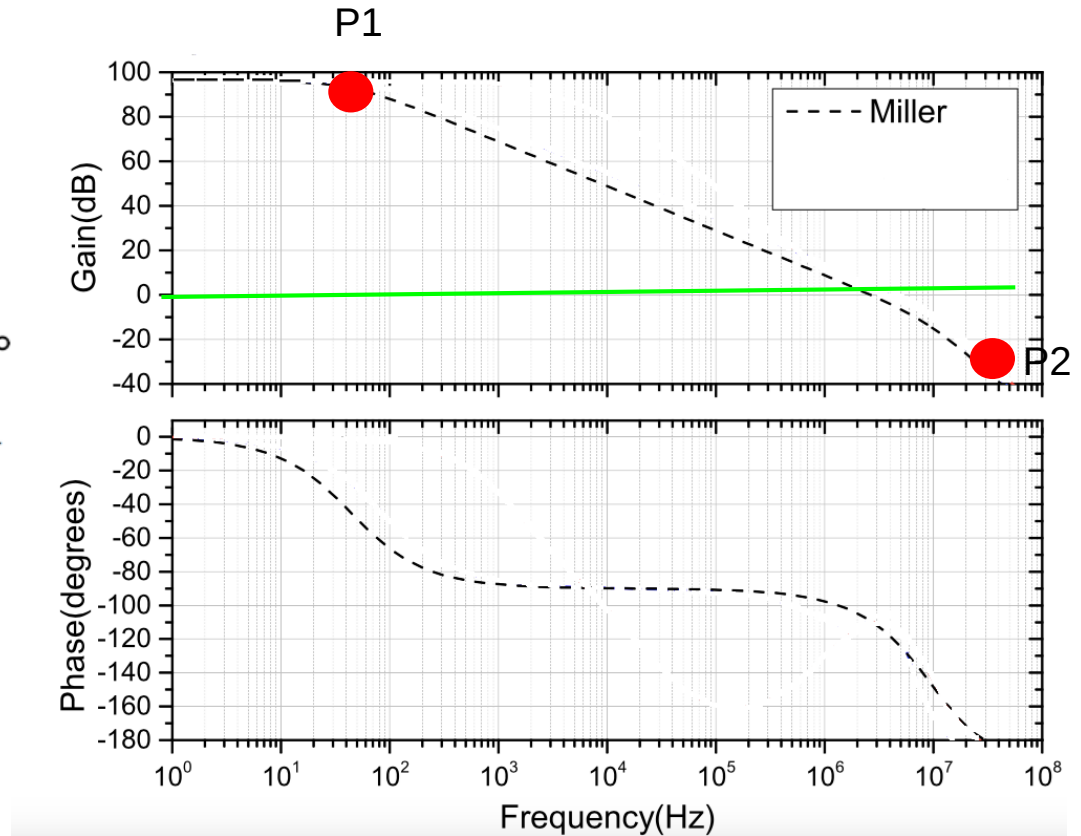
Push the P_1 to lower frequency

Disadvantage : *Reduction in -3dB bandwidth.*

-3dB BW Enhancement Technique

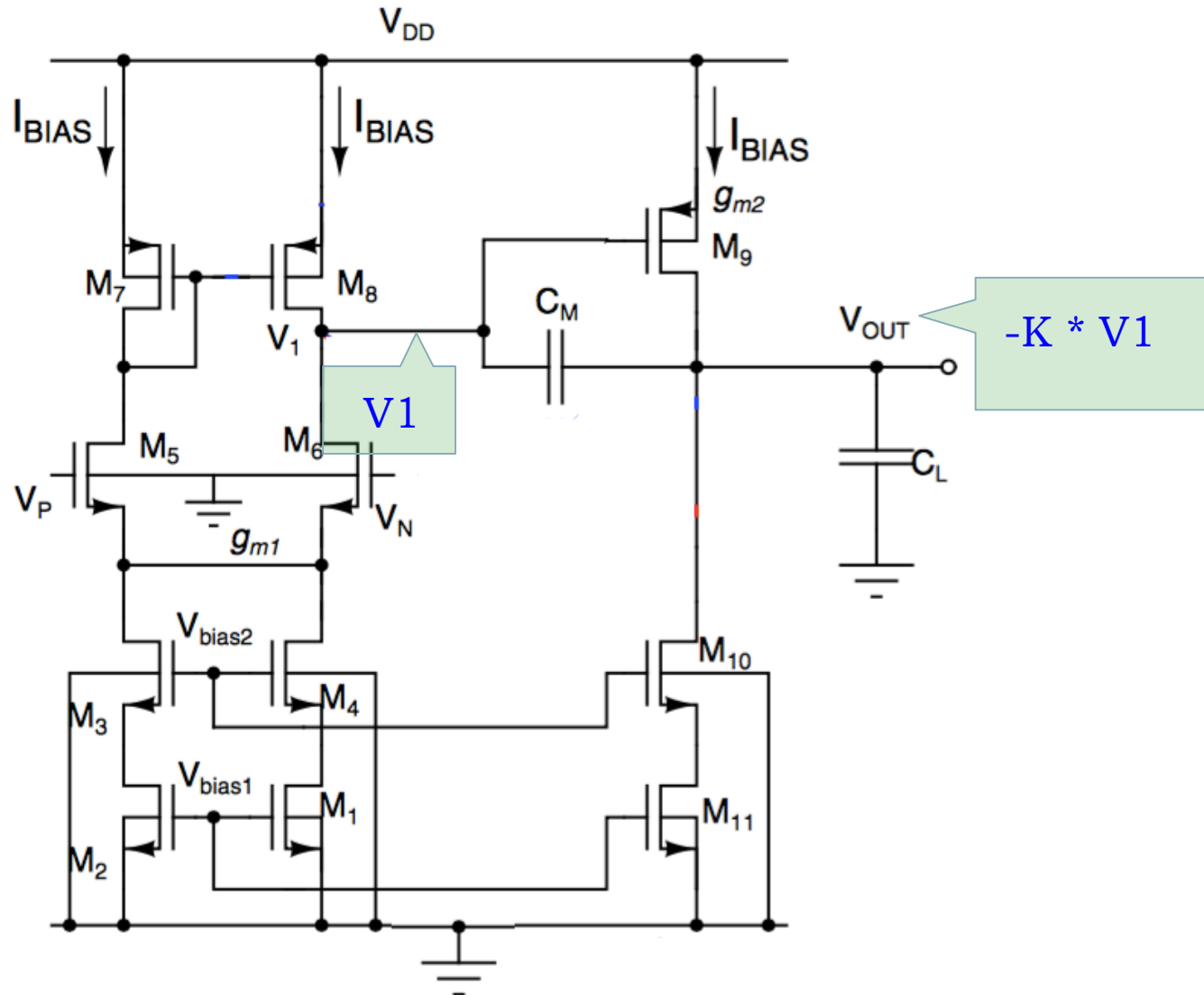


Two Stage Miller Compensated OTA



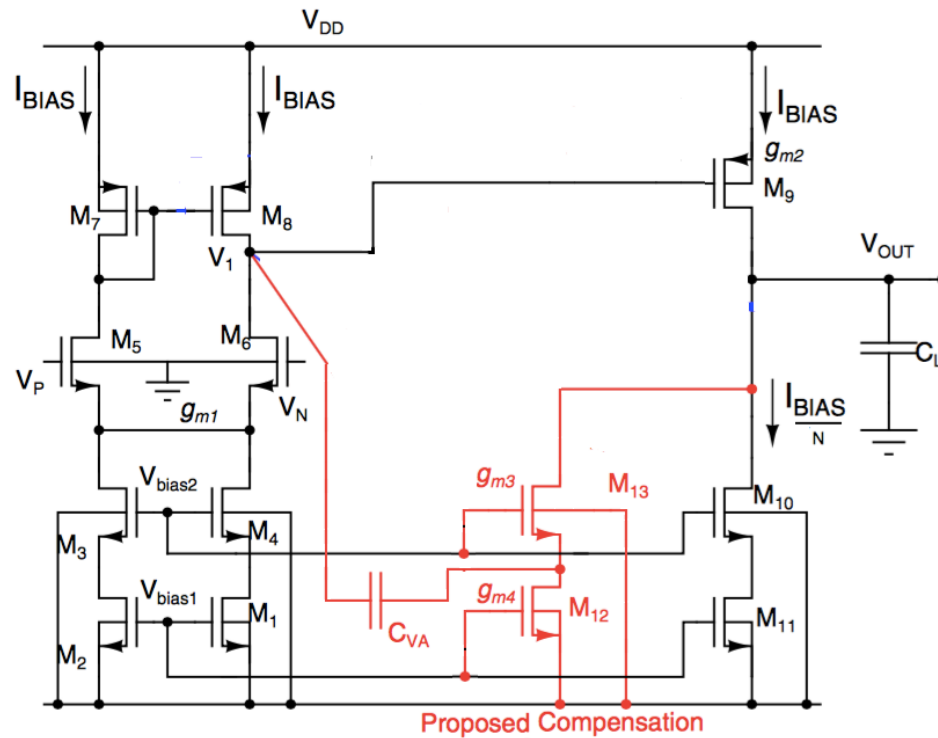
Phase Margin ~ 70

-3dB BW Enhancement Technique

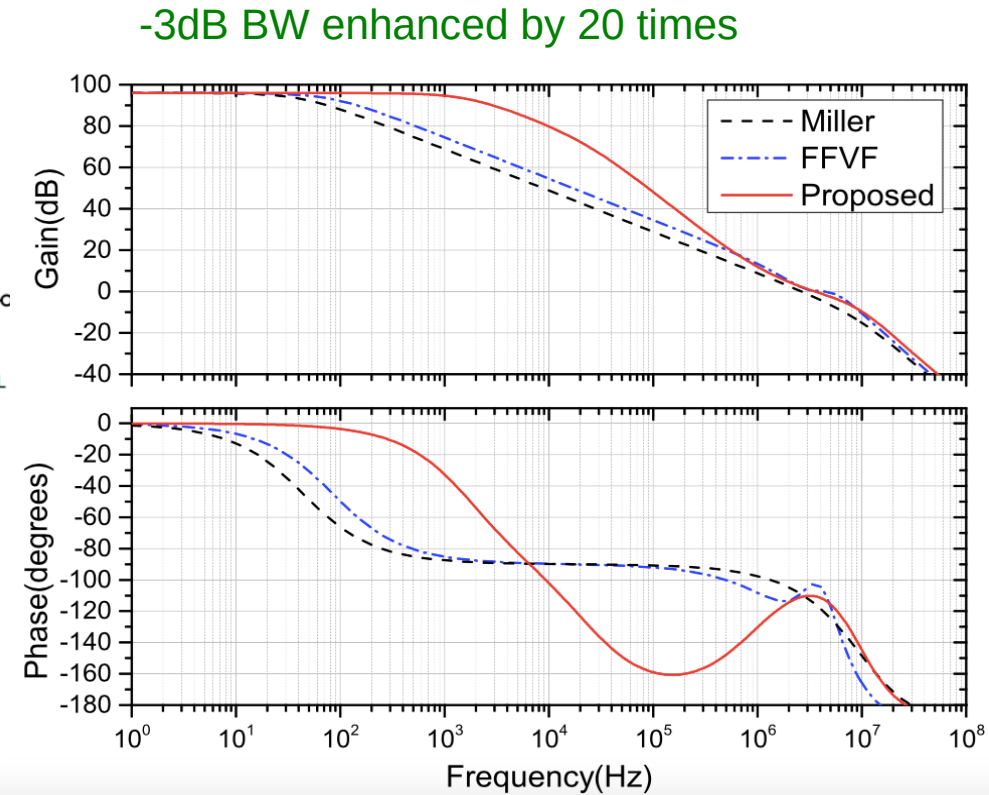




-3dB BW Enhancement Technique



Two Stage Miller Compensated OTA
LHP Zero introduced using $1/g_{m3}$.



Phase Margin almost 70

BW enhanced !!

Conclusion

Scaling in technology created opportunity to re-visit the classical analog design in terms of operational amplifier.

Reference :

Design of Analog Integrated Circuits and Systems by Kenneth R. Laker and Willy M. C. Sansen
and lectures provided by Willy Sansen